



Government of Bharat



Every moment of whose life symbolises an unwavering commitment to service and national interest, and for whom public welfare is a lifelong mission, under the leadership of such **Seva-Vrati Narendra Modi ji**, Bharat is experiencing continuous progress, and the entire nation is saying....

12 *Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke* Saal

» Welfare of the Poor

- Free monthly ration for 81+ crore people
- 4+ crore PM Awas houses, 10.5+ crore Ujjwala LPG connections and 12+ crore toilets made life easier

» Women Empowerment

- 32+ crore Jan Dhan accounts opened for women
- Permanent commission for women in the armed forces
- 3+ crore Lakhpati Didis
- 10 crore rural women empowered through 91+ lakh Self Help Groups

» Nation Building

- Metro network spanning 1,100+ km across 26 cities
- 164 Vande Bharat trains running across the country
- Major infrastructure projects built, including Atal Setu, Sudarshan Setu, Chenab Rail Bridge, Bogibeel Bridge and Pamban Sea Bridge
- Number of airports increased from 74 to 164

» Youth Empowerment

- Skill training for nearly 2 crore youth
- ₹40 lakh crore MUDRA Loan
- 2.2 lakh startups across the country
- 10,000+ Atal Tinkering Labs promoting innovation

» Healthcare

- Free treatment up to ₹5 lakh for senior citizens aged 70+
- Ayushman Bharat coverage for 60+ crore people
- Medicines at discounts of up to 90% through 19,000+ Jan Aushadhi Kendras nationwide

» Nation First

- Record defence exports worth nearly ₹38,400 crore
- Dream of a Naxal-free India becomes a reality, with a strong crackdown on terrorism
- Freedom from the colonial mindset – Rajpath became Kartavya Path, and a new Naval Ensign inspired by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

» Farmers' Welfare

- ₹4.3 lakh crore disbursed under PM-KISAN
- 4+ crore farmers received ₹2 lakh crore crop insurance coverage
- Crops worth ₹26+ lakh crore procured at MSP
- Kisan Credit Cards provided to 8 crore farmers

» Middle Class

- Annual income up to ₹12.75 lakh tax-free
- Affordable air travel for 1.6+ crore passengers under the UDAN Scheme
- MBBS seats increased by 151% to nearly 1.3 lakh

» Virasat aur Vikas

- Construction of the grand Ram Temple in Ayodhya
- Transformation of Kashi Vishwanath Dham, Mahakal Mahalok and Kedarnath Dham



U.S. PRESIDENT CLAIMS HE IS ‘DOING WORLD A SERVICE’ BY STOPPING TEHRAN FROM DEVELOPING NUCLEAR WEAPONS

Lebanon At Heart Of Iran-Israel Tensions



Missile parts on a scorched field near Najha, Syria, after Iranian projectiles sparked fires in the area on Monday. REUTERS

February 28
The United States and Israel attack Iran. War begins.

March 2
Hezbollah enters the war by firing rockets at Israel. Israel retaliates.

April 7
A fragile truce in the Iran war is announced, with talks to continue. Israel not included.

April 8
Israel bombards Lebanon's capital, Beirut, killing over 300 people in a 10-minute attack.

April 14
Lebanon and Israel hold their first direct diplomatic talks in decades in Washington.

April 17
A fragile truce is announced between Israel and Lebanon, but Hezbollah plays no part. Fighting resumes from both sides.

May 31
Israel's ground invasion of Lebanon makes its deepest incursion in over a quarter-century.

June 1
Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu threatens to strike Beirut if Hezbollah attacks don't stop. U.S. President Donald Trump says Israel and Hezbollah agree to calm the fighting. **AP**

June 2
Israeli drone strikes in Lebanon kill 11 people.

June 3
Israel and Lebanon say they agree to renew the fragile ceasefire and create security zones that exclude Hezbollah.

June 4
Hezbollah's leader rejects the ceasefire agreement and demands that Israel withdraw from Lebanon.

June 5
Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard says "there will be no calm in the region" if Israel doesn't withdraw.

June 6
Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon kill three members of the Lebanese military.

June 7
Hezbollah again fires at Israel. Israel strikes Beirut's southern suburbs. Iran fires at Israel.

June 8
Israel launches airstrikes in the early morning targeting central and western Iran in response to Iranian missile fire. Iranian state television reports the sound of explosions being heard in Isfahan, Tabriz and Tehran, without elaborating. **AP**

Trump: Iran conflict doesn't betray 'no new war' refrain

Associated Press
New Jersey, June 8

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump is dismissing the idea that launching the war with Iran this year betrayed his refrain of "No new wars" that he made repeatedly as he campaigned again for the White House.

Trump, in an interview that aired Sunday on NBC's *Meet the Press*, said he "didn't guarantee" there would be no wars if he were back in office. "First of all, I didn't guarantee no war. Why would I have built the strongest military in the world?" Trump said.

Trump also defended plans for a now-scrapped \$1.8 billion fund that would have compensated allies of the Republican president and he repeated his baseless claims of mass fraud in California's drawn-out vote count from Tuesday's primary.

In his 2024 campaign, Trump repeatedly cast his Democratic opponents as warmongers and said he was a president who started "no new wars" and would bring an era of peace.

But Trump said in the NBC interview, taped Friday in Wisconsin, that as a candidate, "I didn't promise anything."

"I don't like these endless wars. This is not an endless war. We've been doing this for three months," he said of the war with Iran, which began Feb. 28.

Trump said he was "doing the world a service" and "doing our country a service" because he had to stop Iran from having a nuclear weapon. But else-



President Donald Trump speaks at Custer Farms, Wisconsin. FILE

a nuclear weapon.

But elsewhere in the interview, Trump repeated a contradictory message where he said US strikes last year "obliterated" Iranian nuclear sites.

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where in the interview, Trump repeated a contradictory message where he said US strikes last year "obliterated" Iranian nuclear sites.

California's notoriously prolonged vote count has been a magnet for election conspiracy theories, and Trump since Tuesday's election has claimed without evidence that Democrats are rigging the election. The Trump-appointed top federal prosecutor in Los Angeles said Friday that his office had opened "multiple election fraud investigations."

While Trump has often said that changes to vote totals as late ballots are counted are a sign of fraud, they are merely a reflection of a slow vote-counting process. Trump in the interview kept claiming that it was a sign of "cheating" and "a rigged election."

Several Indian workers killed in road accident in Dubai: Officials

Press Trust of India
Dubai, June 8

SEVERAL INDIAN workers were killed on Monday when a minibus collided with a truck that had stopped in the middle of a road in Dubai, the authorities said. "Deeply saddened by the tragic road accident in Dubai that claimed the lives of several Indian workers," the Indian Consulate in Dubai said in a post on X.

The mission said that it is working closely with local authorities to provide all possible assistance and support.

Brigadier Juma Salem bin Suwaidan, Director of the General Department of Traffic at Dubai Police, said that preliminary investigations showed the truck had stopped suddenly in the middle of the Emirates Road due to a technical fault.

"The bus driver, who allegedly failed to pay attention and keep a safe distance, then rammed into the truck from behind," he said in a statement.

"The accident resulted in seven fatalities and nine injuries, including five serious and four moderate injuries. All injured were transported to the hospital for treatment," he added.

The officials from the Indian mission visited the hospital and met the injured Indians.

7.8-magnitude quake jolts Philippines, 32 dead



People look at a collapsed building following the magnitude 7.8 quake in General Santos, southern Philippines, on Monday. REUTERS

Reuters
Manila, June 8

THE DEATH toll in a powerful 7.8-magnitude earthquake off the southern Philippine island of Mindanao on Monday has risen to at least 32, with dozens of people injured, disaster officials said, as Manila stepped up search and rescue operations.

The quake, which triggered tsunami warnings across several countries, hit early in the morning about 20 km off the coast of Sarangani province, with tremors felt strongly across Mindanao and 420 km away in the city of Manado on the Indonesian island of Sulawesi.

Residents in the worst-affected location, General Santos City, home to about 700,000 people, recalled the fear they felt as tremors shook the area, saying they were unlike anything they

EU sanctions Iranians, IRGC unit for blocking ships in Hormuz

Reuters
Nicosia, June 8

THE EUROPEAN Union said on Monday it had imposed sanctions on two Iranian individuals and a unit of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps for threatening the freedom of maritime traffic in the Strait of Hormuz. The move marked the first time the bloc has used new powers to sanction Iran for restricting freedom of navigation.

The EU said that it had added the Hormozgan Provincial Command of the IRGC Navy to its sanctions list, as well as Mohammad Akbarzadeh and Hamid Hosseini. It said Akbarzadeh is Deputy Commander for Political Affairs of the IRGC Navy and Hosseini is a representative of Iran's Oil, Gas and Petrochemical Products Exporters' Union.

Commenting on the decision, Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi said Tehran doesn't attach any value to the EU's "political and hypocritical" move.

"Iran's actions are unacceptable... Member states have approved sanctions against Iranian entities... involved in disrupting transit through the Strait," Kaja Kallas said.

Trump's \$100,000 H-1B visa charge is unlawful: US judge

Reuters
Boston, June 8

A FEDERAL judge on Monday struck down a \$100,000 fee that US President Donald Trump imposed on new H-1B visas for highly skilled foreign workers, concluding that it constituted an unlawful tax that Congress never authorized.

US District Judge Leo Sorokin in Boston issued the ruling in a lawsuit filed by 20 Democratic state attorneys general challenging a fee Trump announced in September that dramatically raised the cost of obtaining H-1B visas. The H-1B program offers 65,000 visas annually, with another 20,000 visas for workers

with advanced degrees, approved for three to six years. Employers seeking a visa for a foreign worker before Trump's proclamation typically paid about \$2,000 to \$5,000 in fees depending on various factors.

The increase in fees has discouraged H-1B visa requests, according to court filings. As of February 15, US Citizenship and Immigration Services had received just 85 payments of the \$100,000 fee, the administration said in a March filing. The administration argued the fee constituted a monetary penalty that the president had lawful authority to impose under federal immigration law to restrict entry of certain foreign nationals.

BRIEFLY

NEPAL

House adjourned in minutes as PM Shah refuses to show up



Prime Minister Balen Shah at a press meet in Kathmandu. FILE

NEPAL'S HOUSE of Representatives was adjourned for the day within minutes of the session beginning after Prime Minister Balen Shah chose not to show up, despite opposition demands that he clarify his statement last Sunday on the Nepal-India border issue, in which he suggested external mediation. Adding to the government's troubles was the Finance Ministry's official website, which showed tax rates at variance with those announced in the budget presented by Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle last week. **YUBARAJ GHIMIRE**

UNITED KINGDOM

Starmer set to ban social media for the under-16

BRITISH PRIME Minister Keir Starmer is set to announce a ban on "harmful" online platforms for children under 16 while maintaining access to some safer forms of social media, the *Times* newspaper reported Monday. Starmer is said to have decided to proceed with restrictions after speaking to bereaved parents. **REUTERS**

FRANCE

70,000 child abuse reports under review

FRENCH JUSTICE Minister Gerald Darmanin said on Monday he had told public prosecutors to review 70,000 ongoing allegations of violence against minors, after an outcry over the death of an 11-year-old girl. The girl's death had caused outrage after authorities said they had not acted on previous child rape allegations against the main suspect in the case. **REUTERS**

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

Gilgit-Baltistan heading for a coalition govt

PAKISTAN-OCCUPIED Kashmir's Gilgit-Baltistan region was poised for a coalition government as none of the parties could win a majority in the so-called legislative assembly elections, according to media reports on Monday. President Asif Ali Zardari's Pakistan Peoples Party has secured nine seats. Five independent candidates have won the polls, *Geo News* reported, citing unofficial results. **PTI**

SRI LANKA

Opp mounts protest backing former spy chief

A GROUP of Sri Lankan opposition leaders Monday led a protest in support of detained former head of the state intelligence service Suresh Sallay. He was admitted to the National Hospital last night due to his resorting to a fast unto death, alleging degrading treatment under detention. His transfer came after a letter to the inspector general by his wife Manori Sallay which alleged her husband was "tortured..." **PTI**

THIS YEAR'S AWARDS CAP A RECORD BROADWAY SEASON, HAVING GENERATED \$1.91 BILLION IN GROSSES AS AUDIENCES TURNED OUT FOR BOTH ESTABLISHED HITS AND NEW PRODUCTIONS

From *Liberation* to *Ragtime*, Tony winners take a turn towards social themes

Associated Press
New York, June 8

SCHMIGADOON! WON the Tony Award for best musical on Sunday, while more socially driven works dominated other top categories, with *Liberation* taking best play, *Ragtime* best musical revival and John Lithgow best leading actor for *Giant*. Based on a television series, *Schmigadoon!* is a send-up of Golden Age Broadway shows, following a modern couple drawn into a musical theater fantasy world.

Liberation, a drama examining the legacy of the 1970s women's liberation movement, added to its 2026 Pulitzer Prize for drama, as author Bess Wohl became the fourth woman to win the Tony Award for best play and the first since 2009.

Ragtime prevailed over *Cats: The Jellicle Ball*, reviving

a sweeping story that intertwines Black, immigrant and upper-class white lives, exploring race, class and the promise of the American Dream at the dawn of the 20th century. Caisie Levy and Joshua Henry won best lead actress and actor for their roles in the show.

In *Giant*, the 80-year-old Lithgow portrayed author Roald Dahl in the 1980s as he faces fallout for remarks deemed antisemitic and weighs apologizing against risking his reputation. It was his third Tony, having won his first 53 years ago for his Broadway debut in *The Changing Room*.

"At every point we had to figure out, 'Why is this man doing this?'" he told reporters later. "Antisemitism, cruelty of all kinds... these are things that we're dealing with these days up front and personal... that's what makes *Giant* so important

and such a success."

Lesley Manville won best lead actress in a play for her role as Jocasta in Robert Icke's reimagining of the Sophocles classic *Oedipus* as a political thriller.

Death of a Salesman, Joe Mantello's staging of Arthur Miller's American classic, won best revival of a play, with Mantello taking best direction of a play and Laurie Metcalf winning featured actress in a play for her role as Linda Loman — her third Tony. The play also stars veteran Nathan Lane.

This year's awards cap a record Broadway season, having generated \$1.91 billion in grosses as audiences turned out for both established hits and new productions.

Pop singer Pink, hosting the ceremony at Radio City Music Hall, led a huge opening number with a Broadway-updated rendition of *Lady Marmalade* and



Pink at the 79th Annual Tony Awards in New York City. REUTERS

featuring the cast of every single nominated musical.

There were plenty of Easter eggs in the number, including veteran actress Lea Michele singing, "We don't do it for the awards" and trans actor Dylan Mulvaney singing, *Protect the dolls*. Michele herself, the lead-

ing lady in the revival *Chess*, was passed over for a nomination this year.

Zhailon Levinston and Bill Rauch won best direction of a musical for *Cats: The Jellicle Ball*, a bold reimagining of Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical that places the story within

New York's ballroom culture. Shoshana Bean won best featured actress in a musical for *The Lost Boys*, a stage adaptation of the 1987 vampire cult classic film that follows two brothers who move to a California beach town and discover it is inhabited by vampires. This was Bean's third nomination and first win.

Ali Louis Bourzgui won best featured actor in a musical for his role as lead vampire in the show. Alden Ehrenreich won best featured actor in a play for *Becky Shaw*.

In a preshow, Queen Jean won best costume design of a musical and Omari Wiles and Arturo Lyons won best choreography, both for *Cats: The Jellicle Ball*. Queen Jean became the first openly transgender person to win a Tony Award according to the show's publicist.

THE TONY GOES TO...



Best Leading Actor in a Musical:
Joshua Henry, *Ragtime*



Best Leading Actress in a Musical:
Caisie Levy, *Ragtime*



Best Leading Actor in a Play:
John Lithgow, *Giant*



Best Leading Actress in a Play:
Lesley Manville, *Oedipus*



Best Direction of a Musical:
Zhailon Levinston & Bill Rauch, *Cats: The Jellicle Ball*



Best Direction of a Play:
Joe Mantello, *Death of a Salesman*



BENGAL CM ALSO PRESENT AT MEETING; MAMATA CAMP PUTS REBEL STRENGTH AT 12

Crisis deepens for Mamata as her Lok Sabha team breaks, rebel TMC MPs reach out to BJP

Rebels say 20 of TMC’s 28 MPs with them; 14 attend meeting at BJP minister’s house

Manoj C G & Ravik Bhattacharya
New Delhi, Kolkata, June 8

THE CRISIS in the Trinamool Congress (TMC) deepened on Monday, with the rebel camp claiming that at least 20 of the party’s 28 Lok Sabha MPs have decided to form a separate bloc and align with the BJP-led NDA. This is a massive blow to party chief Mamata Banerjee, who has already lost control of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



Sukhendu Sekhar Ray after resigning from the TMC and the Rajya Sabha, in New Delhi, Monday. ANIL SHARMA

At INDIA bloc meeting, allies take aim at Cong

Manoj C G & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, June 8

THE CONGRESS faced criticism from some of the constituents of the INDIA bloc at the alliance’s meeting here on Monday, with leaders such as Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav and Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) national working president Tejashwi Yadav indulging in some plain speaking. Some of the leaders, including those from the CPI(M) and the NCP (SP),

also took a dig at the Congress for breaking its alliance with the DMK in Tamil Nadu.

After the meeting, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, flanked by Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, announced the decision to write to the Chief Justice of India (CJI) on alleged electoral irregularities and press for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

STOP SHOOTING, SAYS TRUMP



Smoke rises near the Mahshahr petrochemical complex after an Israeli attack in Iran’s Khuzestan province on Monday. REUTERS

Israel and Iran trade strikes, pause, but warn of more attacks

US hits oil tanker, 24 Indian crew members rescued

Jon Gambrell & Melanie Lidman
Dubai, June 8

ISRAEL AND Iran appeared to back away from further strikes Monday, hours after they traded fire for the first time since the US agreed to a cease-fire with Tehran two months ago. Both countries warned that they were ready to launch retaliatory attacks if provoked. The renewed hostilities raised concerns that the Middle East could be plunged back into a full-scale war. Since the US and Israel

INSIDE PAGE 9
INDIA CALLS FOR DE-ESCALATION, ISSUES TRAVEL ADVISORY

began striking Iran on February 28, the war has shaken the global economy, driven energy prices up around the world and made many basics, including food, more expensive. Officials have been unable to turn the April ceasefire into a deal to permanently end the conflict. The new attacks prompted US President Donald Trump to call for an immediate stop to fighting between Israel and Iran. “Israel and Iran must immediately stop ‘shooting,’” he wrote

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• A FIVE-DAY MEETING of the BRICS grouping will commence in Indore to discuss food security, smart farming, global agricultural trade and farmer welfare.

TRACK THIS AND MORE ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

POLITICS PAGE 6

MOU INKED, BENGAL FINALLY COMES UNDER AYUSHMAN BHARAT AMBIT

New bilateral investment model: 2-yr local remedy window, no MFN clause

Aanchal Magazine & Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 8

A MINIMUM two-year period for local remedies before initiation of international arbitration; no most-favoured nation clause; and, an exclusion of tax-related provisions.

These are the three key principles on which the Centre is re-modelling its Bilateral Investment Treaties (BITs) with countries, *The Indian Express*

has learnt.

Amid the recent debate on various issues with the BIT model, the Centre is considering tailoring them according to engagement with other countries, with even a one-year cooling window for local remedies being considered for a few countries amid ongoing negotiations, a top Government source told this newspaper.

“We have to protect the sovereignty of our country, the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

To hike LS strength, Govt works on more clarity, eyes South, DMK support

Damini Nath
New Delhi, June 8

TWO MONTHS after its first attempt to pass a Constitution amendment to operationalise delimitation and women’s reservation was defeated in the Lok Sabha in April, the government now plans to reintroduce it with some changes that clarify that the number of seats of all states in the Lok Sabha with an enhanced strength of 850 seats will

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Delimitation and Census

A big concern around delimitation is the year of Census to be used for deciding how Lok Sabha seats will be allocated among states. The Bill is likely to clarify that seats will be proportionate to states’ population as in Census 1971.

8 killed as molten metal spills, triggers fire at Vizag steel plant

Sreenivas Janyala & Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, June 8

AT LEAST eight workers were killed on Monday when a ladle carrying molten steel broke and caused a massive fire at the Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Ltd (RINL) plant, also known as Visakhapatnam Steel Plant, officials said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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Vijay's Gambit

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay plays chess with Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa in Chennai on Monday. ANI

Bhagwant Singh surplus land case: Ambala officer cancels mutation of 810 acres

Awards land worth Rs 5,000 cr to state

Sukhbir Siwach
Chandigarh, June 8

AMBALA DIVISIONAL Commissioner Sanjeev Verma has directed to cancel mutation of over 810 acres of land in the names of private owners in seven villages of Panchkula district. The land, valued at Rs 5,000 crore at current rates, is part of the estate belonging to Sardar Bhagwant Singh, an erstwhile king, and is located in seven villages of Panchkula district.

The order passed by Verma on May 26, exercising his quasi-judicial powers, also directs that the entire landholding be mutated in the name of the state government.

A substantial portion of the disputed land is situated along the National Highway-7 corridor connecting Panchkula and Yamunanagar. Several residential projects, including some belonging to the VIPs, have already come up on parts of the land over the years.

The dispute pertains to around 1,394 acres spread across seven villages of Panchkula district — Beed Babupur, Beed Firzadi, Bhareli, Sangrana, Barwala, Jaloli and Fatehpur Viran. The land belonged to Bhagwant

Singh who died in 1960, leaving behind seven legal heirs, who could claim part of the estate. For the past over seven decades, legal proceedings have been ongoing to determine what they could inherit and the surplus, which, as per law, must vest in the state government.

According to a report submitted by the Panchkula Tehsildar, of the total landholding, 583 acres, 3 kanals and 16 marlas had been mutated in favour of the state government, while the remaining 810 acres, 5 kanals and 7 marlas are recorded in the names of private landowners.

The Commissioner held that the surplus land case must be decided by treating the entire landholding as belonging to Sardar Bhagwant Singh. The order notes that the status of the landholding has to be assessed as it existed on April 15, 1953, the reference date under the Punjab Security of Land Tenures Act, 1953. Holding that the entire estate vests in the state government under the applicable land ceiling laws, the Commissioner directed that the remaining 810 acres, 5 kanals and 7 marlas standing in the names of private owners be mutated in favour of the state government.

TMC crisis

the TMC Legislature Party in the West Bengal Assembly. While the rebel group led by Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar claimed the support of as many as 20 MPs, at least 14 of them attended a meeting at Union Minister Bhupender Yadav's home along with Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari. Those close to Mamata Banerjee put the number of rebels at 12. Later in the day, eight rebel MPs met at the residence of Satabdi Roy in the presence of Adhikari.

The rebel camp claimed that the Lok Sabha MPs who attended the meeting at Yadav's home are Ghosh Dastidar, Roy, Bapi Haldar, Arup Chakraborty, June Maliah, Deepak Adhikari (Dev), Kalipada Saren, Jagadish Basunia, Asit Mal, Md Abu Taher Khan, Khalilur Rahaman, Sharmila Sarkar, Prasun Banerjee, and Partha Bhowmick. The dissidents claimed the support of six more MPs. To escape the provisions of the anti-defection law, they need the support of at least 19 MPs.

The TMC witnessed a flurry

of developments in Delhi through the day. While Mamata Banerjee and TMC's second-in-command Abhishek, her nephew and the TMC's leader in the Lok Sabha, attended a meeting of the Opposition INDIA bloc, the rebels moved ahead to split the Lok Sabha wing. The first blow came in the morning when Rajya Sabha MP Sukhendu Sekhar Ray resigned from the primary membership of the party and as a member of the Upper House. There is a likelihood of one more Rajya Sabha MP resigning, sources said.

His resignation from the Upper House has been accepted by Chairman C P Radhakrishnan. Asked why he had resigned, Ray told *The Indian Express*, "Because of the situation that was prevailing in the party for a long time." He refused to provide a definitive answer on whether he would join another party, saying, "I have spent 59 years in politics. So I have to take a call at the appropriate time after introspection and retrospection."

The dissident Lok Sabha MPs and Ray then met at a hotel before proceeding to the house of Bhupender Yadav, who was the BJP's West Bengal election

in-charge. Soon afterwards, Adhikari too arrived at Yadav's Motilal Nehru Marg residence.

Ghosh Dastidar, the Barasat MP, claimed that 20 TMC MPs, including her, had written to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, requesting him for "separate seating". This bloc of TMC MPs would "formally support the NDA" and work with the Central and state government for West Bengal's development, she said. Sources in the Speaker's office, however, said they had not yet received any letter from the MPs.

Sources said Ghosh Dastidar signed the letter as the party's chief whip. The rebels said that though Kalyan Banerjee had replaced the Barasat MP as the chief whip on Mamata Banerjee's directions last month, the change was not completed through the required parliamentary procedure. This has allowed Ghosh Dastidar to claim the post of chief whip.

Bardhaman Purba MP Sharmila Sarkar also claimed that the rebels had submitted the letter. "We held a meeting. We want to sit separately. I respect Didi (Mamata). I wanted to work, but I could not. Under the leadership of Kakoli di, this sep-

arate bloc has been formed," she said.

"We are 20 MPs. We held a meeting at Bhupender Yadav's residence in the presence of CM Suwendu Adhikari. We need to support the NDA for Bengal's development. Kakoli di submitted the letter. So far, she is leading our bloc," Sarkar said.

Those close to Mamata Banerjee said the dissidents do not have the support of two-thirds of the MPs. "The fake and fabricated narrative of the dirty tricks department of BJP is giving numbers of 20 MPs. There were 13 MPs — 12 from Lok Sabha and one from Rajya Sabha — who attended the meeting at Bhupender Yadav's house. No one else has signed on the dotted line apart from these," TMC's Bardhaman-Durgapur MP Kirti Azad said in a social media post.

Azad also disputed Ghosh Dastidar's claim to the chief whip's post, sharing a copy of the letter Mamata Banerjee sent to Speaker Birla on May 20 — in her capacity as chairperson of the TMC Parliamentary Party — informing him about the decision to appoint Kalyan Banerjee as the chief whip.

Opp meet

over paper leaks and exam glitches.

Kharge also demanded that the Centre immediately convene an all-party meeting to discuss the economic situation in the country, unemployment, price rise, and issues related to farmers. The Congress chief said the INDIA bloc parties had agreed to meet every two months and the next meeting would be held in Hyderabad in August. The bloc members would also coordinate their actions during the Monsoon Session, with daily morning meetings in Kharge's office.

Sources said that in the meeting, Akhilesh Yadav bluntly told the Congress leadership — represented at the meeting by Kharge, Rahul, and Sonia Gandhi — that the party should show a "large heart" and be "accommodative".

The SP president pointed out that the alliance itself was meeting after a long gap and during this time the political situation had become much more

"vitiated". He said the alliance should introspect whether it was acting the way it should.

Akhilesh was critical of the Congress for breaking the alliance with the DMK, a point endorsed by NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule and CPI(M)'s John Brittas. The DMK did not attend the meeting.

The SP chief said the Congress's state units were perhaps not being able to gauge the seriousness of the situation. Tejashwi Yadav endorsed this and, at one point, said the Congress's state leadership in Bihar was "compromised".

Referring to the ED raids at the residence of former Kerala CM Pinarayi Vijayan, Akhilesh said INDIA bloc members should stand with each other when central agencies target any of them.

Mamata Banerjee spoke about "political atrocities" before, during, and after the Assembly elections in West Bengal. She appealed to the bloc's leaders to stand united and let the Congress take the lead in coordination. She said the Opposition alliance needs to encourage civil

society movements and not criticise each other.

Alleging that the West Bengal election was "stolen", Banerjee called for a delegation of the alliance to meet the Election Commission, but the proposal did not find much traction. In the end, it was decided that the bloc would write to the CJI.

Shiv Sena (UBT) president Uddhav Thackeray, who joined the meeting virtually, suggested the alliance project a leader as its face. He argued that the alliance should introspect why an online phenomenon such as the Cockerroach Janta Party (CJP) had managed to get traction unlike the Opposition. "Have people lost faith in us?" he is learnt to have asked.

Brittas conveyed his party's displeasure to Congress about attacks on Vijayan by its national leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, during the recent Assembly elections. Brittas too flagged the Congress breaking its alliance with DMK, saying driving out the party from the INDIA bloc was not "a good omen".

CPI-ML (Liberation) general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya

said that a joint coordination team should work on capturing the space against the BJP on "people's issues". He also said the alliance should extend solidarity to people's movements such as the CJP.

Rahul Gandhi said he accepted all the criticism with a smile and assured the leaders that his role was to unite all of them with "love and affection". He asked the parties to remain united to fight BJP and stop pulling each other down. He said some parties often criticise the Congress, which should be avoided. He reiterated his long-held view that elections in the country are stolen. "It is clear that Congress and INDIA are on one side and on the other side it is BJP-RSS. We will have love and affection to unite these parties," he said.

Gandhi said he had no personal enmity with Vijayan and that speeches during campaigning are crafted after incorporating inputs from the state leadership. He played down his attacks on Vijayan, saying it was done during campaigning and should not be taken personally.

LS strength

be in proportion to their existing numbers.

According to at least two senior government functionaries, talks are ongoing with the DMK, which recently lost the Assembly elections in Tamil Nadu. With Lok Sabha MPs of Trinamool also resigning, issue-based support may be forthcoming from both the DMK and the Trinamool Congress, they said. Both had earlier rejected the Constitution amendment Bill.

The government plans to retain the 1971 Census in which the increased number of seats will be allocated among states while increasing the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha from 550 to 850, a senior government functionary and BJP leader told *The Indian Express*.

A Delimitation Commission, to be set up following the enactment of a separate Delimitation Bill, will decide on how the new Lok Sabha and Assembly constituencies will be redrawn.

For the division of Assembly constituencies within states, the 2011 Census could be the basis, changing from the current basis of 2001 Census, one of the two functionaries said.

As of now, Article 81(3) of the Constitution says the allotment of Lok Sabha seats to states and the division of states into territorial constituencies would be as per population "at the last preceding Census", until the fig-

ures for the first Census taken after 2026 are published.

A senior government functionary argued that if the Constitution amendment is not passed, the delimitation process would get automatically triggered when the ongoing 2027 Census, which has a reference date of March 1, 2027, is completed next year. This would mean that the gap between the Northern states and Southern states in terms of population, and therefore the distribution of seats, would widen.

"This is one good reason for southern states to agree to what is being proposed," the functionary said, referring to Union Home Minister's earlier statement in Lok Sabha that each state's number of Lok Sabha seats would go up by 50% when the Lok Sabha strength goes up from 543 now to 816.

But the northern states had then refused to buy Shah's oral commitment in Lok Sabha on April 17 during the debate on the three bills — Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty-First Amendment) Bill, 2026 had sought to amend Article 81(3) to define the population on the basis of which the allotment of seats would be done as "population as ascertained at such census, as Parliament may by law determine". The Opposition had wanted an assurance on which Census would be used for the same, which the Bill had not specified.

Home Minister Amit Shah

had said during the debate that "no injustice would be done to any state, particularly to the states of South India". He had

anidhi asked in Lok Sabha during the debate.

But there is a lot at stake for southern states now, argued the senior BJP leader and government functionary. If the size of the Lok Sabha is not increased, then the southern states would see a reduction in seats, which would be more if the basis is 2027 instead of 2011. In case the Opposition does not agree, the freeze on readjustment of seats that has been there for the past 50 years would expire as soon as the 2027 Census is notified next year, automatically triggering delimitation on the basis of this Census, BJP sources said. This would mean that the Southern states would see a reduction in their seats.

As of now, the Lok Sabha seats are allotted on the basis of the 1971 Census and the Assembly constituencies on the basis of the 2001 Census.

The Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty-First Amendment) Bill, 2026 had sought to amend Article 81(3) to define the population on the basis of which the allotment of seats would be done as "population as ascertained at such census, as Parliament may by law determine". The Opposition had wanted an assurance on which Census would be used for the same, which the Bill had not specified.

Home Minister Amit Shah had said during the debate that "no injustice would be done to any state, particularly to the states of South India". He had

prices skyrocketed. Israel has continued to strike Hezbollah, Iran's ally in Lebanon, and pushed deeper into that country.

The US military continues to impose a blockade on Iranian ports. US Central Command said its forces on Monday fired on and disabled a Palau-flagged oil tanker, the MT Marivex, in the Gulf of Oman after the ship attempted to breach the blockade.

Officials in India said the tanker's crew of 24 Indian sailors were all reported safe after a fire broke out on the vessel. It was the seventh commercial vessel the US military has disabled to enforce its blockade, which began in mid-April. Iran launched waves of at-

said the proportion of seats allocated to each state as of now would be maintained if the Lok Sabha's strength was increased to 816. He said Karnataka's seats would increase from 28 to 42, with its share of total seats going from 5.15% to 5.14%. Similarly, Tamil Nadu's seats would go from 39 to 59, with the seat share going from 7.18% to 7.23%; Andhra Pradesh's seats would increase from 25 to 38, with its share increasing slightly from 4.60% to 4.65%; Telangana's seats would go from 17 to 26 and its share from 3.13% to 3.18%; and Kerala's seats from 20 to 30 and its share from 3.68% to 3.67%, as per the data given in the Lok Sabha.

After the Bill was negated, Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju asked the Speaker not to take up the other two Bills that were moved - the Delimitation Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 - saying that they were linked to the Constitution amendment Bill. These two Bills are yet to be withdrawn and remain pending in the Lok Sabha.

Government sources say the government has the option of bringing the same Constitution Bill to Parliament in the Monsoon Session or make some amendments, get it cleared by the Cabinet and then introduce it. Even if the Constitution amendment Bill is not passed, the delimitation Bill can be passed with a simple majority, they said.

tacks on Israel on Monday, and Israel launched strikes on central and western Iran.

The semi-official *Fars* and *Mehr* news agencies said Israeli strikes hit a petrochemical factory in the city of Mahshahr. They did not elaborate on any damage.

Israel said its strikes were in response to an Iranian missile attack. Tehran warned Sunday that it would retaliate after Israel struck Beirut's southern suburbs without warning. When Israel struck back, Iran fired again.

Explosions could be heard in central Israel as air defenses sought to intercept incoming Iranian fire. Iran's paramilitary Revolutionary Guard said it had targeted two military bases in Israel. AP

New BIT model

powers of our Parliament. So, local remedies cannot be done away with by heading straight away to international arbitration. That's why we are looking at a minimum two-year timeline for local remedies within India's legal system. Also, the ongoing discussions are leaning towards no clause for ratcheting or most-favoured nation in the investment pacts. Taxation will also be kept separate from the investment pacts," the source said.

BITs are crucial for promotion and protection of investors as they pour money into each other's countries. At present, the government follows the BIT model approved in December 2015 and adopted in January 2016, which mandates exhaustion of domestic remedies prior to the initiation of international arbitration proceedings.

Asked if the local remedies clause, which did not exist in the country's pre-2016 BIT model, creates a hurdle for investors, the source said India has pushed for dedicated commercial courts — and that route has to be explored before international arbitration, which doesn't have fair representation from all countries and can lead to discretionary decisions.

The changes in the erstwhile 1993 BIT were also prompted by several international arbitration proceedings by global majors such as Vodafone and Cairn against the Government in different tax disputes. The Budget for 2025-26 had announced the revamping of the 2016 model to make it more investor-friendly and attract sustained foreign investment.

In February 2025, speaking at the International Commercial & Investment Treaty Arbitration in Delhi, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that BIT should be handled separately and negotiated standalone from the free trade agreements by specialists with expertise in elements of policy making such as taxation.

Sitharaman had underlined that before taking up international arbitration, enough time should be given to the contesting parties to go through the available local remedies because that is important for the host country.

On May 21 this year, senior economist Surjit Bhalla in his column for *The Indian Express* wrote that the "most damaging provision" in India's BIT was the requirement that "foreign investors exhaust local remedies for five years before accessing international arbitration".

"Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced in Parliament in February 2025 that the BIT framework would be reviewed and a new version released. The reform release is still awaited. Speculation is that the fundamental architecture has not changed — except that the five-year waiting period has been shortened to 'just' three years. And the requirement to exhaust Indian courts first — the

defining departure from pre-2015 BIT norms — is likely being retained," he wrote.

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran had replied to Bhalla's piece with a column of his own on May 23 in this newspaper, stating that academic record has found weak or no effects of BITs on FDI inflows. "...a study examining India — Singh, Shreeti, and Urdhwaresh (2022), published in the *Indian Economic Review* — found that individual BIT signings do not influence FDI inflows; what matters is the cumulative stock of treaties, which signals an overall regime of investor protection," the CEA had stated.

He also noted that the investment climate requires continuous improvement, and the BIT framework revision is incomplete.

Bhalla wrote again on June 2, comparing the situation with Indonesia's decision to scrap its existing BITs in 2014 and restarting with a new model. He mentioned Indonesia having won cases against foreign mining companies and signing two new BITs, one of them with Singapore: a cooling-off period of just 12 months, followed by a three-judge panel and a presiding judge agreed upon by both, who must not be a national of either country.

"In contrast to Indonesia's requirement of a 12-month cooling period, the Indian BIT required 60 months. Sixty months in Indian courts before any international arbitration could begin. This was not a reform — it was retrenchment," Bhalla wrote.

Officials said many countries like Australia have moved away from the traditional model of arbitration of Investor-State Dispute Settlement (ISDS). For instance, in the Australia-UAE investment treaty the countries moved to the dispute settlement mechanism of State-to-State Dispute Settlement (SSDS) instead of ISDS.

Before the 2016 model, India had signed bilateral investment treaties with 83 countries based on the model BIT of 1993, and as amended in 2003. Out of these, 74 were ratified. Among these 74 bilateral investment treaties, notice of termination was issued to 68 countries with request to renegotiate based on the 2016 model, according to Government data shared in Parliament in March 2023.

Since the revised 2016 model, India has signed BITs with Belarus, Kyrgyz Republic, Investment Cooperation and Facilitation Treaty (ICFT) with Brazil, UAE and Uzbekistan, a Lok Sabha reply from April 2025 showed. In the BIT with the UAE, the window for exhaustion of local remedies was reduced to three years from five years. A Bilateral Investment Agreement has also been signed between India Taipei Association and Taipei Economic and Cultural Centre, it said.

Police identified the deceased as G V Apparao, Prabhaakar, Bheem Kumar, Krishna Nag, Gold Kumar, Trinadh, Appala Raju, and Ramana. Five of them were employees of the plant, and three were contract labourers, officials said.

RINL has initiated an investigation to ascertain the cause of the incident, the Steel Ministry said. A three-member external enquiry committee, headed by the Director-in-Charge, Bokaro Steel Plant, Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL), has also been constituted to conduct an independent inquiry.

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu expressed shock and grief at the incident. The CM spoke with the District Collector and Police Commissioner, and directed them to provide help for the families of affected persons. Officials briefed the CM on the ongoing situation and relief operations.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed his sadness at the loss of lives and announced Rs 2 lakh ex gratia to the families of the deceased and Rs 50,000 to the injured. "Saddened by the mishap at the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant. Condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Praying that the injured recover at the earliest. The local authorities are providing all possible assistance to those affected. An ex gratia of Rs 2 lakh from PMNRF would be given to the next of kin of each deceased. The injured will be given Rs 50,000," the Prime Minister's Office quoted the PM as saying.

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उत्तराखण्ड शासन

उत्तराखण्ड
गौरव, विकास और संकल्प का पर्व



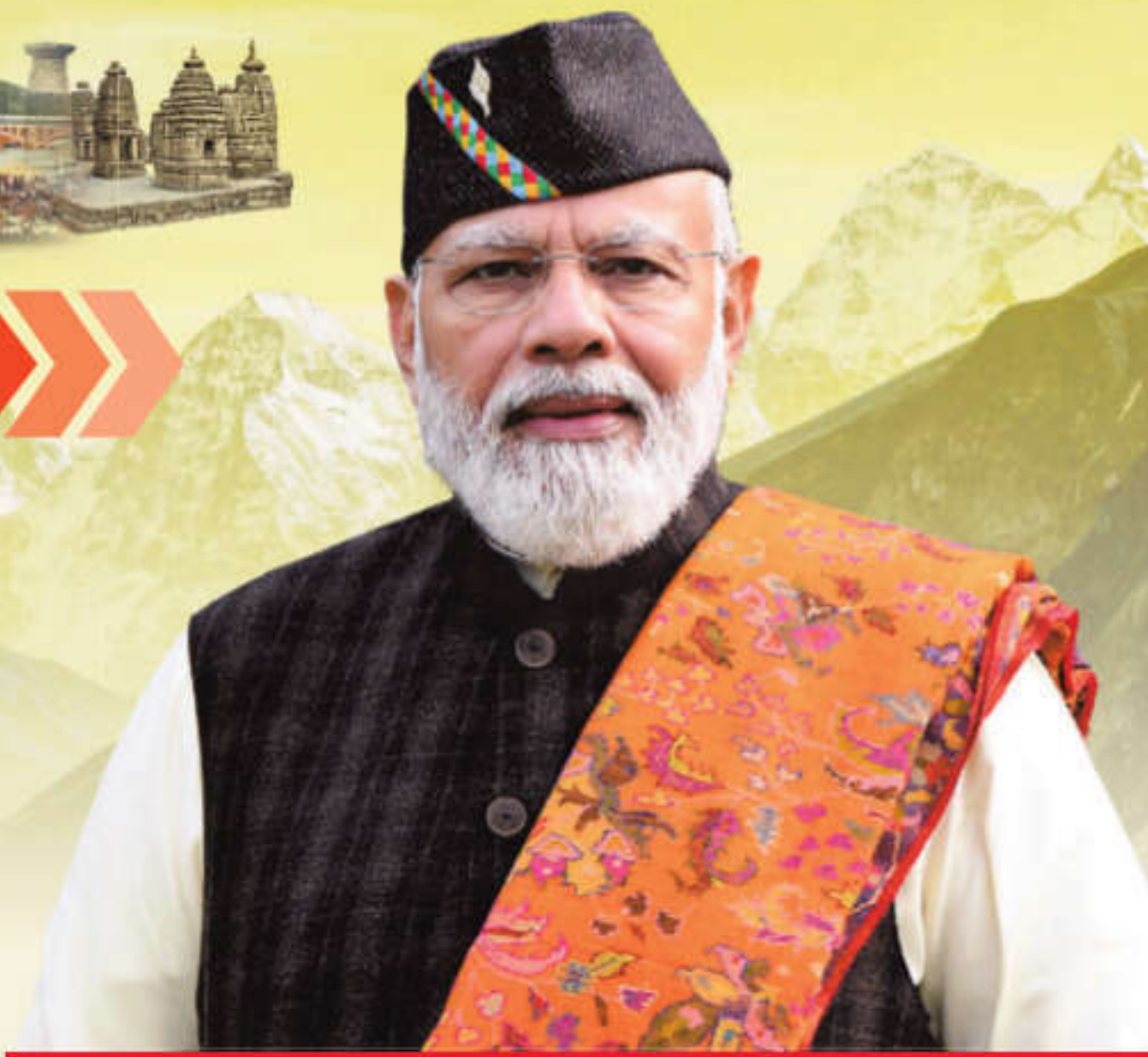
12 साल विश्वास के, विकास के, जनकल्याण के



पुष्कर सिंह धामी
मुख्यमंत्री, उत्तराखण्ड

गर्वित भारत
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सांस्कृतिक पुनर्जागरण की गाथा



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

“माननीय प्रधानमंत्री जी ने 21वीं सदी के तीसरे दशक को उत्तराखण्ड का दशक कहा है। हम प्रधानमंत्री जी के विजन के अनुरूप राज्य को हर क्षेत्र में आदर्श राज्य बनाने के लिये विकल्प रहित संकल्प के साथ काम कर रहे हैं।”

“राष्ट्रीय एकता हो या फिर नागरिक कर्तव्य बोध, इसमें भी हमारी ये सांस्कृतिक विरासत कड़ी का काम करती है। यही वो मजबूत कड़ी है, जो देश को ही नहीं, बल्कि पूरी दुनिया को भी भारत से जोड़ती है।”

अमृत काल के पंच प्रण

विकसित
भारत

गुलामी की
मानसिकता
से मुक्ति

विरासत
पर गर्व

एकता

नागरिक
कर्तव्य

- गौरीकुण्ड से केदारनाथ एवं गोविन्दघाट से हेमकुण्ड साहिब तक रोपवे निर्माण कार्य का हुआ शिलान्यास।
- सोनप्रयाग से केदारनाथ तक 12.9 किलोमीटर रोपवे का 4081 करोड़ की लागत एवं गोविंद घाट से हेमकुंड साहिब तक 12.4 किलोमीटर रोपवे का 2730 करोड़ रुपये की लागत से होगा निर्माण।
- केदारनाथ और बदरीनाथ धाम में मास्टर प्लान के तहत कार्य गतिमान।
- बद्रीनाथ धाम को स्मार्ट आध्यात्मिक पहाड़ी कस्बे के रूप में विकसित करने हेतु ₹ 255 करोड़ की विकास योजनाओं का कार्य गतिमान है।
- ₹ 12,000 करोड़ से अधिक की लागत से चार धाम को जोड़ा गया ऑल वेदर सड़क से, जिससे पहाड़ों का सफर हुआ सुगम।
- हरिपुर कालसी में यमुना तीर्थ स्थल का भव्य निर्माण कार्य जारी।
- महासू मंदिर, हनोल के मास्टर प्लान को दी गई मंजूरी।
- राज्य में पहली बार शीतकालीन यात्रा का हुआ शुभारंभ।
- शीतकालीन यात्रा को बढ़ावा देने माँ गंगा के शीतकालीन निवास स्थल मुखवा पहुंचे प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेंद्र मोदी।

आस्था का पुनर्जागरण

श्री राम मन्दिर, अयोध्या, महाकाल महालोक, काशी विश्वनाथ धाम, केदारनाथ धाम, बदरीनाथ धाम का दिव्य एवं भव्य पुनर्विकास।

अंतरराष्ट्रीय योग दिवस

प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी के प्रस्ताव पर संयुक्त राष्ट्र द्वारा वर्ष 2014 में 21 जून को अंतरराष्ट्रीय योग दिवस के रूप में मान्यता।

प्रसाद योजना के तहत तीर्थ स्थलों का विकास और संरक्षण

आध्यात्मिक पर्यटन से अर्थव्यवस्था को मजबूती

- राज्य के 13 जिलों में 13 आदर्श संस्कृत ग्रामों का हुआ शुभारंभ। राज्य में संस्कृत भाषा को बढ़ावा देने के लिये शुरू की गई पहल।
- दून विश्वविद्यालय में सेंटर फॉर हिन्दू स्टडीज केन्द्र की स्थापना की गई है। इसमें हिन्दू सभ्यता और संस्कृति से जुड़े विभिन्न पहलुओं पर शिक्षण और शोध कार्य हो सकेंगे।
- स्कूलों के पाठ्यक्रम में शामिल होगा श्रीमद् भागवत गीता का अध्ययन
- कैची धाम बाईपास का निर्माण कार्य गतिमान
- प्रदेश में आयुर्वेदिक एवं प्राकृतिक चिकित्सा, योग और आध्यात्मिक पर्यटन को बढ़ावा देने के लिए गढ़वाल और कुमाऊं मंडलों में एक एक स्पिरिटुअल इकोनॉमिक जोन की होगी स्थापना।
- उत्तराखण्ड में कुंभ मेला 2027 की तैयारियों के लिए केंद्र सरकार द्वारा 500 करोड़ रुपये की धनराशि जारी
- कुमाऊं क्षेत्र में मानसखण्ड मंदिर माला मिशन के अन्तर्गत 48 मन्दिरों तथा गुरुद्वारों को सर्किट के रूप में जोड़ने का कार्य गतिमान।
- उत्तराखण्ड के जखोल, सूपी, हर्षिल और गुंजी गांवों को भारत सरकार द्वारा सर्वश्रेष्ठ पर्यटन ग्राम के रूप में पुरस्कृत किया गया।

विकास भी
विरासत भी



संकल्प से
शिखर तक

LG CHAIRS DELHI DISASTER MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY MEETING AFTER BUILDING COLLAPSE IN SAIDULAJAB, B&B BLAZE AT MALVIYA NAGAR



The Last Memory

Prem Bansal, who lost his daughter, son-in-law and two granddaughters in the fire at Flourish Stays B&B in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar, arrives at the site on Monday to collect belongings of the deceased. The blaze killed four more members of Bansal's son-in-law's family. SHREYA SINGHAI

Man in whose name B&B is registered surrenders in court

Police ask IIT-D to study spread of fire

Nirbhay Thakur & Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 8

JAY MISHRA, the close associate and accountant of Lavkesh Bajaj, the owner of Flourish Stays B&B in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar, where 22 people died in a fire last week, surrendered before a Delhi court on Monday. He was later sent to two-day police custody.

The day also saw the Delhi Police writing to IIT Delhi to conduct a study of the fire at the B&B to determine structural shortcomings of the building and ascertain how the blaze spread through the premises in such a short time.

"The study is required to understand the structure of the building, which was constructed without an approved map or permission. It will also ascertain the exact reason for the rapid spread of the fire throughout the building following a small blaze in an air fryer in the kitchen on the ground floor," a source said.

The source added that the exercise could involve a form of 3D mapping, which would help investigators determine the building's structure despite extensive fire damage and identify the factors that contributed to the spread of the blaze. The findings will aid the investigation and may also be included in the chargesheet filed before the court.

According to another source, the study could also provide information about objects and obstacles present in various rooms during the fire.

The study will help map burn patterns, collapsed structures, stairways, windows, electrical wiring, gas cylinders, and



Outside the building that caught fire. FILE

AC or gas pipelines, making it easier to reconstruct the progression of the fire.

Meanwhile, police submitted before the court that the registration certificate of the B&B had been obtained in the name of Mishra, who was actively associated with the affairs and functioning of the B&B.

The police said they needed Mishra's custody to confront him with Bajaj regarding the procurement and use of the "certificate and the actual management and operation of the establishment". They further submitted that they needed to "ascertain the complete circumstances under which the registration/license was obtained in his name and the documents submitted before the concerned authorities".

Also, police said, they wanted to recover relevant documents, records, electronic device, digital communication and other evidence related to the registration and operation of the establishment.

The court, meanwhile, dismissed the bail plea of Keshav Negi, a cook at the B&B who had been arrested in the case.

Delhi HC orders removal of videos blaming judge for building collapse

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 8

THE DELHI High Court Monday directed social media platforms to block a user and take down posts and videos that allegedly contained contemptuous remarks against a sitting HC judge. The user had accused the judge of colluding with the civic body, which the contemnor alleged was responsible for the deaths of six people in a building collapse in Saket on May 30.

A criminal contempt petition was filed by the Delhi High Court Bar Association (DHCBA) flagging posts by Dr Kapil Kakar and a social media handle named 'Black Justice-Web Series', uploaded on June 2. The posts had allegedly accused the sitting HC judge as being responsible for the lives lost in the building collapse and colluding with corporates as well as civic bodies.

Senior advocate N Hariharan, appearing for the DHCBA, impressed before the bench of Justices Neena Bansal Krishna and Madhu Jain, "There are two videos...it is absolutely contumacious. With every video being posted, it's increasing in degree... (in the allegations being made against the sitting judge of HC)."

Social media intermediaries, including Meta, told the court that "as lawyers, we cannot tolerate this kind of content", and it will take down the videos.

Justice Krishna orally remarked, "What has happened is, the media has become all powerful... (there is responsibility) on these platforms also. Once you get to know about something so absurd, why don't you suo motu remove it? Is there any embargo? Because this is happening daily, not everyone can afford to come to court."

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 8

LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday suggested that former Agniveers — Army personnel retired after four years of service — could be inducted to meet the manpower shortage faced by the Delhi Fire Service (DFS) and increase the number of fire stations across the city to improve emergency response time.

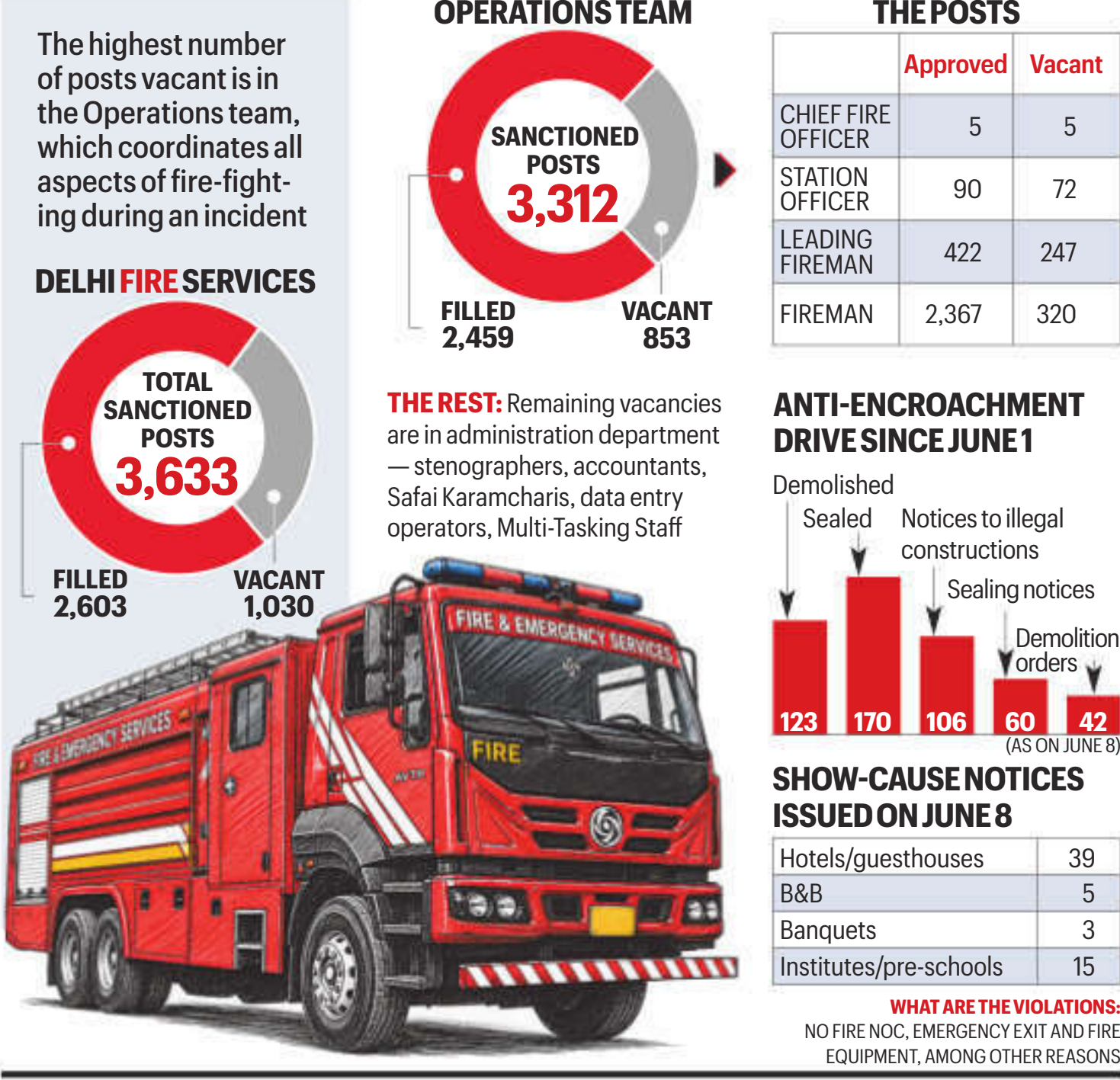
The directions were given at a high-level meeting of the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA) chaired by the LG. The meeting was attended by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and her ministers, Ashish Sood and Parvesh Sahib Singh.

The meeting — which comes days after a blaze at a B&B in Malviya Nagar claimed 22 lives and a building collapse near Saket Metro station killed six — undertook a comprehensive review of ongoing anti-encroachment drive against illegal buildings, misuse of licences related to fire safety and future disaster preparedness.

As per Central government directions, 10% of vacant posts in the CISF, BSF and RPF are to be filled with ex-Agniveers. "In DFS, recruitment is done through both UPSC and at state government level. When the recruitment process will start, 10% of the vacancy will be filled with ex-Agniveers, especially the posts of firemen," a senior Delhi government official said. According to official data, while the DFS has 3,633 sanctioned posts, 1,030 of them are vacant. (See box)

"While some posts were filled a few years ago, major requirements were last under-

• STAFF CRUNCH AT DELHI FIRE SERVICES



taken 15 years ago. The highest number of posts vacant is in the Operations team, which is a key part of the Fire department. They coordinate everything — from receiving calls, informing concerned teams and sending fire tenders and fire-fighters on ground... The huge gap in manpower is a major problem the DFS has been facing for years now," said an official.

Another official said that

the department is managing with contractual staff. As on date, there are 412 contractual employees, of which 318 are fire operators. "Direct recruitment for the post of station officers took place in 2011-12 through UPSC. At present, of the 90 sanctioned posts, only 18 are filled... Also, all five sanctioned posts of Chief Fire Officer are lying vacant," said the official.

According to Home depart-

ment officials, there are 71 fire stations in the Capital.

The LG, meanwhile, pulled up the Fire department for not issuing even a single show cause notice until now in relation to structures not having fire NOC (no objection certificate) and fire-fighting equipment, among others.

Expressing displeasure, he directed the Principal Director (DFS) to immediately take

MCD was aware of illegal construction underway at Saidulajab building, took no concrete action, SC told

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, June 8

A STATUS report submitted to the Supreme Court has slammed the MCD for failing to act on time to stop the construction of the allegedly illegal building which collapsed in Saidulajab on May 30 killing six.

In his report, senior advocate Ajit Kumar Sinha, who is assisting as amicus curiae in a matter related to illegal constructions, said that though MCD was aware of the unauthorised construction, underway since 2015, "no concrete action was ever taken by the corporation". It added: "The corporation failed to discharge its statutory obligations despite repeated notice of the violations, also failed to seal the premises and take consequential action(s) when fourth and fifth floors were being constructed recently."

The report filed through Advocate Gopal Jee also said that "the said illegal construction activities were in gross violation of" the "Delhi Municipal

Corporation Act, 1957 as well as ...the Unified Building Bye Laws 2016".

The amicus urged the court to ask MCD "to file an affidavit indicating survey conducted and action taken against illegal and unauthorised constructions as well as cases concerning unauthorised use of residential premises of all properties located within the precincts" of the corporation.

He also urged SC to ask MCD to conduct structural audit of all its premises located within the precincts "and carry out sealing as well as demolition of the illegal structure(s) in a time-bound manner".

Further, the amicus requested the court to direct the MCD "to furnish a detailed affidavit indicating the manner in which illegal construction of five-storied building (which collapsed)... was permitted to continue and action taken against erring officials" and to ask the government and the Delhi Police to furnish an action taken report.



The site where the building collapsed. FILE

The report pointed out that in 2020, a petition was filed before the Delhi High Court that alleged that the "SDMC (South Delhi Municipal Corporation) had proposed to demolish the structure without prior notice and without hearing the owner of the said illegal premise".

On December 8, 2020, the HC had disposed it of asking the civic body to hear the petitioner within two weeks.

Soon after, another petition was filed alleging inaction by MCD regarding the "unauth-

orised construction". This was disposed of on December 22, 2020, with the MCD stating that the two weeks' time granted in the first matter was not over yet. The court also directed the MCD to give a hearing to the second petitioner and take appropriate action in case any unauthorised construction is noticed at the site.

The report said that the "gross violation and illegal construction which went on since 2015, ultimately led to the horrific and unfortunate incident

where innocent students and residents of the locality lost their lives whereas the beneficiary of said illegal structures as well as officers who failed to discharge their statutory obligations are still enjoying the benefits derived from the unauthorised construction and by letting the illegality continue in perpetuity."

"Such illegal construction cannot perpetuate since 2015 unless the concerned officers who were entrusted with the duty to protect citizens, turned a blind eye more so when the issue of unauthorised construction went up to the High Court...", it added.

It added that "after the tragic incident, the Municipal Corporation as a mere eyewash and (what) appears to be a post-facto and cosmetic exercise... suspended one Sudesh Singh Chouhan, Assistant Engineer, Building Department, and one Aman Jain, Junior Engineer, for dereliction of duties and slackness on their part in discharging official function".

• CBI PROBE EXPOSED A SPRAWLING SYNDICATE THAT LAUNDERED FUNDS THROUGH FAKE FIRMS, MADE INTERNATIONAL CASH WITHDRAWALS VIA PROXY SERVERS

One account, 106 complaints: Cyber fraud costs man Rs 50 L

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, June 8

FOR FOUR grueling days, Anshu Mittal's life was reduced to the glowing lens of his computer camera. As the Managing Director of a manufacturing firm running out of New Delhi and Faridabad, he was used to high-stakes corporate decisions.

But nothing could have prepared him for the trauma that began with a seemingly routine phone call on December 29, 2023, and ended with him being extorted out of Rs 48.56 lakh.

He had become the victim of a "digital arrest" scam allegedly being run by an elaborate cyber fraud network spanning India and abroad, as per the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) which filed a comprehensive chargesheet in the matter in December 2025.

As per the CBI probe, Mittal's nightmare started when a caller introduced himself as a representative from FedEx Courier and delivered a shock-

ing piece of news: his Aadhaar card had allegedly been linked to a confiscated parcel containing illegal items. The caller then offered to connect him with law enforcement to clear his name.

Mittal was moved to a Skype call. On his screen, men posing as officers from the Mumbai Cyber Crime Branch took over. According to the CBI, the fraudsters accused Mittal of being entangled in a massive web of drug trafficking and money laundering. Under the pretext of a sensitive, ongoing investigation, they ordered him into a "digital arrest".

For the next four days, the probe showed, Mittal was kept under constant digital confinement, with the scammers issuing threats of physical arrest and legal ruin if he disconnected or spoke to anyone.

Officials said Mittal complied with their demands, transferring Rs 48.56 lakh across multiple bank accounts specified by his captors.

Once the money hit the ac-

• THE MODUS OPERANDI

● Began with someone calling Anshu Mittal and introducing himself as a representative from FedEx Courier

● Caller alleged that Mittal's Aadhaar card had been linked to a confiscated parcel containing illegal items.

● Mittal was moved to a Skype call, where men posing as Mumbai Cyber Crime Branch officers took over.

counts, it was rapidly siphoned out of the banking system within 48 hours. The CBI discovered in its investigation that the syndicate managed to withdraw approximately Rs 41 lakh via ATMs, cash withdrawals, and cheque clearances within India, while another Rs 6 lakh was pulled out simultaneously from ATMs in Dubai.

However, the fraudsters left behind digital breadcrumbs.

● They accused Mittal of involvement in drug trafficking and money laundering. Soon, they ordered him into a "digital arrest".

● For the next four days, Mittal was kept under constant digital confinement, with the scammers issuing threats if he disconnected or spoke to anyone.

● Mittal transferred Rs 48.56 lakh across multiple accounts specified by captors.

CBI officers focused on a bank account under the name of M/s Sabir Enterprises — the primary mule account into which Mittal had been induced to send the money.

As per probe details, an analysis of IP logs for this account revealed that its internet banking facility was accessed on December 29 and 30, 2023. From December 30, 2023, to January 1, 2024, the handlers

switched to international proxy servers to hide their location while routing the stolen funds, the probe found.

The CBI traced these digital footprints back to an Indian mobile number registered to the primary accused, Raju Kumar Manjhi. As per the CBI, Manjhi had accessed the Sabir Enterprises bank account via internet banking facility just two days before Mittal was targeted.

As per the probe, an analysis of mobile data uncovered coordinated travel patterns between Kolkata and Gurgaon by Manjhi and his accomplices during the crime period. Police said Manjhi, who lived in Gurgaon, was ordered to be taken into judicial custody last month. His bail plea was rejected on May 29.

The CBI, during its probe, found that the account for M/s Sabir Enterprises had registered transactions worth Rs 2.39 crore on January 1, 2024.

This single account has been flagged in 106 separate cyber-

fraud complaints across India. While police across the country registered 10 FIRs representing 10 victims of this syndicate, those complaints have now been clubbed into a single FIR.

On December 8 last year, the CBI, represented by Public Prosecutors Saloni and Anoop Kumar, filed its first chargesheet in this multi-crore scam before Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Jyoti Maheshwari of Rouse Avenue Court.

The chargesheet names 33 accused so far, including the proprietors of dummy firms used to receive the cheated money, technical handlers who accessed the accounts to siphon the cash, and the mules who routed the funds. Disclosure statements from 10 arrested also led the CBI to a WhatsApp group named "Work 24*7". The group was allegedly run by cybercriminals and had incriminating chats on the routine purchase and sale of fraudulent bank accounts, the probe showed. But Mittal's stolen money is yet to be recovered.

• Skywatch



Forecast:
June 9, 2026

Partly cloudy sky, sustained surface winds during day

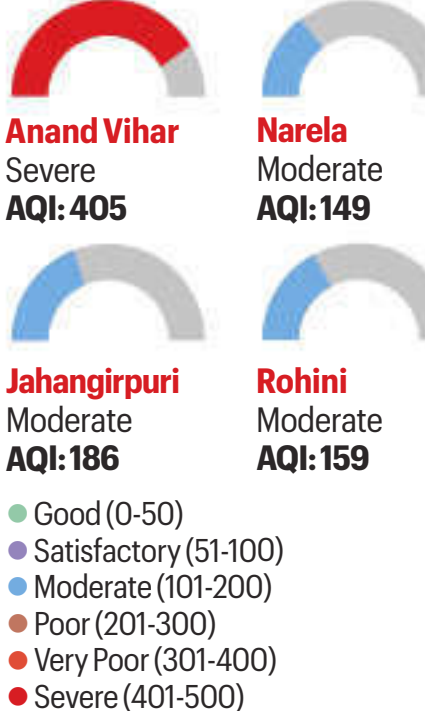
MAX: 42-44

4°C above normal

MIN: 28-30

0.4°C above normal

• AQI Tracker



PRODUCTION BELOW NORMAL: DJB Yamuna level low, water woes to go on despite increase in supply from Haryana



People gather to fill containers from a water tanker at Rajasthani Colony in New Delhi on Monday, ANI

Worst hit are large parts of North, Central and New Delhi

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, June 8

A WATER crisis is likely to persist in the Capital despite a recent push in the amount of raw water received from Haryana, with Delhi Jal Board (DJB) officials saying that production is still below normal due to low levels in the Yamuna.

According to senior DJB officials, Delhi's water treatment plants are currently producing around 945 million gallons per day (MGD), up from about 890 MGD after Haryana released additional water through the Munak canal system. However, the production remains well below the city's summer requirement of over 1,200 MGD.

To manage the shortfall, the DJB has rationalised supply in several areas by extending water supply hours in the morning, while curtailing evening distribution in water-deficit localities.

"There is shortage of supply from the Yamuna," a senior DJB official said, adding that the situation will not normalise unless the water level of the river rises. The official also said that the situation is expected to improve over the next couple of days as the impact of the additional release is felt across the system.

The ongoing shortage, officials said, is linked to reduced flows in the Yamuna, which have constrained raw water availability for key treatment plants, particularly Wazirabad and Chandrawal.

Last month, the Delhi government approached Haryana seeking additional water after water levels at the Wazirabad pond — the key reservoir which stores Yamuna water before it is treated and distributed — fell significantly below the level required for normal operations.

Following the request, Haryana increased supplies through the Carrier Lined Channel and Delhi Sub Branch systems, which feed Delhi's Munak canal network.

The additional water helped improve overall production, though officials said it has not been sufficient to fully bridge the gap between supply and demand.

Meanwhile, another senior DJB official said that the shortage has particularly affected tail-end localities under the command areas of the Wazirabad and Chandrawal water treatment plants, where residents have reported low water pressure and irregular supply over the past several days.

Experts say that such conditions can also heighten concerns over water quality. Low-pressure supply systems are more vulnerable to contamination, particularly in areas served by ageing pipelines.

The Delhi government had previously estimated that nearly 40% of the city's water is lost through leakages and distribution inefficiencies, prompting plans for large-scale upgrades of the network under a proposed Water Master Plan which is in the works, according to PWD officials.

Delhi's average water demand rises sharply during the summer months, touching around 1,200-1,250 MGD, while production depends heavily on supplies received from neighbouring states through the Yamuna, Bhakra and Munak systems.

CENTRE'S PLAN TO TAKE OVER JAIPUR POLO GROUND

Delhi will choke... small (green) lung we have, you want to take it away: HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 8

WITH THE Centre deciding to takeover the Jaipur Polo Ground for "redevelopment of the area", along with the land where other legacy institutions such as Delhi Gymkhana Club and Delhi Race Club are situated, the Delhi High Court on Monday orally expressed concern that "Delhi will choke" if these structures, the green lungs of the Capital, cease to exist.

Justice Neena Bansal Krishna orally told to the Central government counsel, "Delhi people please go to some chhoti mota mountain and please stay there, Delhi will not be fit for any one of us. You already know how much we are choking because of the pollution. The small (green) lung that we have, you want to take that away also. Take it away, ensure that people stop coming to Delhi."

"Is it for public purposes? Making high rises, is it in the public interest? We don't know. We have only high rises in



A polo game at Jaipur Polo Ground in New Delhi. FILE

Delhi, all over. In NDMC, colonies which had two-storeyed houses, now have 20-storeyed houses. Every colony has been demolished, and if this is how you want Delhi to live, then God save us all," she added.

As the government standing counsel Ashish Dixit said that with the city growing, people have to be accommodated, Justice Krishna remarked, "We are equally helpless. Whatever you do, you are the might. But the thing is, Delhi will choke."

The remarks came in a fresh petition moved by the Indian Polo Association (IPA), seeking urgent protection against coercive eviction following an eviction order issued by the Centre on May 20 under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, ordering that the premises be vacated within two weeks, by June 4.

Subsequently, IPA filed an appeal before the appellate authority challenging the eviction order on May 30. On June

3, while notice was issued by the appellate authority, no interim stay on the eviction was granted, leading IPA to move the HC.

Jaipur Polo Ground, spread over 15.20 acres of land in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi, IPA claims, is the association's "principal and only operational polo venue" in the country.

Justice Krishna directed that IPA's application filed before the appellate authority at Patiala House district court be listed on June 10 and recorded the Centre's assurance that the authorities will not execute its eviction order until June 12.

The court directed the district court to decide the stay application filed along with IPA's appeal "forthwith". "No execution (of the eviction order) has been filed and there are no imminent execution of the eviction order contemplated till Friday, as submitted by the counsel (Ashish Dixit)," it recorded.

The court, however, orally inquired from Dixit why the government wants back possession of the Jaipur Polo

HC issues notice to CBSE, Centre over NSUI petition on OSM system

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 8

THE DELHI High Court Monday issued notice to Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) and the Centre seeking their response to a public interest litigation by the National Students' Union of India (NSUI) calling for an independent probe into alleged "large-scale irregularities, deficiencies, technical issues and grievance-related failures" concerning the On-Screen Marking (OSM) system."

The CBSE, through its counsel MA Niyazi, opposed the PIL on its maintainability, with the counsel saying, "It is a student wing of a political party. We do not want education to be politicised like this."

A division bench of Justices Neena Bansal Krishna and Madhu Jain, however, issued the notice to the respondents.

The court will hear the matter next on June 12.

Congress' student wing claimed large-scale deficiencies in evaluation led to lower pass percentages. Court will hear the matter next on June 12

The PIL, filed on May 29, seeks the court's direction to permit manual rechecking and physical verification of answer sheets in cases where students dispute the correctness of the scanned copies or the evaluation process.

It also seeks the court's direction to keep the portal open for verification and re-evaluation of answer sheets for affected students for one month.

Niyazi countered that the portal cannot be kept open "indefinitely" and said that students' grievances are being

addressed.

The NSUI has submitted that "students cannot be made to suffer because of deficiencies in a system introduced by the authorities themselves".

Citing a decline in pass percentage of Class 12 students, the Congress' student wing has submitted in its plea that the "significant fall in performance assumes relevance because the present examination cycle was amongst the first large-scale implementations of the On-Screen Marking system and was followed by unprecedented concerns regarding evaluation accuracy, scanned answer books, portal glitches and verification-related grievances raised by students across the country."

"The said decline, viewed alongside the subsequent events and complaints, raises serious issues warranting examination and independent scrutiny by this Hon'ble Court," the NSUI has asserted.

DU ASSISTANT PROFESSOR MURDER

Bengal man likely involved in multiple cases of cheating: Police

Pragynesh
New Delhi, June 8

FAKE BADGES of West Bengal Police, forged railway ticket examiner (TTE) name pins and more than 25 watches were among the items recovered from the home of a couple from Bengal, who have been accused of murdering their landlord — a DU assistant professor who lived in East Delhi.

The recovery has led police to suspect that the man has been involved in multiple cases of cheating and forgery and managed to not get caught, an officer said. "He would use forged ID cards, West Bengal Police badges, and name pins of TTE to dupe people," the officer said.

According to the police, he had travelled to Delhi at least twice in the last two months and conducted reconnaissance around the residence of deceased Debosmita Paul before the murder. "Multiple pictures



Debosmita Paul

of the building and the car of the deceased were found on his phone," the officer said.

The 42-year-old man, his wife and their 13-year-old son allegedly travelled nearly 1,400 km from West Bengal to Delhi and murdered Paul. They wore surgical masks while entering her complex and, after allegedly committing the murder, fled to the railway station to board a train to Bengal.

Paul, who lived alone in her flat at Satyam Apartment in Va-

Assembly to get a watchtower after security breach and bomb threats

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 8

AFTER A security breach and multiple hoax bomb emails, the Delhi government is planning to construct a watchtower and a dedicated patrolling track along the boundary wall of the Vidhan Sabha premises in Civil Lines, said officials.

This comes in the wake of an incident in April in which a man in a white SUV barreled into the Assembly complex by ramming into Gate No. 2 — a VIP entry point — and evading security personnel. After reaching the premises, the man behind the wheel, Sarabjit Singh, placed a bouquet on Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta's official vehicle before fleeing.

According to officials, the Public Works Department (PWD) will execute the work. "It has floated a tender for the construction of a watchtower and a patrolling track to improve surveillance and response capabilities within the Assembly premises," said a senior official.

The project is estimated to cost Rs 94 lakh and is expected to be completed within two months of the award of work.

sundhara Enclave, was found dead on Thursday. She had been attacked with a blunt object, and there were cuts on her wrists.

During questioning, the accused allegedly revealed that a property dispute with Paul had led them to murder her. According to police, Paul's family owns property worth crores in Bardhaman, one of which was occupied by the accused as tenants. They have claimed that they paid her a monthly rent of Rs 11,500, and had spent around Rs 1.5 lakh on repairs at the property. The accused also operated a profitable sanitary goods shop from the premises, police said.

The couple had allegedly urged Paul to sell the property to them, but she refused. "He initially wanted to buy the house, but was ready to eventually settle on a rental agreement. But he was still asked to vacate the house in June. He murdered her just when he was about to be evicted," the senior officer said.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform and seek objections, if any from general public that our Client proposes to take on long-term lease basis the property more particularly described hereinafter ("Leased Property"), presently owned by SDS InfraTech Private Limited, having its registered office at Bhagwati Business Centre, S-561, School Block-II, Shakarpur, Delhi — 110092.

It is further understood that the said Leased Property is presently proposed to be transferred by way of Tripartite Sub Lease Deed in favour of Sikka Projects Private Limited, having its registered office at Sikka House, C-60, Preet Vihar, Vikas Marg, Delhi — 110092 ("Proposed Transferee/Lessor"), and upon consummation of the said transfer and vesting of title, our Client proposes to enter into a long-term lease transaction with the said Proposed Transferee/Lessor.

The Leased Property being all that premises comprising of (i) Ground Floor measuring 9345.87 sq. ft. (covered area) (ii) First Floor measuring 9864.69 sq. ft. (covered area) and (iii) Second Floor measuring 9496.13 sq. ft. (covered area) aggregating to 28,706.69 sq. ft. (covered area) in the building known as "The Mail of Expressway" constructed on all that land bearing Plot numbered as Builders Residential Plot No. GH-01 measuring 44,556 sq. mtrs, situated in Sector Omega II, near Pari Chowk, Gautam Budh Nagar, Greater Noida, Tehsil Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Pincode: 201308 ("Plot") alongwith (i) the right to exclusively use the (a) Loading and Unloading Area (b) Hoarding and Signages (c) Exclusive Lifts (d) Exclusive Parking Spaces for parking of bikes and cars in the Basement (e) Exclusive OBU Space and DG Space (f) Exclusive Staircase (g) Exclusive Area (h) Exclusive Drivers Toilet (i) Exclusive Scrap Room with canopy (j) Exclusive Bin wash area (k) Exclusive MS canopy (l) Exclusive OTLA with hydraulic platform (m) Exclusive Exit with Proposed platform in RCC and (n) Exclusive Locker room and other exclusive areas and (ii) rights to use in common with other occupants of the Building (a) Common Lift (b) Common Parking Spaces in the Basement (c) Common Driveway (d) Common Corridor (e) Common Entry/Exit Points (f) Common Escalator (g) Common Staircases (h) Common Ramps and (i) Common Toilets and other common areas and amenities. The Plot is butted and bounded by, On or towards North by Noida-Greater Noida Highway, On or towards South by SDS EWS Block Building, On or towards East by SDS Commercial Block and On or towards West by Omxare Arcade Commercial Block.

If any person(s) or any legal entity(ies) including any Government / Public Department, Bank or Financial Institution, etc., is having or claiming to have any form of share, right, title, claim, benefit, demand or interest in the Plot and/or Leased Property or any part thereof, of any nature whatsoever and/or any claim by way of, under, or in the nature of any agreement, sale, transfer, exchange, assignment, family arrangement, settlement, Will, release, relinquishment, decree or order of any Court of Law, partnership, acquisition by the government or any entity, prohibition or any impediment, encumbrance, mortgage, lease, sub-lease, exchange, lien, charge, outgoing, license, gift, inheritance, undivided share, trust, possession, development rights, right of way, easement, trust, best, lease, tenancy, sub-tenancy, leave and license, lis pendens, maintenance, easement, options, reservation, covenant or condition, occupation, right of first refusal or pre-emption or encumbrance of whatsoever nature or otherwise howsoever, or under any agreement, deed, document, or power of attorney or any objection(s) of any manner whatsoever is hereby required to inform the same in writing with notarized/certified true copies of documentary proof in support thereof, to the undersigned at their under mentioned address within 14 (fourteen) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it will be presumed that the title of the Plot and/or Leased Property is clear, valid and marketable and no one has any rights/ title/ interest/ claim/ demand whatsoever on the Plot and/or Leased Property. Any claims without supporting documents will not be entertained.

Please mark your envelope with the superscription [CN-NOIDA].

Dated: 9th June 2026

LXNEGOTIUM Advocates
Attn: Vikas Pant, Principal Partner
3-D, Row House Surya Vihar Apartments, Dundaheera Gurgaon, 122016, Haryana
Tel: +91 124 400 8001 | +91 989911 5125

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Petition No. 214/TD/2026 Dated: 4.6.2026
**NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF
SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 (the Act)**

An application for the grant of a Category-V licence for inter-State trading in electricity across India has been made before the Commission by **PRMK Energy**, Office No. 501, 5th Floor, Sorrento Apartment, High Street, Hiranandani Gardens, Mumbai - 400076.

- A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State trading licence to **PRMK Energy** before the Commission can be accessed at the website www.prmkenery.com or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.
- On consideration of the material available on record, the Commission is satisfied that prima facie the applicant qualifies for the grant of a licence for inter-State trading in electricity and by order dated 3.6.2026, the Commission has proposed to grant a Category-V licence to the applicant for inter-State trading in electricity across India.
- Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act to invite suggestions or objections, if any, to the proposal to grant the licence for inter-State trading in electricity as aforesaid by the Commission to be received by the undersigned latest by **17.6.2026** at the above noted address. The objections or suggestions received after the specified date shall not be considered.
- The Commission has fixed the application for final disposal on **18.6.2026** and the person who files the suggestions or objections may in his discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary

**Careers**

मध्यप्रदेश अर्बन डेवलपमेंट कम्पनी लिमिटेड
(मध्यप्रदेश शासन नगरी विकास एवं आवास विभाग का उपक्रम)
**5. अमरकंटक भवन, इन्दिरा प्रेस कॉम्प्लेक्स, एम.पी. नगर
भोपाल- 462011, फ़ोन : 91-755-2763060, 61, 62
ई-मेल : mpusipbpl@gmpurban.gov.in
क्र. MPUDC/PMU/2026/2893 दिनांक : 08.06.2026**

प्रतिनियुक्ति/संविदा नियुक्ति हेतु विज्ञापन
मध्यप्रदेश अर्बन डेवलपमेंट कंपनी लिमिटेड भोपाल में निम्न पद पर प्रतिनियुक्ति अथवा संविदा से पदपूर्ति किये जाने हेतु आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं:-

क्र.	पदनाम	पद संख्या	वेतनमान
1	प्रमुख अभियंता	01	1,41,800-2,14,700

नोट :

- उपरोक्त पद की पूर्ति प्रतिनियुक्ति अथवा संविदा से की जायेगी। उक्त पद एकल होने से म.प्र. शासन के आरक्षण नियम लागू नहीं होंगे।
- प्रतिनियुक्ति हेतु इच्छुक आवेदक अर्थात् मध्यप्रदेश शासन के विभागों/भारत सरकार के विभागों में कार्यरत अधिकारी अपने आवेदन विभाग प्रमुख के माध्यम से अनापति प्रमाण पत्र एवं अन्य आवश्यक समस्त प्रमाण पत्रों सहित, निर्धारित प्रपत्र में प्रेषित कर सकेंगे।
- संविदा अवधि अधिकतम 03 वर्ष की होगी (प्रथम बार में एक वर्ष के लिए जो मूल्यांकन पश्चात दो बार एक-एक वर्ष के लिए बढ़ाई जा सकेगी) अथवा 65 वर्ष की आयु सीमा तक जो भी पहले पूर्ण हो होगी।
- सेवानिवृत्त कर्मचारियों के संबंध में सेवा निवृत्ति के समय वेतन संरचना (यथा संशोधित वेतनमान) में देय मूल वेतन एवं देय महंगाई भत्ते में से देय पेंशन (सारांशिकरण के पूर्व की) एवं उस पर देय महंगाई राहत घटाने के पश्चात भुगतान योग्य एकमुश्त राशि, संविदा वेतन होगा (पे-माइन्स पेयान)।
- संविदा नियुक्ति की दशा में आवेदक की आयु विज्ञापन प्रकाशन वर्ष की 1 जनवरी को 63 वर्ष से अधिक नहीं होना चाहिए।
- आवेदन पत्र दिनांक 07.07.2026 सायं: 5.00 बजे तक कम्पनी कार्यालय में डाक अथवा व्यक्तिगत रूप से प्रस्तुत किये जा सकते हैं। लिफाफे पर आवेदित पत्र का नाम स्पष्ट पता तथा मोबाइल नंबर अंकित करें।
- समय सीमा के पश्चात् प्राप्त आवेदनों पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा।
- न्यूनतम अनुभव संबंधी प्रमाण पत्र में योजना/परियोजना, किस पद पर एवं संपादित कार्यों का स्पष्ट विवरण होना चाहिए।
- आवेदन का प्रारूप पदों के लिये न्यूनतम/वांछनीय, शैक्षणिक योग्यता तथा सेवा शर्त अनुभव संबंधी विस्तृत विवरण, कम्पनी एवं विभाग की वेबसाइट www.mpudc.co.in एवं www.mpurban.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।
- आवेदन के संबंध में प्रबंध संचालक का निर्णय अंतिम एवं बाध्यकारी होगा।

म.प्र. माध्यम/126261/2026 **अतिरिक्त प्रबंध संचालक**

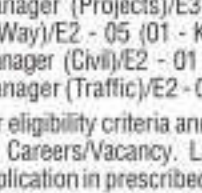
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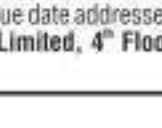
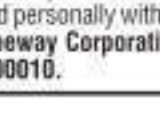
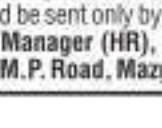
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Communication Loss On All Fronts

MANY LEADERS who were attending the INDIA bloc meeting on Monday struggled due to weak mobile network at the Constitution Club of India. Some of them were seen moving in and out of the club to improve mobile connectivity. TMC MPs Kalyan Banerjee and Dola Sen seemed the most hassled as they were surrounded by journalists every time they came out to make or receive a phone call. The reason the journalists were rushing to the two TMC MPs was to get a comment on the ongoing crisis in the party — in Delhi and Bengal.

When Allies Turn Foes

THE ONGOING tension between the Left parties and the Congress was visible at the INDIA bloc meeting in the Capital on Monday. CPI(M) MP John Brittas took on Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, questioning his remarks against the Left parties during the Kerala Assembly poll campaign and reminding him that his party had backed him and other Congress leaders when they were harassed over the National Herald case. He was also critical of the Congress's decision to break its alliance with the DMK in Tamil Nadu in haste. Things took an amusing turn when CPI's D Raja joined Brittas to question Gandhi's 'Left is no longer Left' comment. When Gandhi said it was because the LDF government allowed the Adani Group to do business in Kerala — referring to the Vizhinjam port project — Brittas shot back saying it was the Congress-led UDF government that had entered into an agreement with the business group.

Promise only on Paper

THE SOCIAL media was abuzz over the weekend as an event poster announced that Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal and CJI Surya Kant would inaugurate a badminton tournament between judges and lawyers from India in London on Sunday. However, as it turned out, Meghwal was in India, while highly placed sources said the CJI was neither invited nor participated in the event.

As defections mount, Naveen convenes BJD meet tomorrow

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 8

TWO YEARS after the party's defeat in the 2024 Assembly and Lok Sabha polls, BJD president Naveen Patnaik has convened a meeting of leaders who contested on party tickets on Wednesday. This comes amid defections of BJD grassroots leaders to BJP and allegations of a communication gap between the leadership and senior leaders. While BJD sources said this would be Patnaik's first such large deliberation since the electoral setback, the timing of the meeting assumes significance: it comes immediately after his week-long visit to Delhi, from where he returned only on Sunday. Patnaik's latest move appears to be an attempt to restore order ahead of the panchayat and civic body polls due in six months. The leader said Patnaik expected to send a strong message at the meeting, especially to leaders who lost in the 2024 polls.

CENTRE ALSO RESUMES IMPLEMENTATION OF MGNREGS, PM AWAS YOJANA (GRAMIN)

MoU inked, Bengal finally comes under Ayushman Bharat ambit

Anonna Dutt & Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, June 8

AS WEST Bengal finally came under the ambit of the Ayushman Bharat, with the signing of an MoU between the state and National Health Authority on Monday, Union Health Minister J P Nadda took potshots at the previous Mamata Banerjee-led government, stating that people of the state were deprived of the Centre's health scheme because the former CM kept saying '*hobe na*' (won't happen).

The Centre has also resumed implementation of the MGNREGS in Bengal — four years after it was suspended in the state.

At an event held at Vigyan Bhavan in Delhi, where the MoU with regard to Ayushman Bharat was signed, Nadda said the TMC government stayed away from several other health programmes such as upgradation of Ayushman Arogya Mandir and HPV vaccination for girls.

Notably, Bengal was the only state that had not joined the Ayushman Bharat.

CM Suwendu Adhikari said at the event, "There were three states that refused. Who were they? One was Odisha where the people said 'Ta Ta Bye Bye' to the government in 2024. Second was Delhi where the government was shown the door (in 2025). The remaining state was West Bengal and even there the citizens ended the government that was against development."

Nadda said: "We wanted to give money (for the schemes), I even asked Suwendu to convince Mamata didi, to hire community health officers, recruit ASHA workers,



Union Health Minister J P Nadda and West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari in New Delhi on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

put in the logo under the National Health Mission. She again said '*hobe na*'."

Meanwhile, after meeting Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Adhikari said that Bengal will receive over Rs 700 crore under MGNREGS. The labour budget has been approved only for June keeping in mind the impending rollout of VB – G RAM G, the Centre's new rural job scheme set to replace the UPA-era scheme on July 1.

Adhikari said West Bengal will receive around Rs 1,000 crore under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY). Sources said that Centre has also allowed resumption of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Gramin). However, the state will receive funds after it conducts a survey under the scheme. The Ayushman Bharat scheme is expected to cover an estimated 1.43 crore households in Bengal — including 1.24 crore poorest households, 15.95 lakh persons aged 70 and above, and 3.06 lakh frontline health workers. The Centre has

already released Rs 976 crore for the scheme, less than a month after the formation of the new government in the state.

CM Adhikari said there were nearly 1 crore migrant workers who travel to other states from Bengal, who will now be able to use their Ayushman card to get treatment wherever they are located.

West Bengal Chief Secretary Manoj Kumar Agarwal said these migrant workers have their Swasthya Sathi card but it is of no use in other states. "Now they will be able to avail benefits of the scheme in all these hospitals," he said.

Adhikari said that the National Health Mission was not implemented in the state for the two preceding financial years. "They said 'it is called Ayushman Arogya Mandir, why is there Mandir in the name? we will not implement it'. Now there is a double-engine sarkaar in the state, the first tranche of Rs 527 crore under NHM has already been released."

Ayushman may cover beneficiaries of Bengal's Swasthya Sathi; state govt set to bear full cost

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, June 8

AS THE West Bengal government prepares to roll out the Ayushman Bharat scheme across the state, people covered under the local health policy — Swasthya Sathi — are also likely to be brought under the ambit of the Centre's flagship insurance scheme, sources said.

The Ayushman Bharat scheme is expected to cover around 1.43 crore poor families, elderly and frontline workers in Bengal. The Swasthya Sathi scheme, on the other hand, provides near-universal annual health coverage of up to Rs 5 lakh per family to around 2.45 crore families not covered by government health schemes.

"These (Ayushma Bharat beneficiaries) are families for which the Central government will share the premium. The other residents of West Bengal covered under the Swasthya Sathi scheme will also be onboarded to Ayushman Bharat, with the state government completely covering the premium," said officials.

While the Swasthya Sathi scheme provides cover to all permanent residents of Bengal not covered by other government scheme, the Ayushman Bharat scheme has a specific list of

beneficiaries — the poorest 40% as per the socio-economic caste census 2011, all elderly aged 70 years and above and frontline healthcare workers such as ASHA and Anganwadi workers among others.

Usually, for the poorest and other beneficiaries of Ayushman Bharat, 60% of the insurance premium is paid by the Centre and 40% by the state. For extending the cover to others, the state government will have to pay the entire premium. "The benefit is these residents will be able to access the national network of empanelled hospitals with the card," said the officials.

There are over 36,000 empanelled hospitals under Ayushman Bharat and the scheme allows portability, meaning patients from one state can use their card in another to access healthcare services.

The newly formed State Health Authority is in the process of uploading patients' and empanelled hospitals' data to the national portal.

The official also added that with a BJP government in the state, Bengal is unlikely to go for co-branding, although the decision is yet to be taken. The newly formed State Health Authority is in the process of uploading patients' and empanelled hospitals' data to the national portal.



Independent candidate Parimal Nathwani files his nomination papers for Rajya Sabha polls, in Ranchi on Monday. PTI

Jharkhand numbers game in RS race heats up as BJP bets on Gujarat businessman

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, June 8

THE ENTRY of Gujarat-based businessman and sitting YSRC MP from Andhra Pradesh, Parimal Nathwani, into the Rajya Sabha race in Jharkhand as an NDA-backed Independent candidate has added a fresh layer of intrigue to the June 18 contest for two RS seats from the state.

"I share good relations with leaders across parties. I request all parties to support me," Nathwani said Monday after filing his nomination. With Nathwani joining the Rajya Sabha fray along with the JMM's Dalit face Baidyanath Ram and Congress nominee Pranav Jha, the focus has now shifted to whether the NDA-backed candidate can bridge the gap between the Opposition alliance's numbers and the votes required for victory.

The arithmetic appears straightforward for one seat, with the JMM comfortably placed to secure it with its strength of 34 MLAs in the 81-member Assembly. A candidate requires 28 first-preference votes to win.

Things, however, appear more complicated for the second seat. NDA's tally of 24 MLAs — BJP (21), LJP-RV (1), JD-U (1), and AJSU Party (1) — currently leaves it four votes short of the winning number. However, sources in Congress suggest BJP could secure the support of Jairam Mahto, the MLA of the Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha (JLKM). The JMM-led alliance has a total of 56 MLAs. So if there is no cross-voting in the ruling alliance, both its candidates would sail through.

Nathwani recalled his election to Rajya Sabha from Jharkhand in 2014. "In 2014, I contested as an Independent and

received support from the BJP, AJSU Party and others. There were no allegations of horse-trading then, and there is no question of it now either."

His bid is significant as it comes days after he met CM Hemant Soren before eventually securing NDA's backing.

A businessman and senior corporate executive, Nathwani represented Jharkhand in the RS for two consecutive terms between 2008 and 2020, both times as an Independent. He has highlighted his work in the state through MPLADS-funded projects, village development initiatives and infrastructure works.

The ruling alliance has dismissed suggestions of any cracks within its ranks. Congress spokesperson Rajesh Thakur said BJP's backing of Nathwani reflected compulsion rather than strategy. "The BJP has completely fallen apart. Their MLAs became proposers for an Independent candidate. They could not field the candidate they initially wanted. This is not a strategy, it is a compulsion," he said.

Asked if Congress could win the seat without JMM's support, Thakur said: "Without the (JMM's) support, how can Congress win? We have 16 MLAs. JMM has 34, RJD has four, and Soren is the leader of the alliance. JMM will definitely support us." JMM general secretary Supriyo Bhattacharya also expressed confidence the party's MLAs would remain united. Political observers have speculated that, apart from JMM, Nathwani could secure support from some of the four RJD MLAs. RJD spokesperson Kailash Yadav said, "He (Nathwani) is effectively a BJP-sponsored candidate. We are in opposition. Why would we support him?"

BJP's candidate for third RS seat in MP tests Cong unity as party leader resigns

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, June 8

THE BJP'S decision to field a third Rajya Sabha candidate from Madhya Pradesh has transformed what was expected to be a routine election into a test of Congress unity, exposing simmering discontent within the Opposition party over the nomination of senior leader Meenakshi Natarajan.

As Natarajan filed her nomination papers on Monday, senior Congress leader Naresh Gyanchandani resigned from party. On paper, the arithmetic for the third seat still favours Congress. In political terms, however, BJP appears less interested in winning the seat outright than in forcing Congress to publicly demonstrate cohesion at a time when sections of its state leadership remain unhappy with the high command's choice, functionaries from both parties said.

By nominating Mahesh Kewat, a prominent leader from the Kewat community who brings together OBC and fisherfolk representation, for the third seat, BJP has shifted the contest away from numbers and towards loyalty. "BJP knows that arithmetic is difficult. But elections like these are often about exposing contradictions within rival parties," said a senior BJP leader from Bhopal. "Even if Congress wins, BJP would consider it a success if it can make internal dissatisfaction visible."

CM Mohan Yadav has been involved in discussions with senior BJP leaders following the decision to field Kewat, asking party leaders to stay put in Bhopal until polling on June 18. Congress has convened legislature party meetings, brought MLAs to Bhopal and enlisted leaders across rival factions — from former CMs Kamal Nath and Digvijaya Singh to state Congress chief Jitu Patwari and LoP Umang Singhar — to publicly endorse Natarajan.

Along with Kewat, BJP has nominated Tarun Chugh and Rajneesh Agrawal. BJP enjoys a 163-seat majority in the 230-member House, while Congress has 66 seats. BJP can secure two seats as each candidate would require 58 first-preference votes to win. For the third seat, Congress possesses just enough strength to be in contention, with little room for error.

The first signs of discomfort over Natarajan's candidature surfaced from within Congress. Gyanchandani questioned the leadership's decision to nominate Natarajan in place of veteran leader Singh, warning that it could create conditions for cross-voting. He said, "I've regularly tweeted to (LoP) Rahul Gandhi in the interest of party. Yet, after serving the Congress honestly for 37 years, it is painful that a single tweet to Rahul Gandhi was not acceptable to the Madhya Pradesh leadership," he said on his reason for quitting.

TMC strongman Jahangir Khan nabbed in hotel near Nepal border

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, June 8

THE SPECIAL Task Force (STF) of West Bengal Police on Monday arrested TMC strongman Jahangir Khan, who is facing a slew of FIRs related to extortion, murder, and criminal intimidation charges, from near the India-Nepal border.

Khan was TMC's candidate in the Falta Assembly constituency but with drew just ahead of May 21 repoll. He had gone underground after the Calcutta High Court vacated a stay on his interim protection on May 26, said an STF officer.

According to STF sources, Khan was hiding in a hotel in Darjeeling's Panitanki area, close to the Nepal border, for the past two days. The hotel reportedly belongs to one of his acquaintances. "Khan had plans to settle down in Nepal, which is why he got his children admitted to a school in Nepal," said a police officer. "To evade tracking, Khan had switched off his phones and deleted his WhatsApp account," said a police officer involved in the operations.

However, investigators said Khan kept in touch with his family members and close associates. By tracking those



TMC leader Jahangir Khan after his arrest on Monday. PTI

TMC moves Calcutta HC challenging Ritabrata as LoP

The TMC on Monday moved Calcutta HC challenging the decision by the Assembly Speaker Rathindra Bose to appoint expelled TMC MLA Ritabrata Banerjee as the LoP. The petition seeks judicial review of the Speaker's decision and appointment of the party's LoP nominee, Sovandeb Chattopadhyay, as earlier decided. The court is likely to hear the matter on June 11. ENS

numbers the STF zeroed in on locations and deployed police teams in plainclothes. "Khan was detained by one of these undercover units," the STF officer said.

TMC out of KMC as govt dissolves Board, appoints administrator

Kolkata: Three days after TMC leader Firhad Hakim resigned as Kolkata Mayor, the BJP government in West Bengal, led by Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, on Monday dissolved the governing Board of Kolkata Municipal Corporation (KMC), and appointed IAS officer Smita Pandey as its administrator.

This marks the end of the TMC's 16-year rule in the civic body. In the 2011 KMC elections, TMC had 136 councillors in the 144-member corporation. The Department of Urban Development and Municipal Affairs, in its order on Monday, said that with the dissolution of the KMC board, all councillors, members of the mayor-in-council, committee members, and the chairperson would vacate their offices in accordance with the provisions of the Kolkata Municipal Corporation Act, 1980.

After Hakim resigned on June 5, the government had issued a show-cause notice to the corporation, warning that absence of leadership could disrupt civic services. ENS



Political Embrace

Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi and TMC chief Mamata Banerjee during the INDIA bloc meeting in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

"This year, on May 13, storms caused significant loss of life and property in several districts of the state. During a view meeting, I asked why the early warning system was not functioning effectively. It was found that the system was working, but there was a lack of responsiveness at the local administrative level. Later, during a video conference with officials, I instructed them to ensure that when alerts are received, local residents and institutions should also be informed promptly. Four to five days after that meeting, another disaster situation arose, but this time mobile alerts started reaching everyone three hours in advance," he said.

The CM said Uttar Pradesh now had 450 Automatic Weather Stations and 2,000 Automatic Rain Gauges installed at the block level. These systems provide farmers with accurate rainfall information. The equipment collects real-time data on rainfall, temperature, wind speed, and wind direction, helping in weather analysis and studies.

Speaking at the event, Jitendra Singh said the progress achieved in weather forecasting and observation systems in the last decade has transformed the manner in which weather services are delivered to citizens, disaster management agencies, farmers, tourists, and the aviation sector.

UP may send satellite to space for weather warning: CM

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 8

EMPHASISING THE importance of accurate and timely forecasts in managing the impacts of weather-related disasters, Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath on Monday said his administration was committed to improving the observation and monitoring network in the state to enable more efficient early warning systems.

The CM was speaking at the inauguration of the Regional Meteorological Centre here, which has been created by upgrading the existing Lucknow Meteorological Centre.

Union Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh was



Union Science & Technology Minister Jitendra Singh and UP CM Yogi Adityanath in Lucknow on Monday. ANI

also present on the occasion.

The CM said the weather observation network in Uttar Pradesh had expanded significantly in the last few years, and the state government was making efforts

to fill the gaps that remain. He said the state government was even considering sending a satellite into space dedicated to monitoring weather-related parameters specific to UP.

He said his government had initiated discussions with the ISRO for this purpose. The CM said the establishment of the regional meteorological centre would also help the state in this endeavour.

"During meetings on excessive rainfall, drought, lightning, and other seasonal issues, discussions with meteorological and related departments have often highlighted how timely and accurate information helps in formulating the right strategy," Adityanath said.

‘BRAWL, ABUSE & SHOUTING OVER PHONE THEFT CHARGE’

Man arrested for pushing cleric from Bihar off train in Bareilly

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 8

THE GOVERNMENT Railway Police (GRP) Monday arrested a man who they claimed pushed a Bihar cleric out of a moving train in Uttar Pradesh's Bareilly district on April 26, leading to his death. The incident leading to the death of the victim, Maulana Tauseef Raza, was triggered by a brawl over alleged theft of a mobile phone, officials claimed.

The accused has been identified as Pankaj Rajput, a resident of Moradabad. While police had initially termed the cleric's death an accident, they launched a probe after his wife handed them a clip of her conversation with Raza that night in which he is heard asking her to seek police help. His phone later got switched off. Raza, a cleric in a mosque at his native place in Kishanganj district, had come to attend a religious event in Bareilly and was returning home in a Bihar-bound train.

The accused was identified after scanning over 300 passengers aboard the train the cleric

was travelling in and questioning many of them, officials said.

Moradabad GRP SP Ashutosh Shukla said, "We got a major help from Home Guard Recruitment Exam candidates travelling in the same train. These aspirants recorded on their cellphones a heated exchange between Raza and Pankaj. The police team probing the case had a tough time tracing these candidates." Raza was travelling in a sleeper coach- S-8, even though he had a general ticket, it is learnt. Police collected the list of nearly 300 passengers travelling in S-7, 8, 9 and 10 coaches. While many of these passengers were contacted on phone, a woman admitted to having witnessed the cleric being heckled by a likely drunk passenger.

The SP said, "The woman said the accused picked up a fight with the cleric accusing him of stealing his cellphone even as he had the device with him. The cleric tried to convince him that he had no other cellphone except his, but the man kept abusing and shouting at him. She said Tauseef went to

other coaches to avoid the confrontation, but the accused kept chasing him. Tauseef came to the door of a coach when the accused manhandled him and pushed him in the wee hours of April 26." Police were informed about a body lying near the tracks in the Cantonment area around 7 am. The cellphone helped identify the deceased.

After getting the woman's testimony, police were told by some passengers that there was a group of youths who had recorded the incident. A video procured from these youths, found to be Home Guard's exam aspirants, showed the face and physical appearance of the accused. They also scanned CCTV footage from railway platforms in Moradabad, Shahjahanpur and Bareilly. Then they zeroed in on Rajput by scanning the mobile phones active in the area during that period, the SP said.

Police said that Pankaj has confessed to have pushed the cleric off after a physical assault, and that he was drunk. Pankaj had boarded the train in Moradabad, police said.

Move comes amid backlash over 'exclusion' of many distressed farmers under the govt scheme

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, June 8

FACING CRITICISM that its newly approved Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar farm loan waiver scheme could leave out a large number of distressed farmers, the Maharashtra government on Monday said it may consider modifying or changing certain conditions to ensure more farmers benefit from it.

The *Indian Express* on Monday reported that a note by the state cabinet stated that the scheme's eligibility restrictions are among the reasons the state's eventual expenditure is expected to be lower than the projected outlay of Rs 36,585 crore.

Maharashtra Agriculture Minister Dattatray Bhanu on Monday said, "We cleared the farm loan waiver scheme in the previous cabinet and certain things could not be made public due to the model code of conduct. As per the primary es-



As per primary estimate, this Rs 36,585-crore scheme would benefit around 56 lakh farmers... The government takes a decision after considering all the aspects. The CM has taken a courageous decision..."

DATTATRAY BHARNE,
STATE AGRICULTURE MINISTER

time, the scheme is of Rs 36,585 crore to benefit around 56 lakh farmers. If there are some farmers who do not fit into the criteria announced, we will discuss it in the state cabinet and will bring it to the notice of the chief minister. A decision to change certain norms will be taken to ensure more farmers are benefited."

The Cabinet note on the pro-

posals records that the Planning Department, which vets the financial implications of government schemes, flagged the proposal as imposing a significant financial burden on the state.

The note stated that based on information received from various banks, approximately Rs 36,585 crore would be required to provide benefits under the scheme, but the actual financial requirement may be lower because of the eligibility restrictions proposed. It also stated that commercial banks are expected to provide some concession, or haircut, on the outstanding loans of eligible farmers.

"Government takes a decision after considering all the aspects. The Chief Minister has taken a courageous decision of waiver even in these pressing times. We cannot always satisfy everyone. But if 56 lakh farmers are likely to be benefited, then it is not a bad thing at all," according to Bhanu.

Meanwhile, the state government has written to the Election Commission of India (ECI) seeking permission to issue official notification of the Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar farm loan waiver scheme as the state is under Model Code of Conduct (MCC) due to the June 18 legislative council elections.

"The government has sent a request to the ECI to allow them

to publish the government resolution announcing the scheme. The ECI had given permission to the state government to take a decision on the scheme. Now whether an official notification can be issued or not has to be decided by the Commission," an ECI official said.

Before the state Cabinet meeting last week, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis had said that as per the ECI guidelines, the cabinet can approve the scheme but cannot make an official announcement as MCC was in place.

A farm loan waiver means the government pays off a farmer's outstanding debt to the bank on their behalf. The Punyashlok Ahilyadevi Holkar scheme, approved by the state cabinet on June 2, earmarked Rs 36,585 crore for the purpose though the actual burden on the exchequer is expected to be lower.

The state government has come under fire from the Opposition drawing criticism for imposing eligibility conditions that could exclude a large number of distressed farmers from the scheme.

Nationalist Congress Party (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar announced to launch an indefinite hunger strike from June 12, demanding a blanket farm loan waiver without restrictive eligibility conditions.

Over 50 'illegal' structures razed in Jaipur demolition drive

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, June 8

IN A major anti-encroachment drive, the Jaipur Development Authority (JDA) on Monday demolished over 50 allegedly illegal structures including some religious sites, officials said.

Bulldozers were deployed in the city's Jagatpura area to clear encroachments along a key road running parallel to the railway line from the Nandpur underpass. The operation aims to restore the road to its sanctioned width of 80 feet and improve connectivity between Nandpur and Jagatpura. Officials said that several stretches of the road had narrowed to just 25-30 feet due to encroachments, despite revenue records showing an 80-foot-wide right-of-way. The approximately 1.5-kilometre route passes through six major residential colonies and serves as an important link for commuters.

ACP (Law and Order) Rajeev Pachar said, "We have removed a mosque and two temples. There were over 100 houses, the front portion of which were removed a month back. There was no problem faced by police, and the public supported the administration. There was one mazaar, which had its boundary between the road, so we removed that..." Authorities imposed extensive security measures to prevent law-and-order issues.



बिहार सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता (यॉंत्रिक) का कार्यालय
सिंचाई यॉंत्रिक प्रमंडल, वीरपुर

E-Mail ID:- imdbirpur@gmail.com

शुद्धि-पत्र

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 1033 दिनांक 15.05.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित एवं PR No.-003646 WRD 2026-27 द्वारा प्रकाशित अत्युत्कालीन पुनर्कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-03/2026-27 का इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 1174 दिनांक 26.05.2026 द्वारा निर्गत शुद्धि-पत्र में अपरिहार्य कारणवश निम्न रूपेण विस्तारित किया जाता है।

विवरण	आमंत्रित कोटेशन की अवधि	कोटेशन की विस्तारित अवधि
कोटेशन कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि	दिनांक 03.06.2026 से दिनांक 06.06.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)	दिनांक 08.06.2026 से दिनांक 11.06.2026 के 3.00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
प्री-बिड मिति का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि	दिनांक 04.06.2026 को 3.00 बजे अपराह्न में मुख्य अभियंता (यॉंत्रिक), जल संसाधन विभाग पटना के कार्यालय कक्ष में।	दिनांक 09.06.2026 को 3.00 बजे अपराह्न में मुख्य अभियंता (यॉंत्रिक), जल संसाधन विभाग पटना के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
तकनीकी सीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 08.06.2026 को 3.30 बजे अपराह्न (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)	दिनांक 12.06.2026 को 3.30 बजे अपराह्न (सिर्फ वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

कृपया इसे इस हद तक संशोधित समझा जाय। कोटेशन के शेष सभी नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगे।

(ईओ अमित कुमार)
कार्यपालक अभियंता (यॉंत्रिक)
सिंचाई यॉंत्रिक प्रमंडल, वीरपुर

PR-005162 (WRD) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, विक्री एवं सेवन अवेध है।
संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज कराये। आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।

टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268



Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Limited
(CIN – U40108JH2013-SGC001702), Office Of The
General Manager-Cum-Chief Engineer

Electric Supply Area, 33/11 KV P/S/S, Daridih, Giridih, Pin- 815302
GSTIN No.- 20AADJC3148AD21, E-mail ID- gm.giridih@jbvn.co.in



E-Tender Notice

e- Procurement for Deployed Technical & Non-technical Resource For Electric Supply Division, Godda under O&M Head for F.Y. 2026-27.

Online tender is invited from reputed contractor/Proprietor/company having past experience of providing/ handling of Technical resource in the electricity distribution system and financially sound to provide technical (ITI) and Non-Technical manpower/ Experienced USK (matriculate) agencies for empanelment of agencies to provide technical and non-technical resource for 33 KV/ 11 KV/ LT line and distribution transformer maintenance and 33/11 KV Power Sub Station maintenance and operation & revenue related works under Electric Supply Area, Giridih.

All online tenders should be submitted online on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Sl. No.	NIT No.	Name of the work	Particulars	Unit	Qty.	EMD (In Rs.)	Cost of BOQ Non-refundable
1	148/PR/JBVN L/2026-27	To provide technical manpower and non-technical resources for 33 KV/11 KV, LT line, distribution transformer maintenance & Operation and 33/11 KV Power Sub-Station maintenance & operation under Electric Supply Division, Godda for 01 (one) year.	Switch Board Operator Gr.-II/ I.T.I. Trained (Electrical) Junior Line Man I.T.I. Trained (Electrical) Unskilled Khalasi (Helper (Matric Pass)) Total No. of Manpower	Nos.	60 25 109 194	12,06,000/- 18% GST= 11,800/-	10,000 + 18% GST= 11,800/-

IMPORTANT SCHEDULE OF DATES FOR ABOVE NIT's

Availability of tender document on website From: 09.06.2026 to 29.06.2026 up to 05.00 p.m.
Last date and time for uploading of E-tender 29.06.2026 up to 18.00 p.m.
Date of Pre-Bid Meeting with bidders 16.06.2026 up to 02.00 p.m.
Last date and time of receipt of bid documents (Online) 29.06.2026 up to 05.00 p.m.
Date and time for opening of Techno commercial part. 01.07.2026 up to 02.00 p.m.
Date and time for opening of tender Part-II (Price Part) To be Further communicated
Tendering Officer and address for communication Electric Supply Area, Giridih

(Note:- The aforesaid quantity is tentative and may be increase or decrease as per requirement)
Tender Notice is also available on our website: www.jbvn.in
12- For any clarification please contact: 75429-73449/ 82501-58600.

Sd/-
G.M.-Cum-Chief Engineer
Electric Supply Area, Giridih

PR 381796 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27)#D

Directorate of Tourism,

Department of Tourism, Art Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs, Govt. of Jharkhand
MDI Building, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004, GSTIN-20RCHD00786C1D4
Phone:(0651)2400493, email:dirjharkhandtourism@gmail.com, Web:<https://tourism.jharkhand.gov.in>

e-Tender Notice

e-Tender No.:-Tour/Dir/Pra/09/2026/ 443 /Ranchi Date:-08/06/2026

Jharkhand Tourism invites reputed bidders with proven experience in Adventure Sports and Leisure Activities, along with a sound financial background, to participate in the e-Tender through this Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of an Agency for Development, Operation and Management of Adventure Sports and Leisure Activities under Adventure Festivals at various locations in the State of Jharkhand (2nd Call).

NIT No.	Name of the works	Earnest money to be deposited (In Rs.)	Time of completion of work
	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of an Agency for Development, Operation and Management of Adventure Sports and Leisure Activities under Adventure Festivals at various locations in the State of Jharkhand (2 nd Call).	₹ 30,00,000.00 (Thirty Lakh Only)	120 Days

NIT No.	Name of the works	Earnest money to be deposited (In Rs.)	Time of completion of work
	RFP/Tender Availability	09/06/2026; Time: 11:00 Hrs	
	Last date for receiving Pre-bid queries	18/06/2026; Time: 16:00 Hrs	
	Pre-bid Meeting	19/06/2026; Time: 15:00 Hrs	
	Response to queries	23/06/2026; Time: 15:00 Hrs	
	Last date of Submission	08/07/2026; Time: 14:00 Hrs	
	Technical Bid opening	08/07/2026; Time: 16:00 Hrs	
	Financial Bid Opening	To be announced	
	Cost of Tender (Demand Draft)	Electronic transfer of INR 11,800/- (Inclusive of GST) (Non-Refundable) through Jharkhand Tender website - https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in/nicgep/app	
	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Electronic transfer of INR 30,00,000/- through Jharkhand Tender website - https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in	
	Website for downloading Tender Documents	Directorate of Tourism, Department of Tourism, Art Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs, Govt. of Jharkhand, MDI Building, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004	
	Name and Address of Office inviting Tender	Director, Directorate of Tourism, MDI Building, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004	
	Venue for Bid Opening		

E-Tender document and BOQ including terms & conditions, Tender specification, etc. can be downloaded from website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>. Any details required in the regard can also be procured from the office of the undersigned (0651-2400493) during office hours. NIC helpline no. is 0651-2400178.

The bids will be received only through electronic tendering mode.

No claim shall be entertained on account of disruption of internet services while uploading the bid. Bidders are advised to upload their bids well in advance to avoid last minute technical snag.

Bidders must submit a copy of the UTR/reference number as proof of online payment of the tender fee and EMD, as mentioned in the NIT, before the specified cutoff date and time. The details of the finally uploaded BOQ, EMD, and payment instruments (DD/Cheque, etc.) must exactly match the details submitted online (scanned copies); any discrepancies will result in the bid being rejected.

Sd/-
Director, Tourism

PR 381854 Tourism, Art Culture Sports And Youth Affairs(26-27)#D

Kamal Saiyed
Surat, June 8

A RESIDENT of Nasirnagar slum in Surat's Ved Darwaja area moved the Gujarat High Court on Monday, challenging the demolition of several shanties and alleging that "due process was not followed" and sought a stay on the "drive".

While the demolition of nearly 100 units were carried out from May 28, allegedly under police protection, the Surat Municipal Corporation (SMC) has denied its involvement in the action even as the local BJP MLA, Vinu Moradiya, said later on Monday that there was "something fishy" about it.

The Special Civil Application (SCA) filed by Hussain Aziz Shaikh (40), whose house is yet to be demolished, has made the State of Gujarat, Surat Municipal Corporation, Surat Police Commissioner, Deputy Commissioner and Special Operation Group respondents in the case.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that some people "dressed in sky-blue shirts and black trousers, accompanied purportedly by Surat police Special Operation Group personnel and



A woman lies atop the rubble of houses demolished in Nasirnagar area of Katargam in Surat. PTI

Chowk Bazaar police personnel, however, told *The Indian Express* that they received an application and other required documents from SMC authorities to provide security for the demolition in the Nasirnagar slums. "It was a demand made by SMC, so we provided police force to prevent any incident of law and order", claimed an officer who did not wish to be named.

On May 29, local Congress leaders made representations to Municipal Commissioner Nagarajan, Police Commissioner Anupam Singh Gahlaut, District Collector Tejas Parmar, Mayor Mayaben Mavani and Standing

Officers in the Surat police, however, told *The Indian Express* that they received an application and other required documents from SMC authorities to provide security for the demolition in the Nasirnagar slums. "It was a demand made by SMC, so we provided police force to prevent any incident of law and order", claimed an officer who did not wish to be named.

On May 29, local Congress leaders made representations to Municipal Commissioner Nagarajan, Police Commissioner Anupam Singh Gahlaut, District Collector Tejas Parmar, Mayor Mayaben Mavani and Standing

Committee Chairman Rajan Patel seeking redressal on behalf of the residents. The petition said the slum-dwellers had been occupying the land for "35 years" and there were 250 such units in the Nasirnagar slum, which was located on private land.

Salim Shaikh, a resident of Nasirnagar, said, "I drive an autorickshaw for a living and to feed my family: wife and three children. My father stayed in this house, and after his death, I started staying here. We are regularly paying property taxes to the SMC, and we have registered meters and a water pipeline connection. We stay on the land owned by a private person. How can the SMC evict us?"

Congress corporator Arshad Jariwala said, "When I spoke with the municipal officials of the Central Zone and the Katargam Zone, they told me they had visited to demarcate the road. The police took me away and later carried out demolitions. Following our representations to the higher authorities, the demolition activities were stopped the next day."

Katargam MLA Moradiya told *The Indian Express*, "Something has gone wrong there. The

municipal corporation officials went for demarcation of the road in the area, and when the public approached them about houses being demolished, they did not give perfect answers. Even the police present at the site did not favour the local people."

Moradiya said, "As per my information, a builder's land is nearby the Nasirnagar area and he wanted to get these slums removed... The builder has demanded a small road leading to his under-construction project. We also wanted to know why the SMC went ahead and removed entire slum settlements... Something fishy is going on among the SMC officials."

The application filed by advocate Zameer Shaikh on behalf of Aziz Shaikh claims that Aziz has been living in Nasirnagar since 1990. Aziz has sought a stay of demolition and relief for those whose houses were demolished till the petition is disposed of by the Gujarat High Court.

Aziz's Advocate Zameer Shaikh said, "We filed a special Civil Application before the High Court... notices have been issued to all the respondents to remain present in the forthcoming hearing."

Hate speech Bill: MHA seeks clarification from Karnataka

Express News Service
Bengaluru, June 8

THE MINISTRY of Home Affairs (MHA) has sought clarification from the Karnataka government over The Hate Speech and Hate Crimes (Prevention) Bill, 2025, which was passed by the Assembly in December 2025, saying that provisions of the Bill were "already substantially covered under the existing provisions of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 and other prevailing laws".

According to the provisions of Bill, first-time offenders would face a jail term of one to seven years along with Rs 50,000 fine, while repeat offenders could face up to 10 years in prison and Rs 1 lakh as penalty. Ahead of its passage, Opposition BJP had termed the Bill "draconian".

In February this year, the Governor had withheld assent to the Bill citing representations against it and reserved it for President's consideration. A communication from the Lok

Bhavan to the President had said that the definition of a hate speech under the Bill was "vague" and there was a "possibility of misuse of the provisions of this Act for political malice or to avenge hatred against any person, group or community".

Based on comments from the Judicial Cell of MHA and Ministry of Electronics and IT, the MHA sought clarifications from the government. An office memo dated May 12 from the Centre-State Division of MHA

stated that the enactment of a separate state legislation "may result in duplication and lack of uniformity". "...the proposed legislation may not be necessary at this stage, and the existing legal framework is adequate to address the concerns," it said. On May 20, it was forwarded to the Karnataka Home Department and Department of Parliamentary Affairs and Legislation. It sought further comments and clarification regarding the Bill from the Home Department.

Court to hear anticipatory bail plea of Khan 'Sir' today

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, June 8

A PATNA court will hear educator and YouTuber Faizal Khan's anticipatory bail plea Tuesday in an attempted murder case filed against him for allegedly asking his security guards to fire at a crowd after violence outside his Khan Global Studies (KGS) coaching centre. Khan is yet to be arrested.

This comes as the court reserved its order on the bail plea of Khan's rival Raushan Anand, director of Gyan Bindu Coaching Institute, who was arrested in a counter FIR linked to the same incident. "Faisal Khan alias Khan Sir's anticipatory bail has been filed. It has been listed for tomorrow and the first

hearing will take place then," his counsel Arvind Kumar Mouar said Monday, adding that the bail pleas of his security guards, arrested on June 10, will next be heard Wednesday. *The Indian Express* reached out to Patna SSP Kartikeya K Sharma and City SP (Central) Diksha seeking clarity on the probe, and whether Khan could be arrested, but did not get a response. The legal developments come a week after violence erupted outside KGS in Musallahpur on the night of June 2.

Meanwhile, the court also heard arguments on Raushan Anand's bail plea and reserved its order until Tuesday. "Raushan Anand Sir was not even present at the scene," Anand's counsel Raghav Kumar said.

Manipur: Man killed by armed miscreants

Express News Service
Imphal, June 8

A RONGMEI Naga man, 58, was killed by armed miscreants in Kangpokpi district of Manipur on Monday.

Official sources said a group of villagers from Pongringlong Part-I, a Rongmei Naga village in Kangpokpi which is a Kuki-dominated district, had gone to collect firewood in the forest around 6.40 am when armed miscreants allegedly opened fire at them. While most of the villagers escaped, Chungjanglung Panmei went missing after being hit by a bullet.

The police launched a rescue operation, and around 1.30 pm his body was recovered. Police said Panmei’s body bore four bullet injury marks, and it seemed he was shot from point-blank range. The body was taken to Imphal for a post-mortem.

Pongringlong Youth Club, a local Rongmei Naga body, in a statement claimed Panmei’s was killed by Kuki militants in Kangpokpi forests.

The club said it was a matter of serious concern and required a thorough and impartial investigation by a competent authority.

Govt: Fire on tanker off Oman coast, all 24 Indian crew safe

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, June 8

ALL 24 Indian seafarers on board the foreign-flagged oil products tanker, Marivex, have been safely evacuated and taken to Oman after an incident of fire was reported on board around 1.30 pm Monday, a senior Shipping Ministry official and the Embassy of India in Muscat said.

Marivex was well outside the Strait of Hormuz area. When the fire was reported, Marivex was south of the Gulf of Oman, in waters off Oman’s east coast.

However, according to the Forward Seamen’s Union of India (FSUI), one of the seafarers on board the vessel informed the union that the Marivex was hit by a missile, also damaging a couple of its lifeboats. The vessel sent out distress calls, stating it was on fire and needed to be evacuated, as per information posted by the FSUI on X.

In a post on X, the Embassy of India in Muscat said, “We are thankful to the Omani authorities for their swift response and rescue of all the 24 crew members of Indian nationality, onboard MT Marivex, and ensuring their safety.”

Shipping Ministry Director, Opesh Kumar Sharma, said the cause of the fire was being looked into. “Whether the ship was hit by a projectile or not, presently we are trying to get the updated information... We are in touch with the owners. We are trying to ascertain the facts.” As per preliminary information, the tanker was not carrying any cargo.

The initial distress call from

EXIT COUNTRY BY ANY AVAILABLE MODE OF TRANSPORT, EMBASSY TELLS INDIANS IN IRAN

Amid fresh strikes in West Asia, India calls for quick de-escalation, dialogue

Shubhajit Roy & Divya A
New Delhi, June 8

WITH THE almost two-month fragile ceasefire disrupted by exchange of fresh strikes between Israel and Iran, India expressed concern at the renewed attacks in West Asia and called for immediate de-escalation, ensuring civilians stay unharmed and talks to find a diplomatic solution.

New Delhi’s statement was cautious and carefully phrased since Israel, a close strategic partner, broke the ceasefire as it launched attacks on Lebanon, despite US President Donald Trump’s warnings otherwise.

The Ministry of External Affairs statement was headlined “Developments in West Asia” — a benign description of what’s really happening on-ground. It said, “India deeply regrets the renewed attacks in West Asia. These developments are a matter of utmost concern to the international community.” It did not specifically say who targeted whom.

Iran and Israel signaled on Monday that they were ready to wind down the military escalation that briefly shattered a fragile two-month cease-fire and brought West Asia back to the precipice of full-blown war.

The Indian statement also made a case for an end to the war — which has impacted India with rising fuel and commodity prices with the near-closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

MEA said, “This conflict has now lasted over 100 days and has already caused immense human suffering. It has also had a debilitating impact on the global economy and energy supplies.”

The Indian statement made three appeals: “We call on all parties to immediately de-escalate tensions, ensure that civilians are not harmed and conclude ongoing negotiations for a diplomatic solution so that peace and stability can return to the region.”

As the death toll of Indians crossed double digits — 10 civilians killed since the war

E. EXPLAINED

Navigating turbulence

While keeping Indian nationals safe has been a priority for the government, it also faces the diplomatic challenge of keeping communication lines open with all sides — Israel, Iran and the US. This has been a major diplomatic task as Delhi continues to navigate the turbulence in the region and protect its interests.

began on February 28 — Delhi yet again articulated its concern for the lives of innocent civilians. There are about one crore (10 million) Indians in West Asia and the conflict poses a threat to their lives and livelihoods.

The advisories are not new, but the timing suggests that Delhi is worried about their

well-being.

The Narendra Modi government had evacuated more than 2,400 Indians from Iran in the first two months of the war. In late April, the Indian Embassy in Tehran had reported that it facilitated movement of Indian nationals through Armenia and Azerbaijan for onward travel to India. It had said that 2,423 Indian nationals, including 1,091 students and 657 fishermen, have moved out of Iran into Armenia and Azerbaijan.

The Indian Embassy in Iran, which has issued at least seven such advisories in the past few months, posted on X: “In view of the latest developments in the region, the Embassy reiterates its earlier advice to all Indian Nationals to avoid any travel to Iran.” It also advised the Indians presently in Iran to exit the country by any available mode of transport.

An estimated 6,000 Indians, including students, are in Iran currently.

In Tel Aviv, the Indian Em-

bassy strongly advised Indians to strictly adhere to safety guidelines and instructions issued by the Israeli authorities. “In view of the prevailing security situation in the region, all Indian nationals in Israel are advised to exercise utmost caution and remain vigilant at all times,” it said.

The Indian nationals in Israel have also been advised to “remain in proximity to designated shelters” and “to familiarise themselves with the nearest protected spaces in their area of residence or work.”

“Indian nationals are advised to avoid all non-essential and unnecessary travel within Israel until further notice. Citizens are encouraged to monitor local news, official announcements, and emergency alerts regularly,” it said.

Around 40,000 Indians are said to be in Israel presently. “The Embassy remains closely engaged with the relevant authorities and will continue to issue updates as necessary,” the Indian mission in Tel Aviv said.

HONOURING THE HEROES



NAIB SUBEDAR DOLESHWAR SUBBA



CAPTAIN LALRINAWALA SAILO



AIR COMMODORE PRASANTH BALAKRISHNAN NAIR



MAJOR ARSHDEEP SINGH



LANCE NAIK MEENATCHI SUNDARAM A



LIEUTENANT SHASHANK TIWARI (POSTHUMOUS)



SEPOY JANJAL PRAVIN PRABHAKAR (POSTHUMOUS)

President Droupadi Murmu conferred seven Kirti Chakras (in pics), including two posthumous; 15 Vir Chakras, including three posthumous; and 29 Shaurya Chakras, including one posthumous, to the personnel of Defence Forces, CAPFs and State/UT Police during Phase-I of Defence Investiture Ceremony 2026 at Rashtrapati Bhawan on Monday. ANI, PTI

• BRIEFLY



The tunnel is considered world's longest single-tube bi-directional bypass built at record height — 11,578 feet above sea level. ANI

JAMMU & KASHMIR

Zojila tunnel breakthrough likely today, 6 months ahead of schedule

ZOJILA TUNNEL will see light of the day on Tuesday when a blast will lead to a breakthrough at the end of the world’s longest single-tube bi-directional bypass built at record height. The breakthrough will bring the decades-old dream of an all-weather connectivity between the Kashmir Valley and Ladakh closer to reality, officials said. Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari will witness the breakthrough blast, they said. The breakthrough is six months ahead of schedule, according to an official of the National Highways & Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (NHIDCL). PTI

YouTuber held over videos against TVK govt

MARIDHAS, A prominent Tamil YouTuber known for his outspoken support of the BJP and sharp criticism of Dravidian parties, was arrested on Monday by a special team of the Chennai City Police in connection with videos allegedly targeting the TVK-led government headed by Tamil Nadu CM C Joseph Vijay. While authorities confirmed a case had been registered, details of the FIR and the specific legal provisions invoked had not been made public. ENS

Rs 398 cr cyber fraud network busted; 14 held

POLICE BUSTED a cyber fraud racket involving illegal transactions of Rs 398.43 crore through 13 mule accounts, linked to 228 inter-state cyber fraud complaints, and arrested 14 people from Patan district of Gujarat under Operation Mule Hunt 2.0, officials said on Monday. Police said an analysis of data on the Union government’s SAMANVAYA and NCCRP showed suspicious transactions in certain current accounts opened at Harij Nagrik Sahakari Bank in Patan district. PTI

Preventive detention not for punishing past conduct, says J&K HC

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, June 8

SAYING THAT the preventive detention is not intended to “punish a person for past conduct”, the J&K High Court has quashed the Public Safety Act (PSA) against a Srinagar resident, who had crossed over to Pakistan-occupied Kashmir for arms training in 1989.

Srinagar resident Mehraj ud din Bhat was detained under the PSA in June last year for “being an active conduit of the banned outfit, LeT, instigating and motivating youth and providing logistical support to terrorists”.

The court, however, said the allegations against the petitioner that he instigates youth, works against democratic institutions or supports anti-national ideology are unsupported.

“The grounds of detention reveal that the foundation of the detention order rests substantially on allegations that the petitioner crossed over to POK in

1989, when he was admittedly a juvenile, received training there and returned in the year 1990,” Justice M A Chowdhary said in his order. “It is further alleged he was arrested by BSF in 1991 and remained in custody for about twenty months before being released in the year 1992.”

Justice Chowdhary called the allegations against the petitioner “bald assertions” lacking any material facts and said he is not expected to rebut such generalised accusations. “Allegations that the petitioner instigates youth, works against democratic institutions or supports anti-national ideology are bald assertions unsupported by particulars. The constitutional requirement is that grounds of detention must be sufficiently definite to enable the petitioner to make an effective and meaningful representation. Vague and indefinite allegations render the subjective satisfaction of the detaining authority vulnerable...” the judgment read.

Helicopter survey done, no clue still in hunt for missing trekker

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, June 8

TEN DAYS after she went missing while on a trek to Uttarakhand, the authorities are yet to make any headway on what happened to Babita Pandey, 24.

On Sunday, an aerial survey with a helicopter was done of the Dayara Bugyal trek which Pandey was attempting, and of the surrounding region.

Police had received information on May 30 evening about Pandey going missing from the Go Base Camp area of the trek. Since the next day, a search operation has been on, involving around 150 personnel from the local police, SDRF, NDRF, Forest Department, Disaster Management QRT, and other agencies, with drones, sniffer dogs as well as teams from the Indo-Tibetan Border Police, Army and the Nehru Institute of Mountaineering. A deep-diving team has



Babita Pandey went missing 10 days ago in Uttarakhand

conducted searches in the lake and marshy areas near Go Base Camp.

The authorities said they had inspected hotels, guest houses, and other accommodation facilities in the Dayara Bugyal and Raithal areas, reviewing CCTV footage, and conducting inquiries along the Agoda–Dodital route.

The family has blamed the two trekkers who were accompanying Pandey — her friend Harmanpal Singh and his friend

Harmanpreet Singh — for her disappearance. But, sources said that while police have been questioning the two, they haven’t got much against them. “Their story has been consistent from the start,” said Superintendent of Police Kamlesh Upadhyay.

Pandey’s brother Harshit, however, raised several questions. “She told us she was going with her girl friends. Later, I was told by a friend that she was going with Harmanpal... We think she has been kidnapped. How can she vanish into thin air?”

Harshit also argued that with the three allegedly duped into carrying fake permits for the trek, how could the authorities be sure they had traced all the people in the area at the time.

Another problem police are facing is the heavy traffic in the area due to the ongoing Char Dham Yatra.

As controversy over ‘beef in tiffin’ spreads, 5 school students in Assam’s Goalpara face expulsion today

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 8

FIVE MUSLIM students of a government higher secondary student in Assam’s Goalpara may be expelled Tuesday as a row over beef brought in tiffin by one of them snowballs.

The minor boy to whom the tiffin belonged was earlier detained and his mother arrested. The school has, meanwhile, directed that only vegetarian food be brought in tiffin boxes, located in a mixed-population area in Muslim-majority Goalpara district.

Ananda Rabha, the officer-in-charge of Krishnai Police Station, said the mother and son were facing charges of acts intended to outrage religious beliefs, and the complaint had been filed by parents of two of their Hindu classmates.

The woman, who is associated with a local self-help group,

lost her husband, and is a single parent. Rabha said: “Since the boy is a minor, he was produced before a juvenile court. Four other boys are being questioned as part of the case.”

Officials said while the alleged incident took place Friday last week, as word of it spread, the matter escalated, with different organisations descending on the school the next day. The president of the School Management Development Committee (SDMC), Subrata Das, told *The Indian Express* that a meeting will be held Tuesday to decide on a proposal to expel the five Muslim students.

Das added: “On June 5, the five students of a Class 9 section tried to feed beef they had brought in tiffin to two Hindu classmates. The latter told their teachers, and the teachers and principal tried to resolve the matter within the school since it was a sensitive matter. But after

“I have already directed the inspector of schools that students should at most be allowed to bring eggs to school. Fish, meat should not be allowed.”

PRODIP TIMUNG,
DISTRICT COMMISSIONER

the boys went home and told their parents and other people in the village, the matter became inflamed and local organisations began calling up the authorities. When it escalated, I went and met the two Hindu boys. A lot of people had gathered by then and the parents decided that they wanted to take it to the law. I called the police station OC (officer-in-charge) that night myself.”

Manidul Islam, a local All Assam Students’ Union leader who has spoken to the accused boys and their families, said the matter had been vitiated by different groups and organisations getting involved. “The boys said they were sharing the tiffin, when two classmates walked over and asked what they were eating. The issue grew from there.”

Amidst the chaos, both District Commissioner Prodipt Timung and SSP Nabaneet Mahanta visited the school and assured action.

“Such an incident should not have happened, it should not happen. If required, tiffins should be inspected. I have already directed the inspector of schools that students should at most be allowed to bring eggs to school. Fish, meat should not be allowed,” Timung said at the school.

The District Commissioner

told *The Indian Express* that a magisterial inquiry has been initiated, but did not elaborate on the scope of the inquiry.

On Sunday, the school authorities, members of the SDMC and various local community organisations held a meeting on the school premises to discuss the matter.

While the principal could not be reached for comment, SDMC chief Das said the consensus at the meeting was that the five Muslim boys be expelled. “We have decided to expel them. We will have an SDMC meeting on Tuesday and take a final decision,” he said.

Islam, who opposed the proposal at the meeting, said: “Whatever the matter is, I said the students should not be deprived of education because of this. We need to focus on bringing back communal harmony to this area where all of us live as neighbours.”

After 100 days of conflict, a backsliding

ONE HUNDRED days into the West Asia conflict, Iran and Israel have exchanged fire for the first time since a fragile ceasefire took effect on April 8. The escalation was hardly unexpected. Tehran has long insisted that any ceasefire must include an end to Israel’s bombing campaign in Lebanon. That is something Donald Trump has also pursued publicly, and evidently unsuccessfully. The latest flare-up began after Iran fired ballistic missiles at northern Israel on Sunday in retaliation for Israeli strikes on southern Beirut. Israel responded with attacks on targets in central and western Iran. The renewed hostilities threaten to unravel the progress that had been made in the US-Iran talks, further narrowing the limited space for diplomacy that had opened up over the past two months.

The US President, who has demanded that Iran and Israel “immediately stop shooting”, finds himself trapped between a recalcitrant rival and an intransigent ally. Iran sees its control of the Strait of Hormuz as a source of leverage to extract concessions, while Israel remains unwilling to compromise on the Hezbollah threat. Domestic political considerations further complicate matters: In all three countries, two of which face critical elections in the coming months, any compromise risks being portrayed as capitulation at home. Even as a section of public opinion in the US has turned sharply against Israel, the political establishment remains committed to supporting it unconditionally. Trump cannot afford to be seen as abandoning Israel, but he must also contend with the prospect of higher energy prices and supply-chain disruptions. Netanyahu, meanwhile, depends for his political survival on his hard-right coalition — after Iran’s offensive, one minister declared that “Tehran must burn”. How Trump balances these competing forces will determine when the shooting stops and diplomacy gets another chance.

Even before the return to kinetic action, the US and Iran remained far apart on a deal because their core demands — on nuclear weapons, sanctions, regional proxies and frozen assets — have been fundamentally irreconcilable. Deep mutual distrust, compounded by the absence of meaningful direct contact between Tehran and Washington since the Islamabad meeting in April, means that even if Trump succeeds in securing a de-escalation, the region is likely to remain trapped in a state of no-war, no-peace, with continuing consequences for the world economy. For India, a second increase in domestic LPG prices in three months, as oil companies continue to grapple with surging energy costs, is a reminder that the conflict in West Asia is not a distant one.

In law, need to write a new marriage story

THE SUPREME Court saying that keeping alive a marriage which is “already decayed and is decomposing day by day” serves neither the couple nor society is an important intervention in what is often one of the most bitter and wearying legal processes. The two-judge bench that was ruling on the case of a couple that has been living separately for 15 years said that asking them to live together after they’ve been estranged for so long would amount to “cruelty to both the parties”. In thus framing the issue, the Court has underlined the need for a more nuanced approach to the complex issue of marital breakdown.

While the laws in their present form offer two paths to legal separation — mutual consent (no-fault) and contested (fault-based) — the Supreme Court has periodically used its extraordinary powers under Article 142 (1) to intervene the framework of divorce and bring in the concept of “irretrievable breakdown of marriage” (IBM). In 2006, while ruling on *Naveen Kohli vs Neetu Kohli*, it urged the government to “seriously consider bringing an amendment in the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955 to incorporate irretrievable breakdown of marriage as a ground for the grant of divorce”. The concerns animating the Court cannot be dismissed: A protracted legal battle can take a toll on the mental, physical, and emotional well-being of the parties involved. The financial implications, too, are often serious. As the Court has rightly said, to prolong an estranged couple’s agony because their case does not meet the criteria laid out in the law amounts to “perpetuity of marriage on paper”.

The judgment serves as a reminder to both the government and Parliament that reform is long overdue. In its 2009 report, the Law Commission recommended the inclusion of IBM, and subsequently, there were two attempts at legislative reform via the Marriage Laws (Amendment) Bills of 2010 and 2013, both of which lapsed. At the same time, reform cannot overlook the realities of a deeply patriarchal society where women often enter divorce proceedings from a position of social and economic disadvantage. Protecting their interests, especially on the questions of property rights, custody, maintenance and residential rights, is paramount. Reform is necessary, but it should not become another instrument for perpetuating inequality.

When the Grand Slam crown isn’t enough

ONE WOULD have to go back three decades for the last German player to win a Grand Slam men’s singles title — Boris Becker — before Alexander Zverev beat Flavio Cobolli in five sets at Roland Garros on Sunday. The only previous instance of a German clinching the French Open men’s singles crown was Henner Henkel in 1937. And yet, more than a few would put an asterisk beside the name of Zverev.

Zverev’s path to the title wouldn’t have been easier if he had made the draw himself. Defending champion Carlos Alcaraz pulled out before the tournament due to injury. The other two major contenders — Jannik Sinner and Novak Djokovic — didn’t go past the third round. Apart from Zverev, there was only one other player ranked among the top 10 in the quarterfinals. He became the first man in 24 years to win a Grand Slam singles title without facing a single top-10 player. Then, Zverev’s conduct on and off the court hasn’t made him a favourite among tennis followers. He has been involved in more than one case of allegations of physical and emotional abuse filed by his ex-girlfriends. He has also been punished for striking an umpire’s chair with his racket at the 2022 Mexican Open.

Whether Sunday’s win turns a page in his career remains to be seen. He may have to win a Major by defeating either Sinner or Alcaraz to be considered a bona fide champion. Zverev needs to use his maiden Major title as a catalyst to take his game to the next level, or he will remain part of a large trivia group — those who have won just one Grand Slam crown.

Fifteen FTAs, 27 countries, four challenges

WITH THE India-Oman agreement taking effect on June 1, India now has 15 FTAs covering 27 countries. Another nine agreements with 42 countries are nearing completion. Once finalised, India’s FTA partners will total 69 countries and could account for nearly 75 per cent of the country’s exports.

As India expands its network of FTAs, four recurring challenges demand attention: Rising trade deficits, low utilisation of FTA benefits by Indian exporters, worsening inverted duty structures, and the relocation of manufacturing to FTA partner countries.

Let’s examine how these challenges are shaping India’s trade patterns, industrial competitiveness, and economic outcomes.

First, a rising trade deficit. Between 2007-09 (before the FTAs took effect) and 202-25, India’s trade deficit with ASEAN grew by 381 per cent, that with Japan by 318 per cent and that with South Korea by 268 per cent. In comparison, its trade deficit with the rest of the world increased by 142 per cent. Over the past three years, India’s average annual trade deficit with ASEAN, Japan and South Korea has reached about \$62 billion.

The newer FTAs are also associated with large trade deficits. In FY2025, India exported \$48.6 billion to the UAE, Australia, Mauritius and EFTA countries, but imported nearly \$100 billion, resulting in a trade deficit of over \$50 billion. As tariff cuts under these agreements deepen, the deficit may increase further. South Asia remains the major exception, where India’s trade surplus expanded from \$6.7 billion to \$20 billion during the same period.

The difference between India’s tariff structure and those of its FTA partners helps explain why imports often grow faster than exports after FTAs. Most of its FTA partners are already open economies with low tariffs. Average MFN tariffs are close to zero in Sin-

gapore and below 4 per cent in Japan, Australia, Malaysia and the UAE. In contrast, India’s trade-weighted MFN tariff is about 12.6 per cent, with rates ranging from zero to 150 per cent. As a result, when India cuts tariffs under an FTA, exporters from partner countries gain a significant price advantage in the Indian market. A 50 per cent tariff reduction, for example, can translate into a major cost advantage over competing suppliers. Indian exporters, however, often gain little additional market access because tariffs in partner countries were already low or zero before the agreement.

The difference becomes even clearer when actual trade flows are examined. Almost all imports into Singapore enter duty-free under MFN rules, while more than 80 per cent do so in Japan and Malaysia. In the EU and the UK, more than half of imports face zero customs duty. In India, however, only about 6 per cent of imports enter duty-free under MFN treatment. As a result, FTAs often give foreign exporters a much bigger advantage in the Indian market than Indian exporters receive abroad.

Second, low utilisation of FTA benefits. The same tariff asymmetry also helps explain why Indian exporters make limited use of FTAs. When MFN tariffs in partner countries are already zero, there is little benefit in exporting under an FTA. Even where MFN tariffs are low — say 1 to 3 per cent — the savings are often too small to justify the costs of complying with rules of origin, certification requirements, and paperwork. As a result, only an estimated 20-30 per cent of India’s eligible exports take advantage of FTA preferences. Many small firms prefer to avoid the compliance burden for modest tariff savings.

The incentives are very different for exporters selling to India. Since India’s MFN tariffs remain



AJAY SRIVASTAVA

When it becomes cheaper to manufacture in an ASEAN country and export duty-free to India than to produce in India, investment and jobs tend to move abroad. As a result, FTAs can encourage firms to ‘Make in ASEAN, Sell in India’

relatively high, tariff reductions under FTAs can generate substantial savings. As a result, import-side utilisation rates are estimated at 60-70 per cent. Thus, rising imports and low export-side utilisation are not separate issues. Both stem from the same tariff asymmetry between India and its FTA partners.

Third, worsening inverted duty structures. An inverted duty structure arises when duties on raw materials and industrial inputs are higher than those on finished products. While this problem has existed for years, FTAs have made it harder to fix because many finished goods now enter India at low or zero duty from partners such as ASEAN, Japan, South Korea, the UAE and Australia. As a result, Indian manufacturers often pay high duties on imported inputs, especially those sourced from non-FTA countries, while competing against finished products imported duty-free under FTAs.

For example, steel and aluminium attract MFN duties of 7.5-10 per cent, but machinery, industrial equipment and engineering products made from these materials can enter India duty-free under several FTAs. Indian manufacturers, therefore, face higher input costs when competing with tariff-free imported machinery produced with globally priced inputs.

Similar distortions exist in chemicals, plastics, rubber and textiles. Duties on inputs such as caustic soda, soda ash, polypropylene, PVC and SBR raise production costs. At the same time, many finished products in these sectors can be imported at low or zero duty. The result is a tariff structure that protects producers of basic materials but disadvantages downstream manufacturing, making it harder to achieve higher domestic value addition and the goals of Make in India.

Fourth, make in ASEAN, sell in

India. An equally significant consequence of FTAs and resulting inverted duty structures is the growing incentive for firms to manufacture outside India rather than within it. When raw materials and components attract duties in India, but finished products can be imported duty-free from FTA partners, companies may find it more profitable to locate production abroad and export back to the Indian market. In such cases, FTAs effectively encourage offshore manufacturing at the expense of domestic value addition.

ASEAN countries are increasingly becoming manufacturing hubs for supplying the Indian market. Chinese companies have invested heavily in countries such as Vietnam, Thailand and Indonesia. At the same time, some Indian firms have also set up factories and joint ventures there to benefit from lower production costs and duty-free access to India under FTAs. Similar trends can be seen in electronics, steel, chemicals, plastics, consumer goods and engineering products.

When it becomes cheaper to manufacture in an ASEAN country and export duty-free to India than to produce in India, investment and jobs tend to move abroad. As a result, FTAs can encourage firms to “Make in ASEAN, Sell in India” rather than “Make in India”.

Unless India’s tariffs on industrial inputs are better aligned with its FTA commitments, these agreements may encourage firms to produce abroad rather than in India, weakening domestic manufacturing and supply chains.

The government and industry must work together to address these four challenges so that FTAs strengthen India’s manufacturing base instead of encouraging higher imports, overseas production, and loss of industrial capacity.

The writer is founder, GTRI

On India’s EV transition, it’s time to shift gears



LAVEESH BHANDARI

POLLUTION KILLS. It is harmful to India’s reputation as a dynamic, forward-looking society, and, where vehicular pollution is concerned, the better-off pollute more, whereas the worse-off suffer more. The auto industry has historically tended to oppose policies aimed at reducing fossil-fuel vehicles due to fears of revenue losses and the cost burden of moving to new technologies. Fear of new competitors with a technological advantage may be another factor.

Such challenges will remain whether we switch now or 10 years later, and policymakers must ask: How long should the government wait? It is now time for the government to institute a comprehensive policy for a move towards electric vehicles (EVs) for both two- and four-wheelers by 2028. And in parallel, implement a plan to install the required charging points in parking lots, petrol pumps, and public spaces across the country.

The belief that such a policy will make India dependent on China is deeply flawed. First, India is a large two- and three-wheeler market. But Delhi, where EV sales are being mandated, accounts for less than 4 per cent of the national market, and therefore, the changeover will cause minimal damage to the two-wheeler economy.

Second, EVs, in fact, reduce India’s global vulnerabilities, whereas fossil-fuel vehicles increase them. Why? Because batteries and magnets are not consumables, even if their imports stop, EVs already on the road will continue to operate; this is not the case with fossil-fuel-driven vehicles.

Third, India has a mechanism for keeping petroleum stockpiles, and it can do the same for rare earths or critical minerals. Indeed, India’s National Critical Mineral Mission envisages precisely this. The Indian government highlighted in the 2026-27 budget its efforts to enhance access to critical minerals and rare earths. These efforts will need domestic demand to succeed.

Yet another concern is the potential loss of jobs associated with the repair and maintenance of fossil-fuel-driven vehicles. Here as well, the government is proposing to

stop the registration of new vehicles after 2028. All the older vehicles will continue to need the services of such mechanics. Moreover, new EVs will also create jobs for other services. Remember the concerns that accompanied computerisation in banking?

It is also sometimes argued that EVs, despite government subsidies, are more expensive and therefore delivery workers, own-account workers and others dependent on two- and three-wheelers will end up paying more. To the contrary, analysis conducted at CSEP has shown that the lifetime costs of electric two-wheelers are significantly lower than their petrol counterparts, and in fact, these workers will gain from the switch to EVs. The higher purchase cost, if a real concern, can be addressed through slight tweaks to the government’s collateral-free credit programs. The gig-work economy has already embraced electric two-wheelers.

Any policy change results in a diverse set of winners and losers. But imaginative and cooperative actions can create win-win solutions. The Indian automobile sector includes some of the most respected firms in India. And these firms can and must come up with a forward-looking and solution-oriented plan.

They will no doubt face stranded assets as production lines shift from internal combustion engine vehicles to electric vehicles. For this, they could ask the government for accelerated depreciation. Dependence on China is a concern, and the industry needs to ramp up R&D spending for that.

The industry could also work with the government on interim stockpiling solutions. It should be proposing innovative ideas for ramping up charging facilities; bringing utility companies into the conversation would help, since they would be a major gainer. Reuse and recycling of batteries is another challenge area, and here as well, there are many ways in which the industry can use its extensive networks to support the government’s efforts.

India needs to change, but this would be best achieved when industry and government are able to create a collaborative and socially oriented relationship.

Bhandari heads CSEP. Views are personal

Indian art can’t dwell in the past. Put today’s artists at the centre



TRISHA MUKHERJEE

THIS IS Indian art’s golden moment. Having made a big splash at the Venice Biennale, it is ready for its next milestone: ‘The Meeting Ground’ exhibition, presented by the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art (KNMA) at Christie’s London. A survey bridging “modern and contemporary practices with folk and indigenous artistic traditions from South Asia”, it is perhaps the biggest showcase of Indian artists since ‘The Imaginary Institution of India: Art 1975-1998’ in London in 2024. Such exhibitions are cultural milestones that declare to the world: This is Indian art.

It is. Except, that is not all it should be. Indian art today is vast, yet we keep circling back to a few 20th-century names, mostly from the Progressive Artists’ Group. While this canon earned Indian art its global recognition, returning to them for nearly every international presentation stagnates the narrative. The KNMA show tries to diversify by including folk and indigenous traditions through the works of Jangarh Singh Shyam and Jivya Soma Mashe. However, it remains led by modernists like M F Husain, S H Raza, and Jeram Patel, with senior contemporary artists like Neha Choksi, L N Tallur and Simryn Gill presented as inheritors of this legacy, almost to suggest India’s best art is in its archives.

That is especially perplexing because KNMA holds “cutting-edge, experimental practices across multimedia, including video, photography, monumental installations and new media” in its collection, but these rarely make it across borders. The urge to put your best foot forward with a time-tested strategy is understandable, but by offering international audiences what they are already familiar with, we inadvertently create a bottleneck.

By placing our faith in the past rather than the present, we feed into the market’s insular loops. This is evident in how recent record-breaking Indian works — Raja Ravi Varma’s *Yashoda and Krishna* (1890s) and M F Husain’s *Gram Yatra* (1954) — were scooped up by domestic HNWIs (Cyrus Poonawalla and Kiran Nadar respectively), conditioning the world to look at Indian art as a repatriation asset rather than an evolving ecosystem engaging with contemporary realities. Meanwhile, the international market for mid-career or emerging Indian artists remains flat.

South Korea, which has used both government and private institutional heft to balance the global spotlight between masters and emerging names (like 28-year-old Minhoon Kim), can be a blueprint. Closer to home, look at this year’s Venice Biennale showcase with younger names like Sumakshi Singh and Skarma Sonam Tashi, or the exhibition, ‘Sediments of Becoming’, at the Hermitage Museum in St Petersburg. Instead of spotlighting the modernists yet again, co-curator Tuntty Chauhan chose to lead with the voices of the young and the present, putting forth Indian art as a continuum of creativity and dialogue.

This is not to say the masters should no longer be showcased internationally. They have to be seen as the prologue, not the main act. If we do not position our young contemporary artists as the vanguard, we cannot expect the rest of the world to do it for us.

The writer is associate editor, The Indian Express. trisha.mukherjee@expressindia.com

40 YEARS AGO

June 9, 1986



Terrorists kill three in Punjab

THREE PERSONS were shot dead, and three others were injured in shootouts by suspected terrorists in Punjab in the past 24 hours. According to UNI, three armed terrorists came to Bhatinda railway station on foot and robbed the cashier of the accounts department of Rs 1.27 lakh; no one was injured.

Action after Belgaum riots

HOME MINISTER B Rachaiah, accompanied by Revenue Minister S R Bommai, the Social Welfare Minister V L Patil and Minister of State

for Health D B Inamdar arrived in Belgaum to inspect the riot-hit district. Rachaiah said the team would submit its report to CM Ramakrishna Hegde. Addressing a peace committee meeting, he warned that strict action would be taken against lawbreakers.

Tamils flee homes in Sri Lanka

MORE THAN 1,000 people, the majority of them Tamils of Indian origin, have fled their homes in Kilinochchi in northern Sri Lanka following intermittent clashes between Tamil militants and security forces since June 4. The displaced people, who have taken refuge

in temples and nearby jungles, were facing an acute shortage of food.

AGP slams Centre over accord

THE ASOM Gana Parishad has criticised the Centre over the non-implementation of the Assam Accord and has threatened to launch an action programme. The party said that if the Centre did not take steps to implement the provisions, it would mobilise public opinion for a suitable programme of action. The AGP’s central committee described the Union government’s role in implementing the accord as “extremely disappointing.”



● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Mr Trump's efforts threaten American democracy, and the selection of the unqualified Mr Pulte increases the threat. — *The New York Times*



KANTI BAJPAI

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio's recent visit to India, Secretary of War Peter Hegseth's speech at the Shangri-La Dialogue that briefly referenced India, and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gorr's energetic diplomacy have raised a central question: What does India want from the US, and what does the US want from India? The answer is that India's wants have remained stable. America's have changed. As a result, the special relationship with the US is over. Looking ahead, the India-US agenda will be far more modest and transactional.

For 30 years, India looked to the US for strategic balance against China, for cooperation against terrorism, for its market and investments, for the "export" of skilled Indian professionals, and for military equipment. Broadly, the US would help make India more secure and powerful.

US interest in India was a mirror image. India was a balance against China, a partner against terrorism, a market for exports and a destination for investments, a source of human talent, and a client for American arms. India was not seen as an ally but instead would be strengthened as a "strategic partner" in Asia.

The special relationship has withered because America has changed its view of India. The economic wants are much the same — India as a destination for US products (now including energy), investments, and arms. Against this, American worries about immigration have overridden the demand for talented Indians. More importantly, cooperating with India against terrorism, and crucially, partnering with it in Asia, have diminished in importance.

To appreciate the US's changed strategic outlook towards India, we must

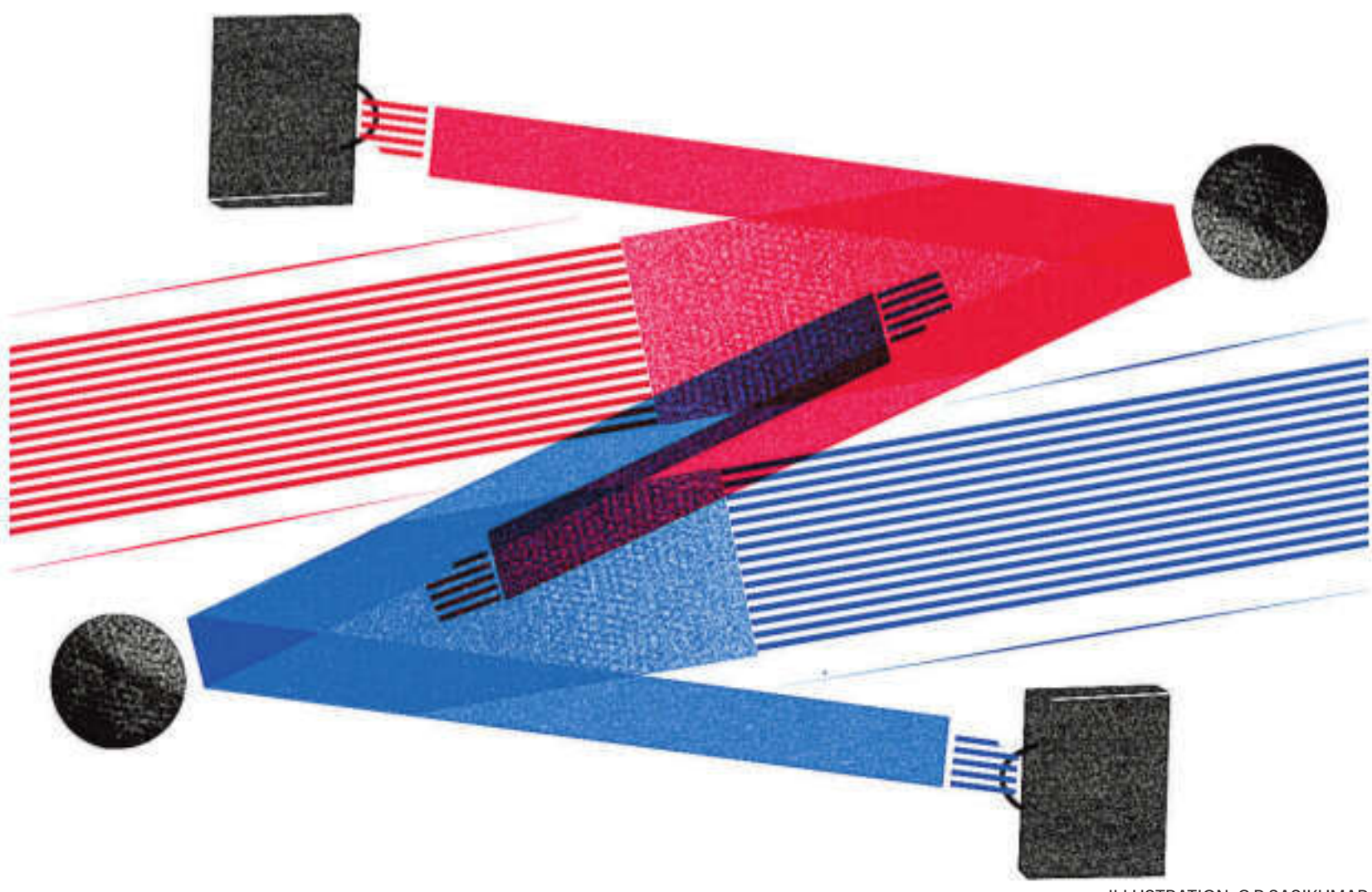


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

understand its geopolitical view of Eurasia — from Europe, at one end of the supercontinent, to Japan, at the other end. Over the last 30 years (indeed, going back earlier), America has wanted to contain three challenges in Eurasia: Russia in Europe; Islamic radicalism in the energy-rich Gulf, and China in Asia.

For the US, India potentially had a role in all three theatres. With its close Russia relationship, it might act as a diplomatic brake against Russian adventurism in Europe. Given its proximity to the Gulf, its energy dependence on the oil powers, and its military power, it might be a force for stability in the region. And given Delhi's quarrel with Beijing, its growing economic strength, and its naval forces, it was a putative balancer against rapidly rising Chinese power in Asia.

The war in Ukraine demonstrated to the US that India would be no brake on Russia. Indeed, with its neutrality in the conflict and its purchases of Russian oil,

To appreciate the US's changed strategic outlook towards India, we must understand its geopolitical view of Eurasia — from Europe, at one end of the supercontinent, to Japan, at the other end

it seemed to play the opposite role even if that was not New Delhi's intention. In the Gulf, India embarked on a larger strategic role, particularly in the past 10 years. Prime Minister Narendra Modi built deeper diplomatic, economic, energy, and even defence ties with the Gulf including Saudi Arabia, and was positioning India as a security provider.

However, when the US's war with Iran moved towards termination and a deal had to be struck on Iran's enriched uranium and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, the Trump administration saw Pakistan and not India as the intermediary.

Pakistani influence with the Iranians and with the Saudis (culminating in the defence agreement of September 2025) was a key asset for Pakistan. Its military power, its long-held relationship with the US defence establishment, and even its closeness to China were additional factors in the turn to Pakistan.

The third Eurasian theatre is centred around China. The US

had hoped that India would begin to catch up with China and play a larger balancing role against it. But despite India's economic growth of roughly 6-7 per cent per annum over 30 years and China's economic slowdown, the absolute GDP gap between the two countries was growing, not reducing.

In addition, in the Indo-Pacific, India's contributions were uncertain. India had underlined that it was averse to a common front against China in the Quad. Australia, Japan, and the US, therefore, gradually thickened strategic ties amongst themselves and with Korea and the Philippines. In addition, India's military was not geared to project force into the South China Sea and East China Sea in the foreseeable future. At best, in a US-China confrontation, the US-India foundational defence accords such as LEMOA might be triggered, but this was by no means a given.

More fundamentally for India-US ties, under both Joe Biden and Donald Trump, America's China challenge has changed. It is less about Taiwan and the security of Asia against China and more about economic and technological competition in commerce (the trade deficit), chips, computer software (AI), and critical minerals. In the US view, India is not a crucial player in any of these four Cs. It cannot replace China as an exporter to the US (indeed, India is now a trade worry). Nor is it a big player in chips, AI computer software, or critical minerals.

Whether the US is right or wrong in its view, India is no longer seen as a power to be strengthened. It is instead a destination for US products, investments, and arms. Despite Rubio and Gorr's and most recently Hegseth's attempts to inject some spark into the erstwhile special relationship, the future is cold-eyed transactionalism. Opportunities but also stern challenges are ahead of us as the special relationship founders. Indian diplomats will have their hands full.

The writer is visiting professor, International Relations, Ashoka University, and emeritus professor, Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore

Under Modi government, states have more space to grow



N CHANDRABABU NAIDU

JUNE 10, 2026, marks 4,399 consecutive days of Narendra Modi's prime ministership. This milestone reflects the enduring trust that millions of Indians have placed in a model of governance anchored in the principle of "Nation First".

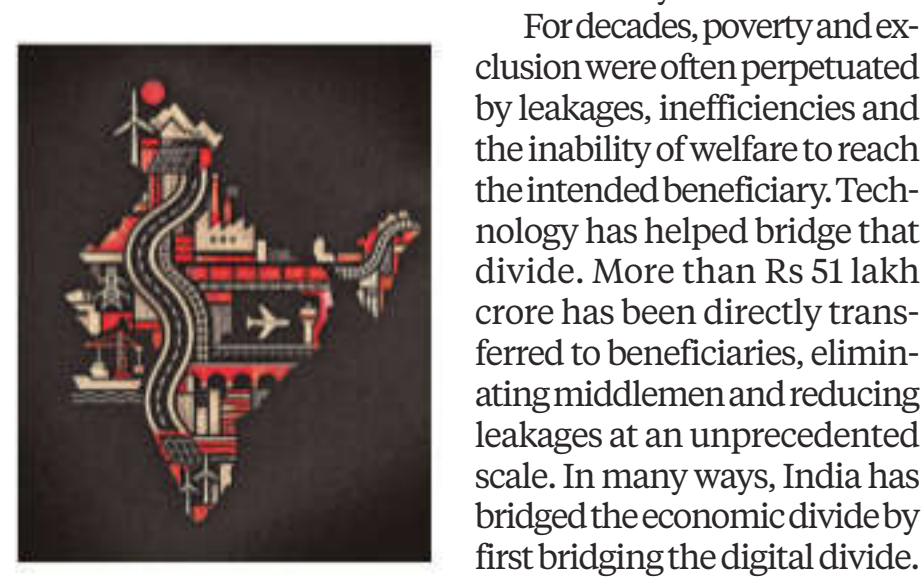
In my nearly five decades in public life, I have had the opportunity to observe and interact with several prime ministers, each of whom led India through distinct challenges and circumstances. But PM Modi stands apart because he has combined civilisational confidence with modern governance.

India was once among the world's richest and most advanced civilisations. Yet, for many decades after Independence, we often behaved like a sleeping giant, hesitant about our identity and uncertain of our place in the world. Under PM Modi's leadership, India has rediscovered its cultural pride and national self-belief.

India today stands with far greater confidence and strategic relevance in the global order. PM Modi has ensured that India engages with the world as an equal among major powers, always guided by the principle of India First.

This revival has not been rooted in nostalgia alone. PM Modi has integrated India's ancient knowledge systems — yoga, *pranayama*, meditation and spiritual traditions — with modern technology, digital governance and innovation-led growth. This synthesis of tradition and technology may well become India's defining contribution to the 21st century. The global acceptance of yoga through the International Day of Yoga is perhaps one of the most visible examples of how India's ancient wisdom has been repositioned as a universal force for human well-being.

In a decade, India has moved from the world's 11th-largest to the fourth-largest economy. The defining feature of these 12 years has been governance driven by conviction and execution. Through DPI, Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar integration, UPI and Direct Benefit Transfers, India has undertaken one of the largest financial inclusion exercises in human history.



Equally significant has been the scale of social transformation. Millions of Indians have been lifted out of multidimensional poverty; investments in housing, sanitation, healthcare, water and rural infrastructure have improved the quality of life for millions. The guiding principle has remained clear: *Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas*.

At a time when the world has faced unprecedented disruptions, from the pandemic and supply-chain shocks to geopolitical conflicts and economic uncertainty, India has remained resilient, stable and among the fastest-growing major economies.

PM Modi has also focussed on long-term nation-building through transformational investments in highways, ports, airports, freight corridors, railways, renewable energy, manufacturing and emerging technologies. These are not decisions made for immediate political gain, but foundational investments.

As someone who has long championed technology-driven governance and economic reforms, I particularly appreciate PM Modi's understanding of how innovation and entrepreneurship can transform society. Young Indians no longer merely seek opportunities abroad; increasingly, they aspire to build world-class enterprises within India itself.

Another important transformation has been in the relationship between the Union and states. Competitive and cooperative federalism has given states greater space to innovate, compete and grow. States are increasingly being treated as engines of national development rather than mere administrative units. Andhra Pradesh has greatly benefitted from this development-oriented partnership through projects relating to infrastructure, industrialisation, Amaravati and emerging technologies.

I have often said that Narendra Modi was the right leader at the right time for India. After 12 years, that conviction has only strengthened further. History will remember this period not merely for economic growth or political stability, but for something deeper — the restoration of India's confidence in itself.

I believe this is India's defining moment; the beginning of a golden era for our nation. With confidence, aspiration and collective resolve, I am certain that India will march steadily towards the goal of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Jai Hind.

The writer is Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Economy challenge

A 7.7 PER cent growth rate in a year marked by tariff disruptions and conflict is an achievement, and the government's role in supporting it deserves recognition ('Facing stress, economy will need a leg up', *IE*, June 8). The RBI's revised projection of 6.6 per cent growth for 2026-27 reflects external headwinds rather than structural weakness. Measures to attract foreign capital and stabilise the rupee are timely. If the situation in West Asia stabilises and the monsoon remains favourable, the economy has resilience to outperform current projections.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

INDIA'S ECONOMY grew rapidly last year, but trouble lies beneath the surface ('Facing stress, economy will need a leg up', *IE*, June 8). The services sector performed well and pushed growth to 7.7 per cent, yet total income rose by only 8.9 per cent, well below the budgeted target of 10.1 per cent. Manufacturing growth slowed. Wars in West Asia and new tariffs have made oil and other goods more expensive. The RBI now expects growth to moderate to 6.6 per cent this year. Tax cuts and lower interest rates provided support earlier, but more needs to be done. To sustain growth, India must create jobs, expand manufacturing, reduce import dependence, and protect farmers.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Another price hike

THE CENTRE'S justification for the latest LPG price hike of Rs 29 per cylinder may be sound on paper, but it overlooks the growing financial strain on ordinary households ('Domestic LPG price up Rs 29; OMCs still losing Rs 700: Govt', *IE*, June 8). Clean cooking fuel is a necessity, not a luxury. Frequent price increases may force poorer households to revert to traditional fuels such as firewood and coal, undermining public-health and environmental goals.

Sanjay Chopra, Mohali



SUKHMANI MALIK

WOMEN ARE sick of the manosphere. And many want out — even if it is into a fantasy where men treat them with respect. The explosion of one show and one movie, both about desire and women's agency, in the last month is evidence: *Off Campus*, adapted from Elle Kennedy's book series of the same name, and Curry Barker's *Obsession*. Made on shoestring budgets, poles apart tonally, both are surprise hits. While *Off Campus* portrays the fantasy of romance, *Obsession* is its most horrific representation, but both aim to address reality.

Off Campus is the story of a handful of college students' trysts with love, friendship, family, and ambition. Viewers — especially women — are eating it up. It is another in the long list of shows and movies that constitute the on-screen romance renaissance; recent years have seen a significant surge in romance shows and movies in the West. But why?

In *Off Campus*, the main draw is the men. They are college students and hockey players, yet there is no "locker room talk". In a time when an alarming number of men are congregating in the "manosphere" and mistaking misogyny for masculinity, these male protagonists are caring and attentive partners and people, in touch with their own feelings and others'.

For many men and boys today, the strongest influences are figures like Donald Trump

Success of 'Off Campus' suggests that standards are not being met by men today. This is why bare minimum becomes fantasy. The 'romance renaissance' reflects a lack of agency, compatibility

and Andrew Tate (both under investigation and/or convicted of sexual assault). This does not bode well for anybody. The echo chambers of the "manosphere" amplify the delusional narrative that young boys and men are somehow both perpetual victims and inherently more powerful than women. Qualities like sensitivity and respect are derided, cutting off the most organic routes to connection, the lack of which drives many men into the manosphere in the first place.

The success of shows like *Off Campus*, *Heated Rivalry*, and *Bridgerton* also suggests that these standards are hardly being met by men today. This is why the bare minimum has become a fantasy. The "romance renaissance" reflects, in reality, a lack of agency, respect, hope, and compatibility for women. What many men and women think constitutes a good relationship today — or even an appropriate performance of gender — is increasingly divergent.

For most women, the world is a scary place right now. Violence against them is on the rise, young men are more likely to lean conservative than many in the generations before them, there is a rollback in legal protections globally, and it often seems as though young women and men are living in different realities. No wonder there is a desire to escape into fantasy.

Which brings us to *Obsession*. The movie, a horror film focused

on incel culture, deals with the deficit of empathy and the spike in male entitlement. It captures how harmless and routine this attitude can look and how it escalates. Look closely at the film, and you'll notice: The violations were always there. Even when Bear (Michael Johnston) seemed to be just a "nice guy" with a crush on a girl in his friend circle, his obsession with winning Nikki's (Inde Navarrette) love had everything to do with him and nothing at all with her. This is why he feels comfortable, from the beginning, in denying her agency and, in the end, any mercy — all while playing the victim. When a section of society is raised to think of another as secondary to their needs, this is the result: Rejection becomes unacceptable, unrequited love becomes humiliation.

When the credits roll, it is to the wails of a bleeding, traumatised woman. The damage is apparent; it also does not discriminate — the entitled, the alphas, suffer and break just as hard as the women and people they subject to violence.

In the hardening of their attitudes, many men risk losing their humanity. While that is a worrying reality for women and society, it leaves the men depleted, too. There is no escaping the manosphere. The best we can hope for is a mass exit into reality. Until then, it will keep ending this way — with no winners at all.

The writer is sub-editor, The Indian Express. sukhmani.malik@expressindia.com

No escaping manosphere for women — and men

The Joe Sacco book that India should, but can't, read

farnagar riots of 2013, rejected for distribution in the country by Penguin India is shocking given his longstanding credibility as an artist and journalist. While technicalities such as one particular image of a hand-drawn map and its accuracy are cited as reasons, it does make one wonder what kind of precedent this sets for artists and writers who take on the task of researching and truth-telling in India today.

In an interview, Sacco said a lot of his research was done by conducting interviews in Muzaffarnagar after the riots and speaking with journalists who had been reporting on them. It involved continuously fact-checking the stories he heard. Across various panels in the book, we can see a skeptical Sacco leaving conversations, only to question the truth of what he's being told, such as by upper-caste leaders in a particu-

lar village. For Sacco, part of what kept him writing and drawing this book over many years was that he felt he had "troubled people for their stories" and had to honour that somehow. As with his previous books, we have Sacco's own drawn-out cartoon character across pages, with a notebook and pen in hand and often looking bewildered and overwhelmed, leading us through the landscape and conversations. This method, along with the fact that each page is elaborately hand-drawn across the book, re-

To have his book investigating the 2013 Muzaffarnagar riots rejected for distribution in India is shocking given his longstanding credibility as a journalist

peatedly reinforces for a reader that the work is one person's storytelling and research. It is precisely this play between personal and political, objective and affective, that makes comics journalism so appealing.

It also inserts the researcher as a human being sitting within conversations and untangling messy webs of stories instead of being an all-knowing and all-powerful entity. In that, the comics journalism format as Sacco has shown us, with all its messiness of boxes, characters, speech bubbles and descriptive text boxes, tries to grapple with the complexities of violence and its conflicting histories without flattening it out to a single narrative.

It has the unique ability to hold contradictions, personal narratives as well as the larger landscape of overarching politics, all on one page. It does so by also laying out the

position of the artist-guide bare across the page, and inviting the viewer right into it, to walk along, with bits of dry humour to keep you going.

Reading Sacco's work is how so many comics makers have understood the very grammar of this medium. Especially in a country like ours, where there aren't many avenues to train oneself in comics journalism, it becomes all the more important to have his books easily accessible. Without works like this around, what kind of visual storytelling is going to surround us — do we really need yet another sci-fi mythological reinterpretation cramming bookstore shelves?

Mehrotra is a graphic novelist and educator based in Delhi and author of Uprooted: A Graphic Account of the Struggle for Forest Rights



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• GLOBAL

Israel, Iran trade strikes again: The major takeaways

Yashee
New Delhi, June 8

ALMOST TWO months after a Pakistan-brokered ceasefire, Iran and Israel traded direct strikes at each other's territories again, over Sunday night and Monday. For a while, return to full-scale war looked imminent, till Iran announced it was halting its campaign as long as Israel too kept the peace. US President Donald Trump announced on Truth Social that "Both sides, Israel and Iran, are looking to do an immediate CEASEFIRE!". He said "final negotiations" for peace were proceeding, "subject to ignorance or stupidity getting in its way."

What was different was that Iran launched attacks directly on Israel in retaliation for the latter's actions in Lebanon. As multiple conflicts rage — Israeli action in Gaza, Israeli action in Lebanon, and the US-Israel-Iran tussle, with Iran's retaliation covering much of West Asia — what do the events of the past day say about the future of the wars?

Iran entrenches Lebanon position: Iran has always said that any peace deal must include Lebanon too, but the Israeli campaign there continues despite multiple announcements of ceasefires. With the strikes on Sunday night, Iran has made it clear that it is willing to go beyond statements on Lebanon. It has asserted that a one-on-one peace deal with the US is not possible till Washington continues to give Benjamin Netanyahu a free hand in Lebanon.

Trump-Netanyahu divide: A major fallout of the recent events is the question they raise on Trump's ability to get Netanyahu to uphold American commitments. Despite Trump announcing multiple times that he would rein in Israel, including in Lebanon, Netanyahu has continued to escalate.

Both Trump and Netanyahu face elections later this year. For Trump, a prolonged war and its attendant economic consequences are damaging. But for the Israeli leader, stopping the campaign now under pressure from Trump would dent his image domestically.

• ELECTION YEAR

Both Trump and Netanyahu face elections later this year. For Trump, a prolonged war and its attendant economic consequences are damaging. But for the Israeli leader, stopping the campaign now under pressure from Trump would dent his image domestically.

teaches International Relations at the Ankara Yildirim Beyazit University, Türkiye, told *The Indian Express*.

Lebanese govt in uncomfortable position: The events also complicate the position of the Lebanese government, which is holding official peace talks with Israel. Beirut would prefer less influence from Tehran and its proxy Hezbollah on its actions, but the opposite will happen if a ceasefire does come to Lebanon on the point of Iranian guns.

Despite several rounds of talks with Israel, being mediated by the US, the Lebanese government has been unable to stop strikes on its soil.

"The recent Iranian actions complicate negotiations between Israel and Lebanon, but for the mediator US, this is apparently acceptable in the larger geopolitical context. Trump is willing to speak to Hezbollah as well as the Lebanese government for a ceasefire. Hence, today's strikes by Iran cause collateral damage to the autonomy of the Lebanese government," Anil Trigunayat, retired IFS officer who has worked in the Ministry of External Affairs' West Asia Division, told *The Indian Express*.



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• POLICY

Sewage in posh Delhi colony taps: How urban water systems fail, what to change



EXPERT EXPLAINS
ARKAJA SINGH

FELLOW AT CENTRE FOR POLICY RESEARCH, NEW DELHI

IN THE posh South Delhi colony of Gulmohar Park, drinking water pipelines recently delivered sewage-contaminated water. Many residents fell ill and people had to switch to water tankers and bottled water.

Several similar incidents have been reported in other cities. In the Indore case earlier this year, the contamination was linked to several deaths.

From an engineering perspective, the risk of contamination in drinking water pipelines

is almost always present: sewage water can enter through even minor openings, especially when supply is off and the pressure in the pipes is slack. Things get worse when the pipe network is aged and corroded, when pipes are damaged, or when sewage flows and other contaminants enter areas around the pipes.

There are two important policy takeaways from this. One, that the risk of contamination can only be managed, rather than completely eliminated. Second, as the risk is from the close interaction of sewage and drinking water pipes, management requires attention to both.

Governance of drinking water and sewage

Our drinking water supply and sewage disposal systems entail very many neighbourhood-level compromises with engineering protocol.

Engineers consider 24-hour water supply system technically superior to intermittent supply—because pipes remain pressurised

and resistant to contaminants — but this requires more water and expensive upgrades in the infrastructure.

Moreover, the true state of pipes and networks is never fully known. Except in a few 'pilot projects', Indian cities do not have complete digitised maps of water and sewage flows. The field staff of urban agencies might know, by experience, how the supply and drainage infrastructure is organised at the local level, but often, their understanding of local risks is not integrated with institutional decisions and priorities.

The management of sewage is even more complicated and is, at least in part, beyond the direct control and management of any public agency. Even in the most upmarket areas, sewage flows are 'bypassed' from blocked or missing sewer lines to storm water drains and natural water channels. Over half the urban population does not have access to any type of organised sewage line, and relies instead on septic tanks and pits, which generate foul effluent liquids that seem to have no practical solution, except to

flow in open drains and water channels.

Slums, unauthorised colonies and urban villages provide additional layers of complexity: one, because rules prevent urban agencies from extending full-scale water and sewage services here (supposedly to disincentivise the proliferation of such settlements) and two, because their winding, narrow and uneven layouts are difficult to build infrastructure for.

In many cities, many government agencies are responsible for different parts of the same problem, and have limited ability to coordinate at the street-level.

Institutional gaps and challenges

There are national environmental law-mandated standards for what constitutes safe drinking water and sewage discharge, but there are considerable institutional lacunae in how this can be realistically delivered.

The right to safe drinking water is loosely defined as part of the constitutionally mandated right to life, but there no clear rules

about how it is to be secured.

Sewage discharge standards apply to the point of discharge from sewerage treatment plants, but do not prescribe how it is to be managed before it reaches a treatment facility. The regulations for sewerage that is not connected to sewage lines are just as hard to pin down. We need to differentiate between environmental law, by which water quality standards are prescribed for drinking water and sewerage treatment, and institutional rules that structure service delivery and infrastructural activities of urban agencies.

This latter space is thinly developed: there are a number of codes of practice and standards issued by government agencies, but they are not legally enforceable and do not always account for the real-world conditions in which they are to be implemented. Naturally, a one-size fits all protocol might not work, given the variations of conditions across and within cities.

The question of whether water and wastewater are managed by a parastatal agency like the Delhi Jal Board, or by an

elected civic body, like the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation, is often raised. But one structure is not necessarily better than the other. Outcomes seem to depend more on the culture of the organisation, and the quality of its leadership, both administrative and political. In practice, state governments also seem to have an important role in providing structure and support to the efforts of their local authorities.

The way forward

Another aspect of the safe water issue is that it cannot be prescribed in one shot, by plan or regulation, but needs rather a structured pathway in which real-time public management improvements can be deployed in sync with administratively issued regulations and notified plans.

There is a large gap between engineering best practice and the situation in our cities, which can only be addressed in a multi-year framework that prioritises the most urgent improvements to human health and environmental outcomes from year to year.

• ENERGY

The boost Centre's solar power schemes need



AMITABH SINHA

INDIA HAS been rapidly scaling up its renewable energy capacity in recent years. This has been led by solar power, which now accounts for close to 30% of India's total installed electricity capacity. The country added more than 50 gigawatts (GW) of solar energy capacity in the last couple of years and, in 2025, added more solar power than any other country in the world except China.

To further expedite the deployment of solar energy, the government has been running two flagship programmes that incentivise the adoption of decentralised solar power generation:

PM Suryaghar Yojana: This targets installation of rooftop solar units on one crore households. It offers every beneficiary free electricity up to 300 units every month, and cash subsidy for equipment.

PM-KUSUM (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha Evam Utthan Mahabhyan): Aimed at farmers, the scheme helps them set up small solar plants on their unused land, or install grid-connected or standalone solar water pumps for irrigation needs. Farmers can earn additional income by selling solar electricity produced on their land, or save on diesel or power bills on traditional water pumps.

Both schemes, backed by a combined budget of around Rs 95,000 crore, have had their successes, but have performed well below their full potential till now.

• CULTURE

Together, the two programmes have seen installation of about 13 GW of decentralised solar power (as on May 31, 2026) against a target of 40 GW by the end of the current financial year.

PM-KUSUM, launched in 2019, was supposed to achieve its targets by 2022, but was extended till the end of this financial year owing to the pandemic disruption. Its most successful component has been the incentive to farmers to set up standalone, off-grid, solar water pumps. Government

• STATUS OF FLAGSHIP PROGRAMMES



• PM Suryaghar Yojana

Target	Achieved
Connection to 1 crore households	40.52 lakh
30 GW of installed capacity	12 GW

(AS ON MAY 31, 2026). SCHEME RUNS TILL

MARCH 2027 SOURCE: PM SURYAGHAR PORTAL

• PM-KUSUM

Target	Achieved
10 GW of decentralised solar capacity	1.2 GW
14 lakh standalone solar water pumps	10.9 lakh
Solarisation of 2.5 lakh grid pumps	15,000

SOURCE: PM-KUSUM PORTAL

figures show as on May 31, 2026, that more than 10.9 lakh new pumps have been installed against the target of 14 lakh.

But the uneven progress of these programmes across different states is quite revealing, as they have done very well in certain states and extremely poor in others.

Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Kerala have seen significantly higher offtake rates for the PM Suryaghar rooftop solar scheme compared with states such as Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, or even the relatively low energy-access states of Bihar and Jharkhand. The five best performing states — Gujarat, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Kerala, and Rajasthan — account for nearly 70% of the nearly 33 lakh rooftop installations so far.

What hinders adoption

One of the main reasons for low adoption of these schemes in certain large states is power subsidies. Several state governments offer either free electricity or highly subsidised power to domestic and agricultural consumers. When electricity is already free, or heavily subsidised, people don't have an incentive to spend on upfront installation costs.

Take Punjab, for instance. It already offers 300 units of free electricity to domestic

Demand and supply

The rising electricity demand can only be met by further expansion of solar and other renewables.

Recent peak demands — in April and May this year during the day — were managed largely through solar power.

consumers every month, and completely free power for all agricultural tubewells. Punjab, which spent more than Rs 20,000 crore on power subsidy bills last year, has low adoption rates for both schemes.

The relatively low offtake of PM Suryaghar in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Delhi is also attributed to their subsidy structure. Last year, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu had electricity subsidy bills of Rs 27,000 crore and Rs 15,700 crore, respectively. Gujarat, Kerala, and Maharashtra, on the other hand, have relatively high tariff rates, particularly for high consuming customers.

The Estimates Committee of Parliament flagged this issue in a recent report on the progress of these two schemes. The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy told the committee that one of the primary reasons for low adoption of PM Suryaghar in some states was free electricity already being offered.

The upfront cost of equipment can be a few lakh rupees, which can only be recovered over time through the use of 300 units of free electricity and sale of excess power being produced.

More subsidies

Ironically, the response to this hurdle has

Incentivising households and farmers is crucial to India's clean energy transition. But high upfront costs can be a challenge

been more subsidies. Although states such as UP and Rajasthan offer highly subsidised power, they have still managed to do remarkably well on both schemes, mainly by offering additional financial incentives to facilitate the switch to solar power.

This makes sense, as such incentives are a one-time expenditure as against the unending recurring liability that power subsidies entail.

The Estimates Committee seemed to endorse this. It suggested that the government should explore ways to make it easier for the consumers to pay the upfront costs in the two schemes and avail of the benefits.

The heat link

Decentralised solar power generation is crucial to India's clean energy transition. While power demand is expected to continue to rise substantially in the coming decades, the availability of land for setting up large solar parks is already becoming a problem. Also, electricity coming in from the grid — even if contributed by solar energy — would have to be subsidised for consumers.

That is one politically sensitive issue no government would be able to withdraw from, even though subsidies are becoming increasingly unsustainable. The PM Suryaghar programme, if fully implemented, is estimated to save the government about Rs 75,000 crore every year in electricity costs, according to the Estimates Committee report.

The rising electricity demand can only be met by further expansion of solar, and other renewables. Solar is all set to become India's second-largest source of electricity generation by taking over from hydroelectricity. Although hydropower was the go-to source for meeting the additional demand during summer, large hydropower capacity has stagnated now.

In any case, the increase in power demand has gone so high, it cannot be met with hydropower alone. Recent peak demands — in April and May this year during the day — were managed largely through solar power.

Decentralised solar power gets increasingly relevant in a year like the current one, when the rainfall is expected to be low and temperatures very high, resulting in very high power demands. And this year is not an isolated case: such situations are fast becoming the norm, and decentralisation can help in cushioning the impact.

• CULTURE

Pride Month: Recalling India's first 'Friendship Walk', its impact

Rishika Singh
New Delhi, June 8

JUNE IS marked as Pride Month annually to celebrate the LGBTQ+ community and raise awareness about the challenges they continue to face.

It can be traced back to June 1969, when a police raid at the Stonewall Inn, a popular gathering space for queer people in New York City, saw a pushback against the authorities. This was a landmark moment for the fight for civil rights.

The Pride Parade, which sees queer people and their supporters march, dance and raise slogans, has become one of the most well-known Pride month events. According to the US Library of Congress, "There were three to five thousand marchers at the inaugural Pride in New York City, and today marchers in New York City number in the millions." In India, the "Friendship Walk" of July 2, 1999, held in Kolkata, is seen as a precursor to the Pride Parade.

Inspiration from history

Pawan Dhall, a managing trustee at the Kolkata-based gender and sexuality plat-



A photo from the 'Friendship Walk' in Kolkata on July 2, 1999. LGBT-INDIA

form Varta Trust, was one of the 15 people who participated in the walk. He told *The Indian Express* that the movement was in its early stages, but both English and Bengali media were covering it.

Dhall described 1999 as a "very happening year" for queer Indians, coming soon after the release of Shabana Azmi and Nandita Das-starrer *Fire*, which told the story of a romantic relationship between two women. It drew protests from groups like the Shiv Sena. "Some news articles at the time projected regressive views on homosexuality," Dhall said. In response, the few active LGBTQ+ groups organised events for

dialogue in the face of misinformation.

Eventually, Owais Khan, a convenor of an LGBTQ group, came up with the idea of a "Friendship Walk", inspired not just by the activism since Stonewall but something closer to home — the Dandi March. "I proposed that we talk about bridge-building and friendship, because we are coming out into the public," Dhall said of the name given to the event. It could also be difficult to secure police permission for a full-scale parade. Yellow t-shirts were made, saying "Walk on the Rainbow, Friendship Walk 99."

Relevance today

The group assembled at the Park Circus Maidan and then split into two to visit NGOs and government offices to discuss the community's concerns.

"We pasted some HIV-AIDS stickers in public washrooms, and also visited the Human Rights Commission office. One official was totally surprised because we had reached without an appointment. We left him with copies of queer magazines like *Pravartak* and *Bombay Dost*, Dhall said.

A few major papers did cover the walk at the time, but Dhall said he felt its impact

FII TAX CUTS AIMED AT BLOOMBERG INDEX INCLUSION: GOVT SOURCE

‘Confident of high growth in Q1 despite elevated energy prices’

Siddharth Upasani & Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, June 8

DESPITE ENERGY prices remaining elevated due to the war in West Asia, the government is confident the economy has continued to perform well in the ongoing April-June quarter, with the high growth seen in January-March spilling over into the new fiscal year that started in April, a senior official told *The Indian Express* on the condition of anonymity.

Further, the tax cuts announced last week for foreign institutional investors’ (FIIs) investments in government bonds were squarely aimed at accelerating India’s inclusion in the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index, with the source adding that more steps will continue to be taken to attract foreign inflows. There was no elaboration of the measures that would be taken.

“The feedback that we are getting from industry and banks is that growth from the fourth quarter has continued into April-June and it is reflecting in economic data,” the official said. “Be it cement, production of cars, Fast Moving Consumer Goods, and even consumer durables, there is clear indication that growth is

sustaining despite the problems emanating from outside India.”

“Even GST collections, the revenue from imports has jumped almost 20%. And this is not because consumer goods are being imported in huge numbers — it is intermediate goods, machinery, inputs that industry uses that are being purchased from abroad,” the source added.

Data released last week showed the Indian economy ended 2025-26 on an unexpectedly strong note, with the GDP estimated to have grown 7.8% in January-March on the back of higher growth in investments despite the war overlapping with the final month. For the year as a whole, India’s GDP has been estimated to have increased by 7.7%, higher than the statistics ministry’s second advance estimate of 7.6%, announced in February.

India’s GDP growth in 2024-25 was 7.1%. Moreover, while overall Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections rose only 3% year-on-year in May, that from imports surged 19.1%. Further, industrial growth rose to 4.9%, with manufacturing sector growth at 6.2%.

Meanwhile, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday lowered its GDP growth forecast for 2026-27 by 30 basis points

• GROWTH MOMENTUM

LAST WEEK’S data showed the economy ended 2025-26 on an unexpectedly strong note, with GDP estimated to have grown 7.8% in January-March on the back of higher growth in investments

A VARIETY of economic indicators, including automobiles production and GST collections, are indicating to the government high growth has sustained into the April-June quarter

INCLUSION INTO Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index is a



key objective behind last week’s decision to remove taxes on FII investment in government debt

(bps) to 6.6%, with the Monetary Policy Committee noting that prolonged global supply chain disruptions, heightened volatility in global financial markets, and weather-related shocks “continue to pose downside risks to the domestic growth outlook.”

According to the aforementioned source, the RBI’s downward revision to the growth forecast is understandable. “The RBI needs to be conservative, and that’s what it has done. And that’s OK.”

“The government has taken measures to help affected

areas: there is the maritime insurance pool, the ATF Price Stabilisation Fund, and the Budget announced the Economic Stabilisation Fund... We are recognising where the pressures are and acting to ease them.”

Bloomberg index inclusion

On Friday, the government and the RBI announced a host of steps to attract foreign capital — from the scrapping of capital gains and withholding tax on FII investment in government debt to concessional windows to boost foreign currency deposits

Bombay HC quashes retrospective spectrum charge on Airtel, Vi

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, June 8

THE BOMBAY High Court on Monday set aside Union Cabinet decisions and multiple demand notices issued by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) as one-time spectrum charge (OTSC) against Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea, and directed that bank guarantees furnished by the two telecom operators need not be kept alive.

The OTSC was a charge the government sought to collect retroactively, pegging fees for spectrum Airtel and Vodafone Idea had already held between 2008 and 2012 to the significantly higher prices that emerged from a spectrum auction held in 2012. The operators had deposited bank guarantees as financial security against the disputed demand. A bench of Justices Manish M Pitale and Shreeram V Shirsat ruled on a plea by the operators against the retrospective imposition of OTSC linked to 2012 auction prices for spectrum held between July 1, 2008 and December 31, 2012, above 6.2 MHz.

Airtel, represented by senior advocates Harish Salve and Darius Khambatia, and Vodafone Idea, represented by senior advocate Aspi Chinoy, argued that the Central government had no power under the Telegraph Act or license agreements to impose such charges retrospectively, and that the demand was “un-

sustainable.” The court held that the Centre had failed to justify levying the OTSC retrospectively and set aside two Cabinet decisions of November 8 and December 28, 2012, along with the consequent demand notices. It also directed the return of bank guarantees and set aside all measures taken under the notices. The court held that the Centre “obviously cannot claim statutory power under section 4 of the Telegraph Act to act as per its own whim,” regardless of the terms of the contract or license executed under that provision.

After examining the licenses, the bench found the government could not deviate from contract terms or add new financial burdens by invoking “public interest,” particularly given that the New Telecom Policy (NTP)-1999 emphasised affordable and wide access, not revenue maximisation.

The court said public interest would depend on the facts and circumstances of each case. The bench also found that before issuing the Cabinet decisions, there had been no formal modification of license agreement terms and no novation, meaning no replacement of the original contract with a new one that could have justified the additional charge. The authorities, it observed, had “unilaterally imposed the levy and that too, without any source of power identifiable” in the contract or statutory provisions.

DOWN FROM \$13.7 BILLION A YEAR AGO India’s current account surplus narrows to \$7.1 billion in Q4

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, June 8

INDIA’S CURRENT account surplus narrowed sharply to \$7.1 billion, or 0.7% of GDP, in the fourth quarter ended March 2026, as a rising gold import bill and foreign investor outflows weighed on external balances, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday.

This marks a notable decline from the surplus of \$13.7 billion, or 1.4% of GDP, recorded during the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year.

The moderation in the current account surplus reflects changing dynamics in India’s external sector, with factors such as trade flows, services exports, remittances and investment income influencing the overall balance.

Despite remaining in surplus territory, the lower figure indicates a reduced contribution from external earnings compared to the year-ago period. FII outflows increased to \$12 billion in March 2026 quarter as against outflows of \$5.9 billion in the same period a year ago.

Gold import bill for the March 2026 quarter was \$22.57 billion and full year at \$71.97 billion as against \$9.5 billion and \$58 billion respectively in the previous year, RBI data says.

The RBI’s latest data highlights the evolving balance of



Net services receipts rose to \$60.4 bn from \$53.3 bn a year ago, said RBI.

payments position amid global economic uncertainties, especially the West Asia crisis which started in late February, and shifting trade patterns, while underscoring the resilience of India’s external sector.

However, in full year of 2025-26, India’s current account deficit widened slightly to \$25.2 billion, equivalent to 0.6% of GDP, compared with \$22.9 billion (0.6% of GDP) in 2024-25.

Net invisibles receipts increased significantly to \$31.2 billion from \$26.4 billion in the previous year, driven mainly by higher net services earnings and stronger net personal transfer inflows, the cen-

tral bank said.

Merchandise trade deficit at \$83.4 billion in Q4 of 2025-26 was higher than \$59.3 billion a year ago. Net services receipts increased to \$60.4 billion from \$53.3 billion a year ago, according to the RBI.

Services exports have risen on a year-on-year basis in major categories such as computer services and other business services. Net outgo on the primary income account, mainly reflecting payments of investment income, decreased to \$11.1 billion in Q4 of 2025-26 from \$11.9 billion in Q4 of last year, the RBI said.

Personal transfer receipts under secondary income account, mainly representing remittances by Indians employed overseas, rose to \$43.5 billion in the latest quarter from \$33.9 billion in Q4 of last year.

In the financial account, foreign direct investment (FDI) recorded a net inflow of \$4.2 billion, higher than \$0.4 billion in March quarter of 2025.

Non-resident deposits (NRI deposits) recorded a net inflow of \$3.3 billion in the quarter higher than \$2.8 billion in Q4 of 2024-25.

Net inflows under external commercial borrowings (ECBs) to India amounted to \$3.6 billion in Q4 as compared to \$7.5 billion a year ago, the RBI said. Forex reserves increased by \$7.2 billion (on a BoP basis) in Q4 of 2025-26 as compared to an accretion of \$8.8 billion a year ago.

‘SEBI weighs regulatory changes across IPOs, broking, mutual funds’



George Mathew
Mumbai, June 8

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is evaluating a broad set of regulatory reforms, including a revised framework for variable net-worth requirements for stock brokers, enhancements to IPO price discovery mechanisms, relaxation of certain compliance norms for research analysts and changes to mutual funds’ intra-day borrowing rules, according to the Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey.

Further, the recent tax exemptions (long-term capital gains tax and withholding tax) for foreign investors and the removal of some corporate debt investment limits will boost debt market inflows, he said.

SEBI is reviewing the framework for variable net worth requirements for stock brokers to ensure that capital requirements more accurately reflect the scale of operations and associated risks, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said at the ICICI Securities conference. The regulator is reassessing existing norms to create a more risk-sensitive approach to capital adequacy. The regulator is also examining measures to improve price discovery in the securities market, particularly through the pre-open call auction mechanism for initial public offerings (IPOs) and relisted securities, according to Pandey. The objective is to facilitate more stable and efficient market openings, thereby reducing

“**Broader policy measures, like the latest tax exemptions for FPIs on govt securities and removal of certain investment limits in corporate debt, will facilitate capital flows into debt mkt**”

TUHIN KANTA PANDEY,
SEBI CHAIRMAN

volatility and improving trading outcomes for investors.

In another move aimed at reducing compliance burdens, SEBI is working on easing regulatory requirements for research analysts, he said. The regulator is considering rationalising certain obligations, including call recording requirements during institutional interactions, to make compliance more practical without compromising transparency and accountability.

For the mutual fund industry, the regulator has proposed a more practical framework for the use of intraday borrowing, Pandey said. Instead of treating it solely as a contingency measure, SEBI intends to allow it to serve as an efficient tool for managing temporary liquidity mismatches, helping fund houses better meet operational requirements while safeguarding investor interests.

“Broader policy measures — such as the latest tax exemptions for FPIs on government securities and removal of certain investment limits in corporate debt — will further facilitate capital flows into debt market,” he said.

On June 5, the Centre scrapped the capital gains tax — both long-term and short-term — on FPI investments in government bonds as well as the withholding tax they must pay on their interest income from these debt instruments amid pressure to attract money from abroad to stabilise the rupee’s exchange rate and bridge the looming Balance of Payments deficit.

He said SEBI and RBI are

Rupee, stocks slump on West Asia escalation

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, June 8

Further escalation in West Asia pushed the stock markets and the rupee lower on Monday amid concerns over high crude oil prices, an elevated inflation outlook, and potential interest rate hikes by the US Federal Reserve.

The Indian currency slumped 0.8% to end the session at 95.71 to the dollar, erasing almost all the gains seen on Friday after RBI’s measures to boost foreign inflows into the Indian market had buoyed sentiment.

However, the central bank is yet to announce the timeline for implementing its new measures announced Friday. When implemented, the steps are likely to attract \$30 billion-\$50 billion of foreign inflows, which is deemed positive for the rupee.

The market slumped 1% to two-month lows as high crude oil prices forced investors to be risk-averse. Nifty 50 ended at 23,123, down 243.70 points, while Sensex lost 719.09 points to end at 73,524.26.

working together to introduce derivatives on corporate bond indices. On the debt side, the corporate bond market architecture has been strengthened. “The Electronic Book Provider platform has been expanded to include issuances by REITs and InvTs, improving transparency and efficiency. In pursuance of budget announcement, a working group is sorting out operational details to introduce market-making framework to improve liquidity in 4 corporate bond market,” Pandey said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

‘India-US deal only after Section 301 probe is over’

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, June 8

INDIA AND US trade deal can be finalised only after US Section 301 probe comes to an end, a government official said, adding that New Delhi has sought assurance from Washington opens no further probes on the county after the trade deal is signed.

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal last week said that India and the US will sign the “first tranche” of the bilateral trade deal by mid-July. The US has already proposed new Section 301 tariffs on 60 countries, which are expected to come into effect after July 7. Washington has set 12.5% tariffs on 54 countries, including India, China and 10% of six countries, such as Pakistan and the EU.

A results of probe on “excess capacity” is pending on India and 15 other countries. The outcome is expected in the coming weeks. And the Indian concession under the trade deal would be in exchange of the cumulative tariffs set as a result of the two probes.

However, under the Section 301 of the US Trade Act 1974, the US can announce other kind of restrictions beyond tariffs. Non tariff barriers can also restrict Indian exports to the US and signing a deal could mean giving up more control of sovereign trade policies to the US.

But the absence of the deal could accelerate the weakening of the domestic currency and flight of foreign capital that had begun since late last year.

The war in the Gulf region and higher oil prices have further weakened India’s macroeconomic conditions. More tariffs could add to India’s fiscal worries. The US team had come to India from June 2-4 for finalisation of the deal and US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer is expected to reach India later this month.

India to sell up to 3% stake in NLC India

Bengaluru: The Centre will sell up to a 3% stake in mining and power generation firm NLC India via an offer for sale, according to an X post from the secretary of Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM). The OFS consists of a base offer of up to a 2% equity stake in NLC India, with the option to sell an additional 1% in case shares are oversubscribed. REUTERS

• MARKETS

Sensex 73,524.26 -719.08 -0.97%	NIFTY 23,123.00 -243.70 -1.04%	Gold ▼ ₹1,51,489	US Dollar ▲ ₹95.71
		Silver ▼ ₹2,44,300	Oil ▼ \$95.93

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 5, 2026

THE BOARD REVIEWED PERFORMANCE OF KEY GROUP FIRMS; TATA SONS BOARD TO MEET ON JUNE 12

Tata Trusts meets ahead of key Tata Sons board meeting

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 8

TATA TRUSTS, the principal shareholder of Tata Sons, met on Monday to review routine matters but did not take up contentious issues such as the proposed listing of Tata Sons or a possible extension for its chairman. The meeting comes ahead of a crucial Tata Sons board meeting expected later this week.

According to sources, it was a routine meeting of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) where the trustees reviewed the financial performance of unlisted companies, with a particular focus on losses incurred by these entities and the roadmap towards profitability. The meeting comes at a time when the Tata group is making significant investments in aviation, digital

commerce and electronics manufacturing, sectors that are critical to its long-term growth strategy but continue to require substantial capital outlay.

The board of Tata Education and Development Trust also met on Monday. Mehli Mistry is a member on its board. Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) board could not meet following an order from the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner.

The meeting of SDTT, headed by Noel Tata, also assumed significance amid growing interest in the future leadership of Tata Sons.

However, sources said no decision was taken on board-related matters, including the possible extension of the tenure of Tata Sons Chairman N. Chandrasekaran and appointing a new Director onto the board. These issues are expected to

• STRATEGY REVIEW

IT WAS a routine meeting of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust where trustees reviewed the financial performance of unlisted firms, per sources

HOWEVER, NO decision was taken on board-related matters, including the possible extension of the tenure of Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran, according to the sources

come up before the Tata Sons board meeting on June 12.

The discussions were largely focused on routine matters and stock-taking. Air India, which is undergoing a multi-year transformation programme following its acquisition by the Tata group and Tata Digital, which operates the Tata Neu platform,

were among the major areas of review of Tata Trusts and Tata Sons. The group is also investing in electronics and semiconductor-related ventures as the conglomerate expands its presence in the sector.

On May 26, the board of Tata Sons reviewed turnaround strategies and business transformation plans for several of the \$180 billion group’s loss-making ventures as the conglomerate seeks to strengthen growth while containing mounting losses across key businesses, with reviews indicating that Air India and Tata Digital are expected to continue reporting losses for the next three years.

Chief executives of major unlisted companies under the Tata Group umbrella, including Air India, Tata Digital and Tata Electronics, made detailed pres-

entations before the Tata Sons board. The presentations, attended by Noel Tata and other Directors, focused on long-term business strategies, operational restructuring, revenue expansion and capital requirements for the coming years.

The Tata Sons board meeting primarily centred on the financial performance and future roadmaps of these companies, many of which are in investment-heavy phases.

On allegations regarding a share transfer made by the Navajbai Ratan Tata Trust (NRTT) to the late Naval H. Tata in the year 1989, Tata Trusts said any suggestion of impropriety on the part of either the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), NRTT, or any of the parties to the transaction, is categorically denied.

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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Babli Kumari D/o Pramod Kumar Yadav R/o 302, Patparganj Village, Peer Wali Gali, Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Aradhya Kumari for all future purposes 0071040780-1

I, Asha Taneja, D/o Lachman Dass Taneja W/o Vijay Kumar Bathla R/o HNo 121 Sec-21D Faridabad Haryana, have changed my name to Asha Bathla vide affidavit dt. 29/05/2026 Notary AR Muneer Ahmed, Bangalore. 0050291040-1

I Tarun Kumar S/o Hira Lal R/o 45, Patodi Road, Near Hanuman Mandi Garouli Khurd, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 that name of my father and my mother has been wrongly written as Hira Kumar & Pinki in my 10th class educational documents. The actual name of my father and my mother are Hira Lal and Pinki Devi, which may be amended accordingly. 0040859296-1

I Shilpa Ailawadi, W/O Aditya Nayyar, R/O 4/101, 2ndFloor, Ramesh Nagar, N.Delhi-110015, have changed my name from Shilpa Ailawadi to Shilpa Nayyar vide Affidavit DL271070213696527, dated: 06/06/2026 0130065559-1

I Kumud w/o Ashok Kumar Garg R/O/1/5562 Gali no 16, Balbir nagar extn, Shahdara Delhi 110032, have changed my name from Kusum Lata to Kumud for all purposes. 0071040862-1

I Hardik S/O, Sushli Singh R/o 1067/6 4th Floor Greenwood Appt Mehrauli New Delhi-110030 have changed my name to Hardik Singh. 0040859314-1

I Dinesh Choudhary S/O- Gyanendra singh, Address-P-226, F/F pillanji village sarojini Nagar Delhi-110023, changed my name to Dinesh Kiran Chaudhary 0040859394-8

I Bhumika Malhotra w/o Sh. Gaurav Bharara R/o WZ -2/3, 3rd Floor, Ram Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 have changed the name of my minor son from Samarth Narang to Samarth Bharara for all purposes. 0040859296-2

I Basanti Devi, Wo- Ali Hussain Address-A/1145/15 jaitpur ext-part-2 badapur New Delhi 110044, changed my name to Haseena Begam 0040859394-9

I Ashok Kumar Garg S/o Durga parshad R/o 1/5562 Gali no 16, Balbir nagar Extn, Shahdara Delhi 110032, Have changed my name from Ashok Kumar to Ashok kumar Garg for all purposes. 0071040859-1

It is for general information that I, SUSHMA, W/o Sh. DEEPAK GUPTA, R/O J-1/215, WEST SAGARPUR, New Delhi-110046, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as DIVYA GUPTA in my son's birth certificate and 10th & 12th class educational documents. The actual name of mine is SUSHMA, both are the names of one and the same identical person. In future I shall be known as SUSHMA for all purposes. 0040859298-1

I, hitherto known as Sabha Satya, W/o- Ravinder, R/o Tandaheri (52), Tandaheri Distt. Jhajjar (Haryana)-124507, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Monti. 0040859423-7

I, Vinod Kumar, S/o Hira Ballabh Joshi, R/o H.No.17, Karanpur, Dharampur Dhanakhola, Ramnagar, Nainital, have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Joshi. 0040859394-1

I, Ranjit Kumar, S/O- SH. Bhola Sah, H.No.621, BLOCK- WZ, Naraina-Village, New Delhi-110028, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that I have changed my name, from SHREE RANJIT KUMAR to RANJIT KUMAR. 0040859423-6

I, Vijay, S/o, Hari Om R/o A-579, JJ-Colony, Raghubir Nagar, Tagore Garden, Delhi-110027, have changed the name of my minor Son VARDAAN age-16 years and he shall hereafter be known as VARDAAN RAJPUT. 0040859423-3

I, Sumit Tanwar S/o Rishpal Tanwar R/o A-5/1, Main Road, S.R.T Farm, Asola, Fatehpur Beri, Delhi-110074 have changed my name to Sumeet Tanwar. 0040859393-1

I, Sudhir Kumar S/o GURBAX R/O-1-a-96 nit Faridabad Haryana, have change name to SUDHIR JAISWAL FOR ALL 0040859423-4

I, Simmi W/o Mahendra Bhandari R/o C-68 A Guru Nanak Dev Colony Bhalasva Dairy, Delhi-42 have changed my name to Simmi Bhandari 0040859394-5

I, Sharvan Maan, S/O-Raj Singh Maan, R/O-103/9, Near-Gaushala, Kishan-Garh, Vasant Kunj, South West-Delhi-110070, Have changed my name to Shravan Maan for all future purposes. 0040859393-3

I, SONU S/o Mahender Sonar, J-1165, St.No-2, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi-42 have changed my name to SONU SONAR. 0071040868-1

I, Arun Kumar Saini, S/O-Charan Singh, R/o-Flat.No.123, Second Floor, Siddhartha Enclave, Hari Nagar Ashram, Jungpura, South Delhi, Delhi-110014, I have changed the name of my minor son Adwin Geed aged 11 years to Adwin Saini. 0040859436-3

I, Saurabh Pandey, S/o-Narsinghan Narayan Pandey, residing at, Flat.No.171, Tower-C-2, Unitech Unihome, Sector-117, Noida, Gautam Buddh-Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name to Saurabh Kumar Pandey, for all purposes 0040859393-4

I, SUNITA CHAUHAN/SUNITA RANI CHAUHAN W/O MADAN PAL R/O VILLAGE PALI BAGHPAT UTTAR PRADESH-250609, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUNITA. 0040859423-2

I, SIMRAN SHARMA, W/o SANJEEV SHARMA, R/O-House- No-148, Tyagi Mohalla, Near Tyagi Choupal, Chattarpur, South Delhi, New Delhi-110074, have changed the name of my minor son CHIRAG SHARMA, aged 13-years, and he shall hereafter be known as YUVIK SHARMA for all purposes. 0040859398-2

I, SHUBEB USMAN S/O WADOOD AHMAD, R/O-E-55, SF B/S FLAT. NO-2C, ABUL FAZAL ENCL-PART-II, SHAHEEN BAGH, OKHLA, DELHI-25, HAVE, CHANGED MY, NAME TO SHUEB USMAN PERMANENTLY FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859398-3

I, SHIWANI BHARDWAJ, D/O- SANTOSH KUMAR JHA, R/O- VILLAGE DHAMAURA, P.O. DHAMAURA, DISTRICT WEST CHAMPARAN, BIHAR-845449, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KM SHIVANI BHARADWAJ FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-5

I, Ramesh Kumar, S/o- Late Dalip Singh, R/O-H.No.33- J, Jy-Colony, Welcome, Seelampur-II, Delhi-110053, declare that name of mine and my minor son has been wrongly written as Ramesh Mavar and David in my minor son Natik aged 15-years in his School Records. The actual name of mine and my minor son are Ramesh Kumar and Natik, which may be amended accordingly. 0040859394-11

I, Rahul S/o Subhash Garg R/O B 190, Sector 11, Faridabad have changed my name to Rahul Garg. 0040859395-2

I, RAMESH S/O RAM LAL R/O D-99, BHAGAT SINGH PARK,, SIRAS PUR, DELHI-110042, have changed my name to RAMESH KUMAR. 0040859423-10

I, RAJ KUMARI alias RAJNI D/o Dal Chand Jajoria W/o Pardeep Kumar R/o-House No.5365, Gali, No.68, Raigar Pura Karol Bagh S.O. Central Delhi Delhi-110005, have changed my name to RAJNI 0040859395-5

I, Praveen Sharma, S/o- Ram Kumar Sharma, R/o-2B, Sham-Nath Marg, Delhi-110054, hereby declare that the names Parveen Sharma and Praveen Sharma refer to one and the same person. My correct legal name, for all purposes is Praveen Sharma. 0040859394-7

I, Pawan Kumar S/o Jai Kumar Jain R/o E 75/A, 2nd Floor, Sector 11, Faridabad have changed my name to Pawan Kumar Jain. 0040859395-1

I, Parmanand Tyagi, S/o Budhprakash R/o 75, Mohammadpur Amad Baghpat, Ghaziabad, I, have changed my name to Paramanand. 0040859394-2

I, PRAVESH KUMAR, S/O- RAMESH CHAND, R/O-A-198, SECOND-FLOOR GANPATI NIWAS STREET NO.5, KABIR-NAGAR, DELHI-110094, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARVESH KUMAR GUPTA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-10

I, PARVESH KUMAR, S/O- SURJIT KUMAR, R/O SD-69 SECTOR-45, NOIDA GAUTAM-BUDDHA NAGAR UP-201303, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARVESH KUMAR GUPTA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-10

I, Nausheen Saed, W/O Asad Aslam, R/O K-40, 4th Floor, Batla-House, Near Khalilullah-Masjid, Jamia-Nagar, Okhla South, Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Nausheen Asad, for all future purpose 0040859436-2

I, Naem Ahmad Ghouri, S/O Mohammad Akhlaq, R/O-592, 2nd Floor, Road, no.7 Zakir-Nagar, Delhi 110025, have changed my from Naem Ahmad Ghouri to Naem Ahmad, for all future purposes 0040859436-1

I, Mohammad Aftab Alam, S/o-Mohammad Bafati Miyan, R/o-H.No-X-4283, Street No-19/3, Shanti Mohalla-Extension Gandhi-Nagar Delhi-110031, have changed my name to Mohd Aftab for all purpose. 0040859394-6

I, MADAN PAL CHAUHAN/MADAN SINGH S/O NAIN SINGH R/O VILLAGE PALI BAGHPAT UTTAR PRADESH-250609, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MADAN PAL. 0040859423-1

I, Lovelesh, S/o-Dharmender D/o G-36 3rd Floor, Gali No.2, Near-Gurdwara Guru Singh Sabha Pratap-Nagar Delhi-110007, have changed my name to Lovelesh Singh, for all Purposes. 0040859423-8

I, RAJESH S/O JAI PAL, R/O B-1375, GAUTAM PURI PHASE-2, BADARPUR, DELHI-110044, have changed my name to RAJESH KUMAR for all future purposes 0071040770-1

I, OM PRAKASH S/O BAJRANG LAL NAGAR R/O A-2-258 MADANAGIR STATE BANK OF INDIA AMBEDKAR NAGAR DEOLL SOUTH DELHI 110062 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME OM PRAKASH NAGAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0071040771-1

I, Poonam Kumari Chauhan W/o Anil Kumar R/o C-149 Millennium Appt. Sector -18 Rohini Delhi 110089, have changed my name to Poonam Chauhan. 0071040775-1

I, Komal D/o Rajesh R/o Village-Kultana, Tehsil Kultana, Dist:Rohtak, Haryana-124501 have changed my name to Komal Dangli. 0040859394-4

I, KM SARTIA, W/O RAJESH KUMAR DASILA, R/O-C-8/8637, VASNAT KUNJ, NEW DELHI-110070, have changed my name for all future purposes to SARITA DASILA 0040859393-12

I, KM RESU BALA, W/O-PARVESH KUMAR GUPTA, R/O-A-198 SECOND-FLOOR GANPATI NIWAS, STREET NO.5 KABIR NAGAR, DELHI-110094, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RESHU GUPTA, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-9

I, KEDAR SINGH, S/O-BIKRAM SINGH RAWAT, H.NO.156A NYAY-KHAND-3 INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD U.P.201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KEDAR SINGH RAWAT, FOR ALL FUTURE PURSURES. 0040859393-6

I, JASVINDER SINGH, S/O ATMA SINGH, R/O-WZ-10, 3RD FLOOR, RIGHT SIDE, MAIN ROAD, SANT-GARH, NEAR SEHGAL CLINIC, TILAK-NAGAR, DELHI-110018, have changed my name to JASVINDER SINGH 0040859423-11

I, HASEEN AHMAD, S/o-ABDUL HAFIZ, R/O-X-23, K-BLOCK, WELCOME SEELAMPUR, DELHI-110053, declare that name mine has been wrongly written as HASEEN AHMED in my Passport No.P3279639. The actual name of mine is HASEEN AHMAD. 0040859395-4

I, GURPREET KAUR MALHOTRA, D/O-SOHINDER SINGH HORA, R/O-09204, ATS ADVANTAGE, AHINSA KHAND-1, INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD-201014, UTTAR PRADESH, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GURPREET KAUR, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-11

I, Dilpreet Singh Sawhney S/o Swarnjit Singh Sawhney, R/O E-614, Jal Vayoo Taawaras, Sector-56, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122011, have changed my name to Dilpreet Singh. 0040859423-9

I, DHARMENDRA SINGH, S/O-Mohan Singh, R/o-394, Gali, No-9, Shahid-Bhagat Singh-Colony Karawal-Nagar, Delhi-94, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Dharmendra in my driving license no-DL-032014049410, The actual name of mine is DHARMENDRA SINGH, Which may be amended accordingly. 0040859436-4

I, DEEPAK KUMAR SINGH, S/o-Nagendra Singh R/O M-46, Second Floor, Sham Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have changed my name to DEEPAK KUMAR. 0040859393-2

I, DABANGANA MUKHERJEE D/O-BIMAL MUKHERJEE ADDRESS-C-164/1, JAWAHAR PARK DEOLI ROAD KHANPUR DELHI-110062, changed my name to DEBANGANA MUKHERJEE 0040859394-10

I, Bhawna, D/o Sh Surat Singh, R/O-98-D, Paket-A, Mayur Vihar, Phase-2, Chilla Saroda Khadar, Chilla, East Delhi, Delhi-110091, have changed my name to Bhawna Singh. 0040859398-1

I, Bal Krishan S/o Chaman Lal Verma R/O G2, Plot-643, Shalimar Garden Extension-1, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Bal Krishan Verma. 0040859395-3

I, Abhishek Kumar S/o Manoj Kumar R/O F-104, Aditya Mega City Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, PO: Shipra Sun City, DIST: Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, I have changed the name of my minor daughter Nitara Kumar aged about 4-Years and she shall hereafter be known as Vedika Bose. 0040859398-5

I, Bal Krishan S/o Chaman Lal Verma R/O G2, Plot-643, Shalimar Garden Extension-1, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Bal Krishan Verma. 0040859395-3

I, ANANYA ARORA, D/O-ARVIND KOHLI, R/O B-1003, CLEMENT CITY, CROSSING REPUBLIK GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201016, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANANYA KOHLI, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-7

I, Virender Singh S/o Mahender Singh R/o 890, Saini Mohalla, Shahbad Mohammadpur, SouthWest Delhi-110061, I have changed the name of my minor son Kavir Singh to Vedaant Singh aged 2 years. 0071040893-1

I, Vinodh K S/o P.K. Ramankutty Nair, R/O A-706 Mahalaksmi Apts. Sec-2 PL-4 Dwarka, New Delhi-110075, have changed my name to Vinodh Kulakezhe. 0071040886-1

I, Ubais, S/o- Abdul Wahid, R/O-R-59, Gali No.4, Joga Bai Extension, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohd Owais. 0040859395-6

I, SUBHASH CHAND, S/O SHRI MUNNI LAL CHAUHAN R/O AF 169 ANSAL GOLFLINK 2 UPSIDC HOUSING SITE C SURAJPUR GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH 201306 have changed my name SUBHASH CHAND CHAUHAN for all future purposes 0071040772-1

I, SALLAUDDIN ANSARI S/O HASAN IMAM ANSARI R/O RZ-2046 Third Floor B/S, Street no 27, Near Mother Dairy, Tughlakabad Extension, Alaknanda, PO: Kalkaji Delhi-110019. Have changed my name to SALAUDDIN ANSARI for all future purposes. 0071040775-1

I, Neelam W/o Mukesh Kumar R/O C81, New Panchwati, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Neelam Singhal permanently. 0071040856-1

I, Mukhtar Ahmad S/o Mohammad Ahmed, R/o 8884, Naya Mohalla, Pul Bangash, Azad Market, North Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Mukhtar Ahmed. 0071040779-1

I, MANDAKINI BANDYOPADHYAY, D/O PAI RAMNATH BABURAO R/O 63 KALLOL APARTMENTS 35 I P EXTENSION DELHI 110092 have changed my name MANDAKINI BANERJEE for all future purposes 0071040866-1

I, MAHENDAR S/o Hira Lal, J-1165, St.No-2, Swaroop Nagar, Delhi-42 have changed my name to MAHENDER SONAR. 0071040867-1

I, Kamal Sharma S/O Sudershan Lal Sharma resident of E-501, Elite Home, Sector-77, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh 201301, have changed my name from Kamal Sharma to Kamal Kumar Sharma. Hereforth I would be known by the name of Kamal Kumar Sharma for all future purposes. 0071040843-1

I, Jagdish Prasad S/o Kishan Lal Arya R/O Flat No 919, G2, Sector -3, Near Sanfort School, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201012, have changed my name from Jagdish Prasad to Jagdish Prasad Arya. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jagdish Prasad Arya for all future purposes. 0071040766-1

I, JASBIR SINGH S/O SARDAR HARNAM SINGH, R/O R-535, 2ND FLOOR, R-BLOCK, NEW RAJINDER NAGAR, DELHI-60, have changed my name to JASBIR SINGH KATHURIA for all future purposes. 0071040769-1

I, HUSBUN NISHA W/O SALAUDDIN ANSARI R/O RZ-2046 Third Floor backside, Street no 27, Near Mother Dairy, Tughlakabad Extension, Alaknanda, PO: Kalkaji, Delhi-110019 Have changed my name to HASBUN NISHA for all future purposes. 0071040776-1

I, Gyanwati W/o No 14345331H Rank Ex NAIK Satish Chander R/O House No. 236, Pol No. 55, Bhajan Thola, Malik Pur Village, South West Delhi, Delhi-110073 have changed my name to Gyanvati Devi vide affidavit date 6-6-26 before Delhi. 0071040773-1

I, Bermati W/o No 14465327W Rank Ex HAV Attar Singh R/O Post Office Khaira, 48, Kharkhari Jatmal, South West Delhi, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Birmati vide affidavit date 6-6-26 before Delhi. 0071040774-1

LOST & FOUND I, Girish Ralhan, S/o- Late Bhim Sain Ralhan, Have Lost Original Demand Letter & Recommendation Letter Of Plot No-16, Sector-10, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075, Finder Contact: 9968031605 0040859436-5

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Savita, daughter of Mr. Ran Kanwar and Mrs. Kanta Devi, resident of Sagar Pur (West), hereby declare that in all my documents, my father's name has been mentioned as Mr. Ran Kanwar, which is incorrect. I hereby certify that my father's correct name is Mr. Ran Kanwar, who was employed as an OT Technical Assistant at Doss Dayal Upadhyay Hospital. He retired from government service on 31.07.2018 and passed away on 01.04.2022. Therefore, Ran Kanwar and Ran Kanwar are the same and one person, and the discrepancy is merely a typographical error in recording the name. I further certify that I and my two children, Anisha Rolem and Anush Rolem, are fully dependent upon my mother, Mrs. Kanta Devi.

I, BHAGWAN DAS S/O LATE SHRI UTTAM CHAND R/O DDA JANTA FLAT NO.101 A, BLOCK-J2, DDA FLATS KALKAJI, NEW DELHI, I HAD LOST/MISPLACED THE ORIGINAL DEMAND LETTER, POSSESSION LETTER, POSSESSION SLIP, NOC FOR WATER AND ELECTRICITY CONNECTION, PAYMENT CHALLANS & ETC. OF ABOVE SITED FLAT, VIDE DDA FILE NO.F31(2)/74, THE LR No. 348883/2026 Dated- 05/06/2026.

I, ARSHDEEP D/O Satnam Singh, 1/58 Gali-1 Gulab Vatika, Behat Hajipur, Loni, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Arshdeep Kaur. 0040859394-3

I, ANANYA ARORA, D/O-ARVIND KOHLI, R/O B-1003, CLEMENT CITY, CROSSING REPUBLIK GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201016, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANANYA KOHLI, FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040859393-7

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PUBLIC NOTICE My clients Sh. Anil Kumar Sharma S/o Sh. S.P. Sharma and Smt. Sunita Sharma W/o Sh. Anil Kumar Sharma R/o H.No. 122 and 123, Sainik Enclave (Near Metro Depot), Maksudabad, Najafgarh, New Delhi - 110043, hereby severed all relations immediately with their son Manish Sharma due to his hostile behaviour and disowned all of him from all their moveable and immovable properties, as such anybody dealing with him will be at his own risks and my clients will not be responsible in any manner socially, morally, legally and financially henceforth. Sanjay Kumar (Advocate) Enrolment No.-D-50/2008

PUBLIC NOTICE I, Anshu Sharma w/o Sanjeev Kumar R/O E-28A, 1st floor gali no. 10, lyoli colony, shahdara Delhi - 110093, (M.B.I. 9015892642) has informed that the possession letter & No objection certificate of LIG FLAT NO-280, SECTOR -17, PO-AJEE-02, BLOCK-C ROHINI has been lost some where. If anybody found the above mention documents kindly return or post at above address. Missuse of above documents will be treated illegal. Authority is requested to please issue duplicate documents.

PUBLIC NOTICE It is brought to the notice of the public at Large through this Public Notice that my client, MR. KULWANT SINGH, son of Late Shri. Singnara Singh resident of 413, 3rd Nagar, East of Kailash, New Delhi-110065 has debarred his daughter Mrs. Manpreet Kaur S/o wife of Mr. Jang Bahadur Singh from all his moveable and immovable properties/assets, due to her disobedient behavior. Any person deals with herin any manner who will be sole responsible for all acts, deeds and consequences. AMIT ANAND, Advocate Enrol. No. D-1452/2003

PUBLIC NOTICE Public at large are informed that my client, Radhey Shyam S/o Shri Raf Ram R/o House No. 34, B-Block, Gali No.3, Kamal Vihar, Kamal Pur, Burari, Delhi-110084 has debarred, disowned and disinherited his son namely Deepanshu from all his moveable and immovable properties, no relation in any matter whatsoever and have ended all relations with him. Anybody who deals with him shall be doing so at his/her own risks & costs and consequences. My client shall not be responsible for the same. SUSHIL KUMAR (ADVOCATE) 288, Western Wing, The Hazrat Court, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE Be it known to the general public that my client, Sh. Bilji devi, W/o Sh. Umakant sharma, R/o Nagar, house no. A-208/A, Sainik enclave, Vikas Nagar, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi 110059, has severed all her relations with her son namely Sudhir sharma and daughter-in-law namely Smt. Arati kumar, W/o S/o Sh. sharma. Be it also known that my client, through this public notice, disowns her above said son and Daughter-in-law from all her moveable and immovable properties, whatsoever, as the above said persons behave rudely and have no regards towards my client. My client shall not be responsible, heretofore, in any kind for any act/deed of her above said son and daughter-in-law. Anybody dealing with any of the above said persons shall be doing so at his own risk, cost and consequences. Jeetendra kumar singh (advocate) Delhi High Court.

PUBLIC NOTICE General Public is hereby informed that my client, Sh. Sanjay Kumar, S/o Sh. Ran Singh, R/o H. No. 124, 3rd Floor, Block-C-1, Deep Vihar, Parsali, NW Delhi 110042, has, due to their conduct and behaviour, severed all social, financial and family relations with his son, LAKSHYAT LOHCHAB, and his wife, NEHA TOKAS, and has debarred/disinherited them from all his moveable and immovable properties. Neither of them shall have any right, title, interest in the properties and assets of my client. Any person dealing with them shall do so entirely at his/her own risk, cost and responsibility, and my client shall not be liable in any manner whatsoever. Sanjay Rathi (Advocate) Office: G-105, Phase 1, Asoh Vihar, Delhi-55

PUBLIC NOTICE Be it known to all that our client Sh. Ashok Kumar Gupta and his wife Smt. Smia Gupta R/o H.No.101-103, Bhogpal Road, 3rd Floor, Jungpura, Delhi-110014 has disowned & debarred their son namely Arkt Gupta, along with his wife Astha Sethi, from all their moveable and immovable properties and has terminated all relations in future due to their irresponsible deeds, misconduct & misbehaviour towards our clients and if any one deals with them, he/she shall be doing at his own costs & risks. Deepak Rana (Advocate) Ch. No.112, Supreme Court, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE My client Shukla Roy Chowdhury wishes to sell her 3/4 share in Ground Floor of D628, C.R.Park, N.D. Anyone having valid objection may write to the undersigned at following address: Shaurya Nagpal, Advocate, 5 R K Garg Block, Supreme Court, Tilak Marg, N.D. Mob : 9416014477"

COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF SH. UMED SINGH, PRINCIPAL JUDGE (H.O.), FAMILY COURTS, SOUTH-WEST DISTRICT, DWARKA COURTS, DWARKA, NEW DELHI. NOTICE UNDER ORDER 8 RULE 20 READ WITH SECTION 131 CPC FOR SERVICE OF RESPONDENT BY WAY OF SUBSTITUTED SERVICE I.E. BY WAY OF PUBLICATION. HMA No. 1956/2023 ND001-20.08.2026

ARVIND KUMAR VERMA S/O SH. KIRUB LAL VERMA R/O PLOT NO. 11, KIR. NO. 102 AND 102, NIRANJAN PARK, NALJAGAR, NEW DELHI. ALSO AT: 307, Dwarka Court, Delhi. H.No. 29A, 300 BAZAR ROAD, PREM VIHAR, NAJAFGARH, DELHI. PETITIONER 1 VERSUS MENAKA W/O SH. ARVIND KUMAR VERMA DO LATE BALKHANDI VERMA R/O VILLAGE AND POST HARPER BARWA, NEAR PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK, KUSHI NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH who is repeatedly avoiding service of summons. That the above matter is now fixed for hearing on 20.08.2026, that MENAKA is directed to appear before the Court of Sh. Ummed Singh, Jd, Principal Judge, Family Court, South-West District, Room No. 307, Dwarka Court Complex, New Delhi on 20.08.2026 at 10:00 A.M., failing which the case will be heard as ex-parte.

GIVEN under my hand and seal of the court on this day of 06.06.2026. Sh. UMED SINGH (PRINCIPAL JUDGE (H.O.) FAMILY COURTS, SOUTH WEST DWARKA NEW DELHI Seal

DIRECTORATE OF TOWN AND COUNTRY PLANNING, HARYANA

Nagar Yojna Bhawan, Plot No. 3, Block-A, Sector-18-A, Madhya Marg, Chandigarh. Tele-Fax:- 0172-2548475: 0172-2549851, E-mail:tcpharyana7@gmail.com Website www.tcpharyana.gov.in

Memo No. RCP-37-Vol.-A/JD(RA)/2026/19829 Dated 05.06.2026 Public Notice

The Sectoral-cum-Shajra plan of Sector-9 (Industrial), Sampla bearing Drg. No. DTP (JH) 776/25 dated 03.12.2025 as per the Final Development Plan-2031 AD, Sampla has been approved in-principle by the Government in which internal circulation is re-planned. A scanned copy of earlier approved sectoral plan as well as proposed revised sectoral plan showing the amendment made in the sectoral plan of

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

Sub-Inspector Veer Pal Singh

ITBP salutes its braveheart Sub-Inspector Veer Pal Singh of 5th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Leh in 2023.

LATE SEP DEEP CHAND

In proud memory of sep Deep Chand of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Poonch (J&K) on 09 Jun 1991. Your act of Valour, raw courage & Devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

“BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE”

Remembered by commanding officer and all Ranks 6 DOGRA

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Birender Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous bullet injuries while fighting with militants in area of Anantnag, J&K. He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PPMG(Posthumously).

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Lance Naik Dinesh Singh Yadav on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in area of Rajouri, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Sh Mukesh Kumar Sinha, Assistant Commandant and Constable Bhanwar Lal Jhakar on this day, they sustained grievous injuries while fighting with armed miscreants in area of BOP Mallikpur, West Bengal and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Assistant Sub Inspector Sanasam Inao Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice, while on operational duty in area of BOP Gitaldah, Cooch Behar (West Bengal).

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Assistant Sub Inspector Sanasam Inao Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice, while on operational duty in area of BOP Gitaldah, Cooch Behar (West Bengal).

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Central Reserve Police Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Veer Balidani on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous injuries while fighting with terrorists in Punjab on 9 June 1989. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Director General and all Ranks of Central Reserve Police Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Veer Balidani on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous injuries while fighting with terrorists in Punjab on 9 June 1989. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. ELG-03-J06-2026-27 Date: 05.06.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N. C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works:

Tender No.: ELG-03-J06-2026-27

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Electrification work in connection with Provision of 05 nos. of Lifts at RKM & FTS Stations to recoup divyngians facility in Agra Division. **Completion period -08 months**

Approx. Cost of the work : Rs. 357429.36

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on 30.06.2026 1298/26 (AS)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

NOTICE

No.: AGC/M/EnHM/16/Serv. Contract/Stn. Clg. Date: 05.06.2026

Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expression of Interest (EOI) for preparing a list of approved vendors for cleaning and housekeeping work at railway stations; Location: Any railway station within the Agra Division.

An Expression of Interest (EOI) is invited to prepare a list of approved vendors for providing cleaning and housekeeping services at any railway station situated within the Agra Division of North Central Railway. Interested agencies/individuals may submit their applications, complete with all details in the prescribed format, to the office of the Senior Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F), Divisional Railway Manager's Office, North Central Railway, Agra 282001. The last date and time for the submission of applications is **10.07.2026 by 15:00 hours**. For detailed information and guidelines regarding participation, please visit the official website of North Central Railway at www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. For any information or clarification regarding this matter, the following officials may be contacted: Shri Naveen Kumar, SSE/Tender (Mobile: 9760536361) and Shri Padam Meena, JE/O&F (Mobile: 8433078615). **1276/26(A)**

North central railways @ CPONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

कार्यालय मुख्य अभियंता (ग्रामीण), जन स्वास्थ्य अभियंत्रिकी विभाग, राजस्थान, 2-सिविल लाईन्स, जल भवन, जैकब रोड, जयपुर कमांक: 4847 दिनांक: 08/06/2026

ई-निविदा संशोधन सूचना-02

ई-ग्राम में तकनीकी खराबी होने के कारण इस कार्यालय के द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा आई. एस. आई. मार्केट स्ट्रुस वाक्स आई. एस. 14846-2000 (अवतन संशोधन) को निविदा में संशोधन निम्नानुसार है:

क्र. सं.	निविदा सं. सं.	पूर्व निर्धारित	संशोधन
1	Sluice Valve/26-27/02	निविदा प्राप्त करने की तिथि 12:00 बजे तक	निविदा खोलने का समय एवं दिनांक 08.06.2026 (प्रातः 12:00 बजे तक)
			निविदा खोलने का समय एवं दिनांक 15.06.2026 (प्रातः 12:00 बजे तक)
			निविदा खोलने का समय एवं दिनांक 15.06.2026 (प्रातः 12:00 बजे तक)
			निविदा खोलने का समय एवं दिनांक 15.06.2026 (प्रातः 12:00 बजे तक)

निविदा को अन्य सभी शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

NIB Code: PHE2627A0532

UBN Code:- PHE2627GLRC01160

हस्ता:- (अशोक कुमार चोपड़ा) अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, वस्तु व्यवस्था वृत्त, जन स्वास्थ्य अभियंत्रिकी विभाग, राजस्थान, जयपुर।

DISTRICT AYURVEDIC OFFICE, GURUGRAM

HUDA DISPENSARY BUILDING, NEAR CHINTPURNI MATA MANDIR, SECTOR-4, GURUGRAM (Haryana)

Phone: 01244-4071687

Email Id: - gurugramayush@gmail.com/
ggn.das555@gmail.com/
daoggn.ayush-hry@gov.in

अत्यकालीन निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी, गुरुग्राम के द्वारा अन्तराष्ट्रीय योग दिवस 21 जून 2026 के लिए टी-शर्ट धरोहर व टैन्ट किराए पर लेने हेतु आपन टैन्ट आमंत्रित है:

टी-शर्ट हेतु नियम व शर्तें:-

- संशोधन रंग की कटौन टी-शर्ट गोल गला एवं कॉलर टी-शर्ट।
- सामने बाई तरफ अन्तराष्ट्रीय योग दिवस का Logo प्रिन्ट होना चाहिए।
- टी-शर्ट का साईज M, L, XL, XXL, XXXL होना। इस्का रेट निर्धारित किया जाए।
- धरोहर राशि 5,000/- रुपये जो कि डीडी District Ayurvedic Officer, Gurugram के नाम देय हो।
- टैन्ट खुलने के दिन टी-शर्ट का सैम्पल साथ लेकर आए।
- वर्क ऑर्डर देने के उपरान्त अधिकांश तीन दिन के अन्दर-अन्दर तक माल की पहुँच होनी चाहिए।

टैन्ट धारण हेतु नियम व शर्तें:-

- कुर्सी, मेज, गढ़े संशोधन चर सहित, कारपेट एवं स्टैंड जे।
- धरोहर राशि 5,000/- रुपये जो कि डीडी District Ayurvedic Officer, Gurugram के नाम देय हो।

सामान्य नियम व शर्तें:-

- टेंडर प्रारंभ का समय 15/06/2026 सार्थ 05:00 बजे इच्छुक लेटर पैड पर बंद लिफाफा में रेट सहित जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी कार्यालय गुरुग्राम में अपने पता व मोबाईल नम्बर सहित जमा करवाएँ।
- टेंडर जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी, कार्यालय गुरुग्राम में 16/06/2026 दोपहर 03:00 बजे खोला जाएगा।
- धरोहर राशि की अदायगी नियमानुसार RTGS के माध्यम 30 दिनों के अन्दर की जाएगी।
- उपरोक्त की विस्तृत जानकारी उपयुक्त गुरुग्राम की वेबसाइट Gurugram.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।
- जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी का पता:- हुड्डा डिस्पेंसरी बिल्डिंग, नजदीक चिन्तपूर्णी माता मन्दिर, मकान नम्बर 817 के सामने सैक्टर-4, गुरुग्राम तथा ई-मेल daoggn.ayush-hry@gov.in, gurugramayush@gmail.com

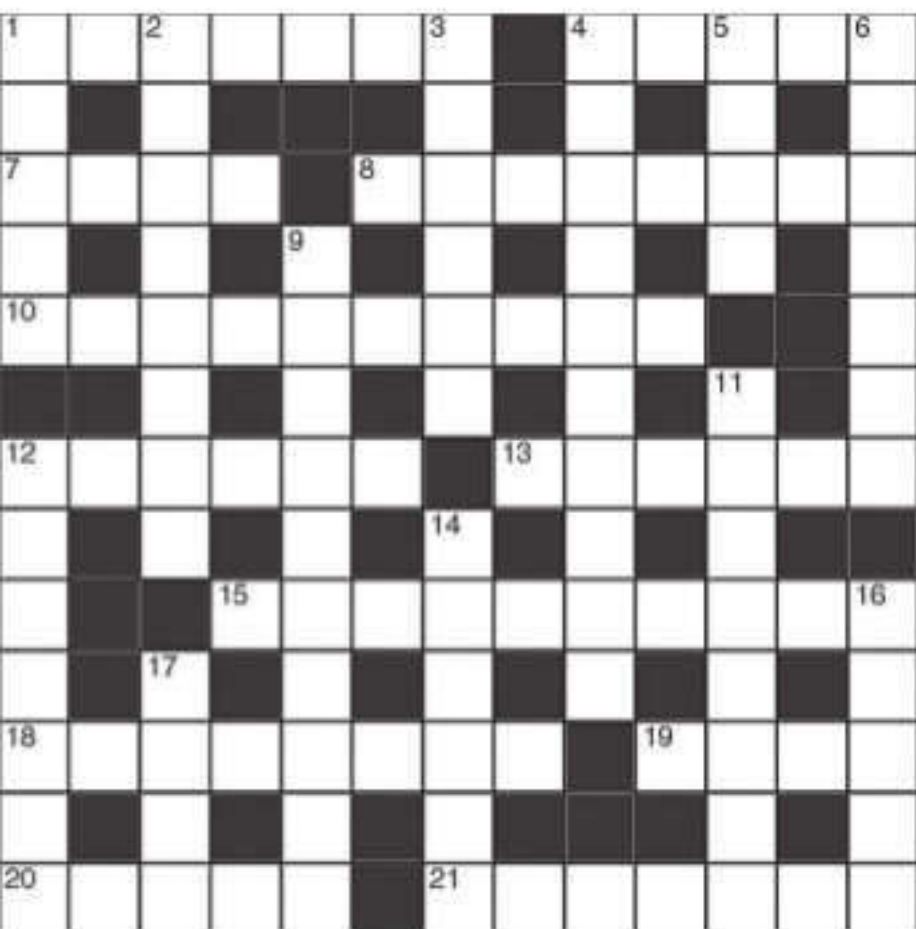
Sd/-
जिला आयुर्वेदिक अधिकारी गुरुग्राम।

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice No. 27/2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.) N.E. Railways, Izzatnagar (F) and on behalf of President of India invites "Open" E-Tender through Online (E-Tendering) for the following work: 1. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-11 Ujhani to Kasganj (Ex Both); Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,31,08,727.97; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,62,000/-; 2. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 in Zone No-12 Kasganj (Incl.) to MHA (Excl.) up to km 253/0 KSJ (Incl.) up to km 427/0 and Jafri, Malgadam Colony (K.S.); Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,79,36,513.90; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹3,58,700/-; 3. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-13 Kasganj LC No. 310 to PTI (Incl.) up to km 204/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹99,800/-; 4. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-14 Kasganj LC No. 310 to PTI (Incl.) up to km 204/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹99,800/-; 5. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-15 FGR (Incl.) to KJL (Excl.) up to km 132/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,49,78,527.06; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,99,600/-; 6. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-16 FGR (Excl.) up to km 132/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,49,78,527.06; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,99,600/-; 7. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-17 CPA (Excl.) up to km 2/2 and BRT Branch line to ARL (Incl.) km 65/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,47,13,436.88; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,94,300/-; 8. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-18 FGR (Incl.) up to km 132/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,49,78,527.06; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,99,600/-; 9. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-19 from MSN (Incl.) to MRT up to L-xing no. 357 (Incl.); Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 10. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-20 from L-xing no. 357 (Excl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 11. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-21 from MSN (Incl.) to MRT up to L-xing no. 357 (Incl.); Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 12. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-22 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 13. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-23 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 14. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-24 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 15. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-25 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 16. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-26 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 17. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-27 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 18. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-28 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 19. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-29 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 20. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-30 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 21. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-31 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 22. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-32 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 23. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-33 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 24. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-34 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 25. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-35 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 26. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-36 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 27. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-37 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 28. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-38 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 29. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-39 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 30. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-40 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 31. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-41 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 32. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-42 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 33. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-43 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 34. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-44 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 35. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-45 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 36. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-46 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 37. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-47 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 38. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-48 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 39. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-49 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 40. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-50 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 41. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-51 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 42. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-52 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 43. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-53 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 44. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-54 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 45. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-55 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 46. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-56 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 47. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-57 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 48. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-58 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 49. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-59 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 50. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-60 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 51. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-61 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 52. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-62 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 53. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-63 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 54. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-64 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 55. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-65 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 56. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-66 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 57. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2027 on Zone No-67 from L-xing no. 357 (Incl.) up to km 253/0 to MSN (Excl.) up to km 253/0; Approx. Value(₹): ₹1,46,12,869.96; E.M.D. Money (₹): ₹2,92,300/-; 58. Description of works: Carrying out Zone works for period ending 30.06.2

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Protests expressed in articles (7)
4 Skeleton gets very small part in film (5)
7 Permission denied apparently for a recess (4)
8 Return to digs for economy's sake (8)
10 Possibly desecrated something very private (4,6)
12 A trading record? (6)
13 Fighting a lawsuit (6)
15 Uncast replacements? (5,5)
18 Jolly occasion long overdue (4,4)
19 Wharf ripe for demolition (4)
20 Unusually dry round central Greece — get piping (5)
21 Maybe tarry round church to see the decoration (7)

DOWN
1 Admitted having had possession (5)
2 In France I work on broken dray; a hazard (8)
3 Draw south by boat (6)
4 Flight taken when things get too hot for comfort (4,6)
5 Marian Newman's middle name (4)
6 Troops stepped out in this formation (7)
9 Medical service for which the pay's too uncertain (10)
11 I'm coming up in gear that may be highly painful (8)
12 Hide article in play (7)
14 Ready to throw a line to one in trouble (6)
16 Sprinkle water on some flowers (5)
17 Fever but initially less than a pestilence (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6009 **ACROSS:** 1 Winter sport, 9 Pretext, 10 Rupee, 11 Last, 12 Propound, 14 Claque, 16 Arrest, 18 Tripling, 19 Mere, 22 Orbit, 23 Eritrea, 24 Temperature **DOWN:** 2 Ideas, 3 Tied, 4 Retort, 5 Perspire, 6 Rapture, 7 Application, 8 Leads the way, 13 Full stop, 15 Amiable, 17 Endear, 20 Error, 21 Kilt

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Only the _____ can make a good soup. -Ludwig van Beethoven (4,2,5)

CSAAE

ESIRR

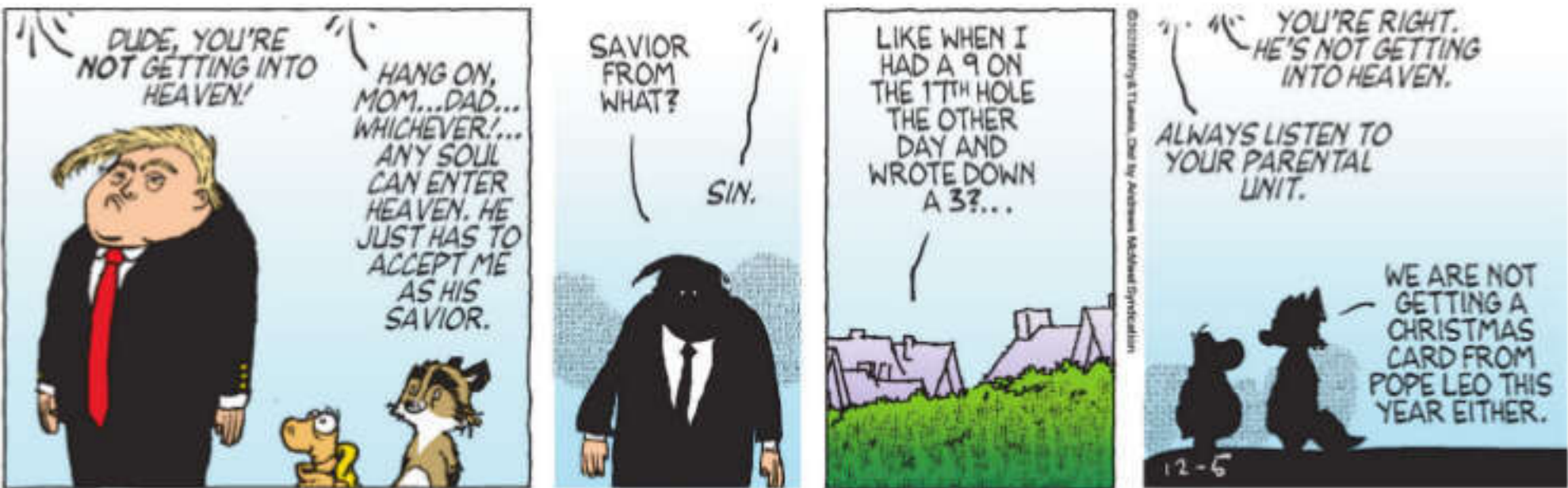
HRUNTU

OSTUHP

Beethoven

ANSWER: Only the pure in heart can make a good soup. - Ludwig van Beethoven

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6344

2			9	3	1			
	3			1	2			
6	9	2	5	4				
	6		4	8				
9	3	6		8	5	7		
		5	2		3			
		6	7	9	2	3		
9	1				5			
4	1	3				9		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6344

2	7	3	4	8	1	6	9	5
6	4	9	3	7	5	2	8	1
5	8	1	6	2	9	3	7	4
8	6	5	7	1	3	9	4	2
4	1	7	8	9	2	5	6	3
9	3	2	5	6	4	8	1	7
1	5	6	9	3	7	4	2	8
3	2	8	1	4	6	7	5	9
7	9	4	2	5	8	1	3	6

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You are feeling affectionate towards others, especially family members. Brush up on your charm. Some of you will find the time to redecorate your living spaces. It's also a great day to explore real estate opportunities. Tonight: You win.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a wonderful day to chat with others. Reach out to siblings, neighbours and relatives. People will be friendly. You will also appreciate the beauty of your surroundings. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a warm, happy day for everyone. You might meet someone unusual, or someone you know might surprise you. This is a wonderful day for financial discussions and negotiations. Tonight: Be friendly.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a fantastic day for you. You'll be optimistic, eager, warm and friendly to everyone! It's a particularly romantic day.(Perhaps the most romantic day of the year.) Tonight: You're admired.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is a feel-good day! This is a popular week for powerful discussions about politics and religion or legal or medical matters. You might meet someone who makes a strong impression on you. Today in particular, you will feel gentle and generous to the world around you. Tonight: Explore.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Make a point to reach out to a friend or get involved with a group today. You might contact someone from another culture or a different country. Or you might hang out with younger people. Someone artistic might inspire you. Tonight: Check your finances.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today is the day to ask for what you want because you look fabulous in the eyes of others, especially authority figures. Having said that, please be nice with partners and close friends. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Grab every chance to travel today, because you want to learn, study, meet new people and encounter new adventures. This is the perfect day to begin a romantic encounter with someone who is "different" from you. Tonight: Get better organised.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Financial transactions will favour you today because this is the perfect day to discuss how to share something. Be open to new romance and surprises. Tonight: Socialise.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Even though you're in work mode, this is a marvelous day to chat. Playful activities, especially competitive sports, will appeal. It's also good to know that this is perhaps the most romantic day of the year. Enjoy good times. Tonight: Relax.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is a great day to party. It's also the perfect time for a vacation. Take time out today to have fun. Work-related travel and relations with co-workers will be rewarding. Tonight: Discussions.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is the most romantic day of the year. If you can't have a planned occasion with someone else, go out and treat yourself. Do something special, just for you. Be open to new encounters. Accept invitations. This is a day for pleasure and friendly appreciation. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

NOTICE

No.: AGC/M/EnH/16/Serv. Contract/Stn. Clg. Date: 05.06.2026

Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expression of Interest (EOI) for preparing a list of approved vendors for cleaning and housekeeping work at railway stations; Location: Any railway station within the Agra Division.

An Expression of Interest (EOI) is invited to prepare a list of approved vendors for providing cleaning and housekeeping services at any railway station situated within the Agra Division of North Central Railway. Interested agencies/individuals may submit their applications, complete with all details in the prescribed format, to the office of the Senior Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F), Divisional Railway Manager's Office, North Central Railway, Agra 282001. The last date and time for the submission of applications is **10.07.2026 by 15:00 hours**. For detailed information and guidelines regarding participation, please visit the official website of North Central Railway at www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. For any information or clarification regarding this matter, the following officials may be contacted: Shri Naveen Kumar, SSE/Tender (Mobile: 9760536361) and Shri Padam Meena, JE/O&F (Mobile: 8433078615). **1276/26 (A)**

f North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section (82 Cr. PC/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Krishan Kumar S/o Raj Kumar R/o H.No.96, Pocket-5, Sec-21, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 521/2021 U/s 188 IPC at PS: Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** of **FIR No. 521/2021 U/s 188 IPC at PS: Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.07.2026**.

By order
Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 09 (Central Distt) Room No. 286, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7534/N/2026

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

Tender No. : BDU-Consultant-04-2025 Dated: 26-05-2026
Closing Date : 16-06-2026
Name of Work: Engagement of Consultant for comprehensive market study to enhance freight, parcel traffic business over NFR, identification of feasible new Gati Shakti cargo Terminals, new Rly freight/parcel terminals, new Warehouses or Godowns and augmentation of existing facilities for increasing Rail coefficient.

In reference to the above-floated tender, the following amendment is hereby issued to the Tender Document:

Page No.	Section/ Reference	Existing Provision	Revised Provision/ To be read as
23	Note : Point No. V	V. Key Personnel includes minimum 14 (Fourteen) personnel required for this assignment as proposed under point no- (12.1) of this under heading of team composition & qualification.	V. Key Personnel includes minimum 14 (Fourteen) personnel required for this assignment as proposed under point no- (IX(i)) of this under heading of team composition & qualification.

Note: All other terms and conditions of the original tender document and any previously issued corrigenda shall remain unchanged.
Full tender document along with all terms and conditions can be viewed in <https://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Chief Commercial Manager/FM
Maligaon, Guwahati-11

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE"

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY

Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE NO.RWF/SIP/1/04/2026-27 Date: 05.06.2026

On behalf of the President of India, Principal Chief Materials Manager invites electronic Tenders from interested Vendors for supply of the following items on the Indian Railways E-Portal – www.ireps.gov.in The Tender documents and the Corrigenda to the Tenders, if any, will be available on the Portal only.

Sl No	Tender No	Due Date	Short Description	Qty
1	P1262028	29.06.26	Coated inserts for Recentering	5450 Nos
2	P1262095	20.07.26	Tin Coated Spiral Machine Taps	1500 Nos
3	P1261316A	26.08.26	25 Ton Axle Journal HDPE End Cover to RWF Drawing	101266 Nos
4	P1262103	27.08.26	Steel Shots Specification IS: 4606 - 1983 (1991-Reaffirmed) grade 1700	410 MT
5	P1262108	04.09.26	Graphite Granules as per RWF specification	607 MT
6	P1262121	10.09.26	GFM Forging Hammer Tool as per RWF Drawing	05 Sets
7	P1262109	18.09.26	Fused silica powder as per RWF specification	211075 Kgs
8	P1262120	25.09.26	Aluminium Star as per RWF specification	14963 kgs
9	P1262110	05.10.26	Heavy duty dry basic ramming mass as per RWF specification	185 MT

This tender notice can be viewed on our website www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in

PRINCIPAL CHIEF MATERIALS MANAGER

OFFICE: SHRI Krishana GOVT. COLLEGE, KANWALI, District-REWARI (Haryana)

Tender Notice

For: Service Level agreement on contract basis (for Horticulture work and security of premises, Chowkidar services etc.)

Sealed tender is here by invited for Service Level agreement on contract basis (for Horticulture work and security of premises, Chowkidar services etc.) services in S.K. Govt. College, Kanwali from interested and eligible services agencies (approved by Govt. of Haryana) having at least 3years experience in similar service in prescribed form. Interested service agencies can collect tender form from the office of Principal S.K. Govt. College, Kanwali. Distt. Rewari on any working day between 9:00 AM to 2:00 PM by paying Rs. 500/- (Payable through demand draft/ bankers cheque of any nationalized bank drawn in favor of Principal, S.K. Govt. College, Kans.ali. All terms and conditions will be attached with the form.

Last date of Submission of sealed tender documents:- 23.06.2026
Date of opening of tender:- 24.06.2026.

Sd/-
Principal

No. 45985/HRY S.K. Govt. College. Kanwali, Distt-Rewari

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kiran @ Safiya, S/o Devi Din R/o 26/02, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.857/2020 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kiran @ Safiya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kiran @ Safiya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kiran @ Safiya of FIR No.857/2020 u/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North) Room No.114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7527/ION/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Govinda, S/o Kalu Ram R/o Vegabond, Sabji Mandi Okhla & Modi Mill Flyover Patri, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 344/2025, u/s 25/54 Arms Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Govinda** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Govinda** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Govinda of FIR No. 344/2025, u/s 25/54 Arms Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 South-East District Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/7643/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Shahnawaj S/o Iqbal R/o Gali No. 3, Khadda Colony, Jaitpur, Delhi** also at 703, Chandni Mohlla, North East Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 302/2020 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC & 25/27 ARMS ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Shahnawaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahnawaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Shahnawaj in FIR No. 302/2020 U/s 392/397/411/34 IPC & 25/27 ARMS ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.07.2026**.

By order
Ms. Isra Zaidi
Judicial Magistrate First Class Room No. 64, 4th Floor, North East District Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7616/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Aslam Khan @ Rihan @ Kalu S/o Mujafar Hussain @ Yasin Khan R/o H.No A-242, Near Buland Masjid, Shastri Park, Delhi,** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 559/2022, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act,** registered at **P.S.: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Aslam Khan @ Rihan @ Kalu,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Aslam Khan @ Rihan @ Kalu,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Aslam Khan @ Rihan @ Kalu, FIR No.: 559/2022, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms Act,** registered at **P.S.: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.07.2026**

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 Central, Room No 138 Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7453/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Anil @ Bhola S/o Chatter Singh R/o B-155, JJ Colony, Raghubir Nagar, Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 219/2025, U/S 21 (C)/29 NDPS Act, PS Crime Branch, NR-II, Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Anil @ Bhola** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Anil @ Bhola** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Anil @ Bhola** the said accused of **FIR No. 219/2025, U/S 21 (C)/29 NDPS Act, PS Crime Branch, NR-II, Rohini, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Puneet Nagpal
Special Judge (NDPS), Central Distt., Room No. 222, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7544/Crime/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE FOR TRIAL IN ABSENTIA CASE

(Section 356(2) BNSS, 2023)

Whereas Proclaimed Offender **KAPIL SANGWAN @ NANDU** s/o Late Surajphan R/o RZ 81B, Nanda Enclave, Najafgarh & RZ 126 East Krishna Vihar, Khaira Road, Najafgarh (Delhi) has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence punishable in **FIR No. 165/24 dated 28.08.2024 u/s 3 MCOC Act, r/w 209 BNS, PS Crime Branch, Delhi** and accused declared proclaimed offender and trial in absentia is to be conducted against accused **Kapil Sangwan @ Nandu**. Whereas, a proclamation has been issued requiring the said accused **KAPIL SANGWAN @ NANDU** to appear before this Court for trial in the aforesaid case; Now, therefore, proclamation is hereby made directing the said accused **KAPIL SANGWAN @ NANDU** to appear before this Court on or before **09.07.2026**.

By Order
Dr. Vishal Gogne, Special Judge, CBI-24(PC Act), Court 410, Rouse Avenue District Court Complex, DDU Marg, New Delhi

DP/7653/Crime/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohit @ Raju, S/o: Surjeet Singh, R/o: K-129/5 Prem Nagar-2 Near Maan Hospital Delhi** also at **Village Sherpur, PO Neshar, PS Harnor, Dist. Nalanda Bihar** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 1194/2016, U/s: 341/506/34 IPC & 25/27 ARMS ACT, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rohit @ Raju** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rohit @ Raju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rohit @ Raju of P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
JMFC-06, North West, Room No. 109, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7264/RD/2026



JUNE 11-JULY 19
48 TEAMS, 16 CITIES, 3 COUNTRIES

The 2026 FIFA World Cup, spread across the United States, Mexico and Canada, is the biggest the sport has ever staged. As always, there are the favourites and the underdogs; those who arrive as stars, and those who come as unknowns and etch their name in prosperity. The game is played as much on the field, tactically and technically, as in the stands. We cover the proceedings from all angles.

Portugal beyond Ronaldo: Vitinha, Bruno provide creative heartbeat

Shankar Narayan

FOR NEARLY two decades, Portugal's football story has been told through Cristiano Ronaldo's lens. Every major tournament has carried the same question: Can Ronaldo carry Portugal once again? As the 2026 FIFA World Cup approaches, that question still remains. The 41-year-old is still the face of Portuguese football, still the player fans come to watch. But for perhaps the first time in his international career, Portugal's hopes may depend less on the man finishing THE moves and more on the players creating them around him.

Somewhere behind Ronaldo, scanning the pitch before receiving the ball, will be 26-year-old midfielder Vitor Machado Ferreira, better known as Vitinha.

Born in Santo Tirso, northern Portugal, Vitinha was introduced to football by his father, Vitor Manuel, a former professional player. Yet the game was never forced on him, allowing him to develop at his own pace. He is not the captain. He is not their biggest star. But over the last two years, he has quietly become one of Portugal's most important players.

A quick look over the shoulder. A pass played with perfect weight. A small run into space to escape pressure. Suddenly, Portugal are moving forward again. It is football's least visible work, but also one of its most important.

Vitinha's biggest strength is not goals or assists, but control. Analysts often call him a 'metronome' because he decides when Portugal speed up and when they slow down. In modern football, where attention is fixed on goals and statistics, he stands out for making the team function better as a unit.

He operates as a deep-lying playmaker, similar to players like Andrea Pirlo or Toni Kroos, dictating games from deep areas rather than advanced positions. Most of his work is simple on the surface, but crucial in shaping how the team plays.

When Paris Saint-Germain signed him in 2022, the club was still driven by big names like Lionel Messi, Neymar, and Kylian Mbappé. Vitinha arrived with little attention and had a difficult start.

He was young, adapting to

Since he burst onto the scene, Portugal's fortunes have hinged on Cristiano Ronaldo, and whether he can carry them once again. But ahead of this World Cup, the focus is shifting to the system behind him, led by a string of talented midfielders and attacking full-backs providing the threat out wide

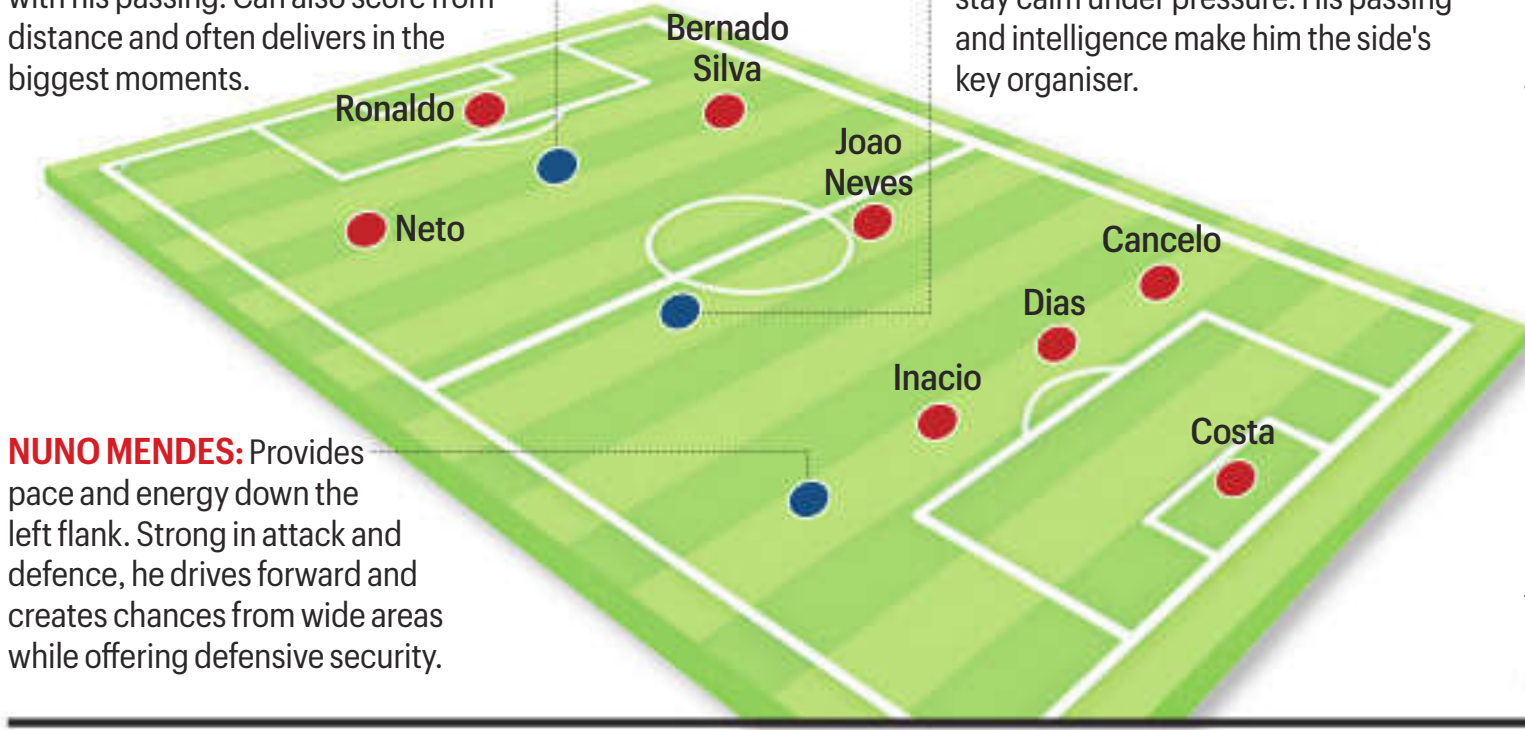


Portugal players receive instructions from coach Roberto Martinez during a pre-tournament friendly in Lisbon. AP

BRUNO FERNANDES: Portugal's chief creator. Looks to play forward, create chances and unlock defences with his passing. Can also score from distance and often delivers in the biggest moments.

VITINHA: Keeps Portugal ticking in midfield. Links defence and attack, controls the tempo and helps his team stay calm under pressure. His passing and intelligence make him the side's key organiser.

NUNO MENDES: Provides pace and energy down the left flank. Strong in attack and defence, he drives forward and creates chances from wide areas while offering defensive security.



Vitinha is not their biggest star. But over the last two years, he has quietly become one of their most important players. A quick look over the shoulder. A pass played with perfect weight. A small run into space to escape pressure. Suddenly, Portugal are moving forward again.

a new league, and competing in a squad full of established stars. At first, opportunities were limited, and he had to wait for his chance.

The turning point came under Luis Enrique. As PSG moved away from relying on

individuals and became a more balanced team, Vitinha grew into one of the most important players in the squad. The Spaniard trusted him to control midfield phases.

"Vitinha is very important for us. He has a significant

role. Vitinha adapts well to everything we ask of him. He has immense technical ability," Enrique said before the Champions League final.

Under Roberto Martinez, Portugal have also become more comfortable keeping the

ball against top opposition. Vitinha's calm style fits this approach perfectly, allowing attackers to stay higher and focus on creating chances.

Midfield control
He is also surrounded by a

talented set of teammates, who are equally competent in their roles. Among them, none is more influential than Bruno Fernandes. The Manchester United playmaker remains Portugal's chief creator, capable of producing passes few others would even attempt. While Vitinha provides control, Fernandes supplies invention.

He often looks for quick, early passes into attacking areas, especially into spaces where Ronaldo can attack the ball. These fast combinations around the box will be central to Portugal's attacking style in the tournament.

With Vitinha behind him, Bruno does not need to control the entire game. He can stay closer to the opposition box, where he is most dangerous. At Manchester United, he often carries the creative burden alone. For Portugal, that responsibility is shared, allowing him to take more risks and act more as a game-changer for the side.

Wide impact

On the left side, Nuno Mendes adds a different kind of threat. After a strong season with Paris Saint-Germain, the full-back has become one of the most important attacking defenders in Europe. He brings pace, strength, and constant forward movement. His runs from deep push opposition defenders back and stretch the pitch.

Mendes' role is not just about overlapping runs, but also occasional underlaps, allowing wingers to hold width and isolate defenders one-on-one. This variation makes Portugal's left side far less predictable. Mendes also has the speed to recover quickly if possession is lost, allowing him to attack without leaving his side exposed. That balance makes him ideal for a high-tempo system. In a team where Vitinha provides control, and Fernandes provides creativity, Mendes adds momentum from wide areas. Each role is different, but they connect naturally.

Together, they help explain why Portugal is seen as a genuine contender for the World Cup. Ronaldo remains the face of the team and its most recognisable figure. Fernandes brings creativity. Mendes brings width and energy. Vitinha brings control.

FROM THE SIDELINES



IN ANTICIPATION: Mexico fans stand along Reforma Avenue in Mexico City as teams begin arriving. AP

'Big words' to compare Yamal to Messi: Spain coach

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 8

SPAIN COACH Luis de la Fuente has hailed Lamine Yamal as one of football's rarest talents but stopped short of declaring the teenager the successor to Lionel Messi, insisting the Argentine remains a figure beyond comparison. Yamal's dazzling rise for Spain and Barcelona has inevitably drawn parallels with Messi, particularly after the resurfacing of the famous photograph showing the Argentine bathing a baby Yamal during a charity calendar shoot nearly two

decades ago. While De la Fuente believes the 18-year-old belongs in an elite category of players blessed with extraordinary talent, he warned against placing the burden of succeeding Messi on the youngster's shoulders. "Messi: Those are big words. Messi has been, is, and will always be... he is football," De la Fuente told *The Guardian*. "Footballers are people of high ability, so intelligent. They are geniuses, and then there are those that are touched by God's wand, and there are very few of those. Lamine, Messi..."

Brazil right-back Wesley ruled out with thigh injury



Associated Press
Morristown, June 8

BRAZIL HAS made an injury replacement to its World Cup roster less than a week before its first match, with right-back Wesley out and midfielder Ederson in. The Brazilian soccer confederation said Sunday that Wesley injured a muscle in his left thigh. He left early in the team's friendly game against Egypt on Saturday night in Cleveland, and imaging found it significant enough to knock Wesley out of the World Cup. "Wesley is an athlete loved by the group and will always be considered part of this team that seeks the six-time world championship," the Brazilian confederation said.

Ederson, 26, is now set to join the team in the U.S. as part of the 26-player roster.

Eriksen 'feeling good' at home after collapse

Reuters
Copenhagen, June 8

DENMARK MIDFIELDER Christian Eriksen said he had returned home on Monday and was recovering well with his family after he collapsed on the pitch during Sunday's friendly international against Ukraine. "Receiving a shock from my ICD (Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator) has had a major impact on both me and my family, but I want to reassure everyone that this was a different situation from what happened in 2021," Eriksen said in a post on Instagram. "I am feeling good, and my recovery has already started," he added.

The 34-year-old playmaker caused widespread concern when he clutched his chest and fell to the turf in the 65th minute of the match against Ukraine in the Danish city of Odense. Sunday's incident marked the second time the 34-year-old playmaker collapsed to the turf while representing his country. In 2021 he collapsed during his side's opening European Championship group game against Finland in Copenhagen.

Iranians wear pins for victims of school strike

Associated Press
Tijuana, June 8

IRAN'S WORLD Cup team arrived in Mexico wearing lapel pins highlighting the victims of a deadly missile strike on an elementary school at the start of the war in the Mideast.

The players wore gold-colored pins with the number "168" on their jackets when getting off their plane Sunday in Tijuana, Mexico. It referred to the people killed, most of them children, when a Feb. 28 strike, likely launched by the U.S., hit the school in Minab in southern Iran. Iran's embassy in Hungary on Monday noted the pins in a social media post with a reference to Minab.

The strike on the school, which was close to a Revolutionary Guard base, was previously memorialized by the Iran team before a warmup game in March in Antalya, Turkey. Players held up pink and purple school backpacks while their national anthem played.

Neither the United States nor Israel has accepted responsibility for the attack on the school, which has come under staunch criticism from the United Nations and human



Iran player Ehsan Hajsafi arrives in Mexico on Monday. AP

rights groups. The Iran delegation flew on a private jet from Antalya on Saturday to Tijuana, after a late change of plans two weeks ago to use Mexico as a training base instead of Tucson, Arizona. Iran is preparing to play all three of its group-stage games in the U.S. ahead of their June 15 opening game in Inglewood near Los Angeles, to face New Zealand.

From mussel-munching octopus Paul to AI prompts

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, June 8

FROM PAUL to Prompts, predicting FIFA World Cup results has come a long way in the last 18 years.

In this age of AI, it all seems a little silly now. From 2008-2010, especially in the World Cup at South Africa, the world banked on a Germany-based octopus called Paul for football predictions.

Hatched at Weymouth, England, Paul picked 11 of the 13 winners of Germany's Euro 2008 and 2010 World Cup campaigns. It would all have been laughed off as a hoot of a joke, but things did get serious enough for then Iran President Mahmoud Ahmadinejad to declare poor Pauli as "the symbol of Western decay and decadence."

When Paul picked Germany to defeat Argentina and that panned out, an Argentine chef threatened to pan-sear him. The recipe had started with detailed braising of the sea animal turned football pundit. His German minders pledged to allow no such thing, but then Paul was declared traitor when he offended German fans by pre-

dicting the home team would lose. They too announced they would eat him.

But then the Spanish prime minister offered to "send state protection" to Germany after he correctly identified them as winners and was under attack, and a diplomatic crisis might've been averted. In his 33-month lifetime, Paul attracted a transfer fee proposal of 30,000 pounds, and warded off competition from German porcupines, pygmy hippopotamuses and tamarins who all failed.

A Singapore parakeet fetched better efficiency, but Paul had by then retired from dipping into jars with mussels, oysters and two competing national flags, his first choice of snack considered the winner. He died in late 2010, but not on a plate.

The smart-armed creature posthumously received attention from iPhone apps, Google doodles and even Chinese movie thrillers.

Sixteen years hence, though, not many are staring at aquariums. They are squinting into smartphones and at whirling supercomputer screens to identify the FIFA World Cup winners. Getting AI to guess the winner on July 19 however, is



Octopus Paul, the so-called "octopus oracle," predicted Spain's victory in their 2010 World Cup semi-final against Germany by choosing a mussels snack. REUTERS/FILE

irresistible.

USAToday used Copilot, though they offered an insightful disclaimer up-front. "Large Language Models aren't keeping up with sports results and matches." This led to refining of Prompts. Nevertheless, Copilot had France ejecting Argentina in the round of 16, Morocco making the semis, Canada beating South Korea and France defeating Brazil in the

final.

AI engineering developers had resoundingly proven one basic English question fed into a comp is smarter than 8-armed octopuses.

Frank Andrade on Artificial Corner deployed Claude to analyse 49,000 matches, with old ones diminishing in importance, and used an Elo score (fewer points for defeating lower ranked) to find his way to

In his 33-month lifetime, Paul attracted a transfer fee proposal of 30,000 pounds, and warded off competition from German porcupines, a hippopotamus and tamarins, who all failed.

Prompts, Opta AI can summon France and Spain as favourites, while slotting Norway into the Top 10, while ChatGPT lines up Spain, France, Argentina, England, Portugal, Brazil. It is not too different from what a casual fan, not enamoured by Messi, might pick.

Between Paul and Prompts, mathematicians have weighed in too, picking Holland as a left-field choice, Portugal closely behind. Grok patriotically and predictably gave a leg-up to USA's chances, calling them 'disruptors'.

China meanwhile is turning the entire predicting-business into a nation-wide game of its own. IChongqing reported that their own tech tranche Lenovo with Migu have planned a "human-versus-AI" World Cup prediction event.

"Lenovo's Tianxi AI agent will bring together 12 Chinese AI models, including DeepSeek, Kimi, ERNIE Bot, Qwen, and China Mobile's Jituan, to compete with fans in match predictions. The program is designed to turn AI prediction into a participatory viewing experience, rather than a background technology tool," IChongqing said.

RIP Paul.

Spain at 27% odds, Argentina 21%, with France and England in semis. AI re-ran the testing 50,000 times, to be sure. And a retrospective AI test on 2018 and 2022 WCs led to 52% correct results.

ActionNetwork.com picked France, using 1200 data points across 25 variables, with Norway predicted to throw up a surprise.

A spokesperson said "the 2026 World Cup outcome was predicted based on key data, including national team form, World Cup history, market value of squads and coach profiles." France's market value? €1.48 billion, as per the website.

Depending on precise

Stokes, Atkinson investigated over ‘incident’ at nightclub



Ben Stokes with Gus Atkinson during the 1st Test. AP
Express News Service
New Delhi, June 8

ENGLAND AND Wales Cricket Board (ECB) said on Monday that it is investigating captain Ben Stokes and fast bowler Gus Atkinson over an undisclosed “incident” in a “nightclub in the early hours of Monday morning”. ECB said that it was investigating “a breach of team protocols” in the hours after England beat New Zealand by 115 runs in the first Test at Lord’s.

“The ECB is currently investigating a breach of team protocols following the conclusion of the first Men’s Test against New Zealand. Ben Stokes and Gus Atkinson were present at a nightclub in the early hours of Monday morning when an incident took place,” said the board in a statement on Monday.

“We are currently seeking further information, and an announcement regarding the squad for the second Test will be made in due course. The Cricket Regulator has been informed and we will provide a further update when possible.”

Stokes had said after the match that he was aware of how much England would’ve been criticised had they failed to win the first Test, before stating he is looking forwarding having a “proper beer with the boys.”

“I knew how big this game was in terms of the result and how it was going to be perceived externally if it didn’t go well, but now it’s gone well,” Stokes said.

“I probably won’t be real happy and smiling until I get up there and share a proper beer with the boys.”

The development comes months after England’s off-field behaviour came under heavy scrutiny during their tours of New Zealand and Australia late last year. England were accused of having a “drinking culture” in their dressing room, with their behaviour during a controversial mid-series break during a rather disastrous Ashes in Australia especially coming under scrutiny.

It later emerged that England’s limited-overs captain Harry Brook was involved in an incident in a nightclub during the tour of New Zealand that happened before the Ashes. The fact that the incident had happened on the night before the third match of a series that England had already lost 2-0 and went on to be swept clean 3-0 only added more fuel to the fire.

Moreover, the news came out in the form of a leak more than a month later while England were struggling to compete with Australia in the Ashes and the ECB had quietly investigated the incident internally and reprimanded Brook.

INDIA VS AFGHANISTAN TEST

Suthar-Sundar combine fashions two-and-a-half-day mauling

Afghanistan crumble from 87 for two to 112 all out, following on, to hand India victory by innings and 300 runs

Lalith Kalidas
New Chandigarh, June 8

IN THE inevitable Afghanistan free fall that was bound to occur on the third day, India arrived at a result without overstretching the batting and bowling departments. With 14 wickets felled shortly after tea on Monday, Shubman Gill’s men also held time to rearrange the record books with India’s largest ever innings victory – by an innings and 300 runs.

The new PCA Stadium’s subdued Test initiation also successfully soft-launched India’s bid to regain their sub-continental flavours before the World Test Championship (WTC) trip to Sri Lanka in two months.

Adding onto the 412-run innings lead that they sucked out inside 20 overs in the morning would have meant a futile exercise in the heat. Having bundled the visitors at 152, Gill decided it was best to deploy his spin forces back on again, with a sprightly debutant and a poised off-spinner’s drifters muting the Afghan resistance.

Ten minutes after he led his side off the field with a rare feat in his first Test match bowling innings, Manav Suthar was back on, this time with the new ball. The Afghans took aggressive measures to ward off the debutant left-armed, but Suthar had delivered a good account of his strengths already in the morning.

Exercise in control

Starting the session with three scalps - the first of which came off just his fourth delivery on day two - Suthar nimbly doubled his tally.

The 23-year-old from Rajas-



India will next face Sri Lanka for a World Test Championship trip in two months. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

than did not seek to impress. Rather, he nailed down his strengths, ball by ball, across 22 overs that jotted 118 dots and six wickets for only 33 runs.

Save the reputation of the opposition, the figures remain exceptional for the conventional debutant nerves. Suthar achieved a stamp of approval in becoming only the seventh Indian to bag a five-for in his first innings on debut, and only the second to reach the landmark this century.

The restraint on lengths was remarkable even when he swerved the ball from left to right with prodigious drift, as he did to defuse Afghanistan’s brick-wall Rahmat Shah for his fifth wicket. For a majority of his innings, No. 4 Shah had played well within his body. Smearing boundaries from simple extensions of his compact defence, Shah’s half-century justified his position as Afghanistan’s record run-scorer in the format.

But when Suthar foxed him on the angle, sliding way past the right-hander’s eyeline outside the off-stump, Shah’s attempted sweep was mangled from around his pads, the ball turning back square to knock the middle-stump.

“When you’re batting in the first innings, try to score 350 every time you get in to bat. No matter where we’re playing, in what kind conditions. I think there’s enough trust in our bowling group that we can take 20 wickets anywhere.”

SHUBMAN GILL,
INDIA TEST CAPTAIN

There was minimal deviation from his drift-and-revs exhibition on length. 98 of his 122 deliveries in the first innings landed between the 4 to 6-metre mark on good length, further pressed into a dangerous corridor in line of the stumps.

He rarely employed quivers past his usual strengths. Only one delivery in his entire spell was marked as a quicker variation, with just seven instances of an arm ball being released.

Suthar only turned to his secondary line after nine wicket-less overs in the afternoon. Set-

ting up Afsar Zazai on the shorter length, the left-armed darted a quicker 92-kph arm ball that held its line to trap the wicket-keeper before stumps.

The Afghan surrender was spread flat out when even a composed Shah lost his rhythm, triggering a collapse with a reckless swipe to a loopy Washington Sundar delivery, grabbed by Suthar at mid-off. Producing the sharpest drift of all spinners on show, Sundar (four for 36) soon settled into his stride, proving uncomfortable for the rest of the Afghan order that folded within another 25 runs — from 87 for two to 112 all out following on.

There was confidence back in the bowling room as the batters collectively struck a jumbo first-innings score, staples of India’s 12-year home dominance between two home defeats in 2012 and 2024.

“When you’re batting in the first innings, try to score 350 on the board every time you get in to bat. No matter where we’re playing, in what kind of conditions. I think there’s enough trust in our bowling group that we can take 20 wickets anywhere, whenever there’s a transition,” skipper Gill reflected in the post-match ceremony.

Back to spin ways?

With seven of their remaining nine Tests in the WTC lined up in Asian conditions, the potential association of a new spin quartet was among the primary targets on head coach Gautam Gambhir’s priority. Its newest member Suthar’s 7/62 match figures, armed by understanding spin peers around him, hold the progression in good stead.

“I personally know what Kuldeep [Yadav] and Manav go about with their bowling plans. Obviously, we also know about each other’s strengths, what each of us could bring to the table,” Sundar had told reporters the previous evening. “Even in preparation, we stick together over a period of time. I think the team will benefit from it in the time ahead.”

A two-and-a-half day Afghan mauling isn’t much to write home about. India will not complain as they chart their sub-continental revival, one step at a time.

BRIEF SCORES: India 564/8 (Gill 126, Rahul 100, Pant 81; Saleem /140) **bt Afghanistan 152/10 and 112 all out** (Seiqualah 42; Sundar 4/36, Kuldeep 3/30) by innings and 300 runs.

and other support staff tell them to play their game freely.

“But the only thing is that if the team requires something specific in red-ball cricket. At that time, whoever the batsman is, or even bowler or all-rounder, they need to play according to the team’s needs,” said Kotak.

Pant had essayed his knock with a strike rate of 66.94 and perished while trying to play an attacking shot against Afghan captain Hashmatullah Shahidi.

“Rishabh hit three sixes also in an over. He batted the way he wanted to bat. I don’t think there was any question of the situation. He is such a big player; why would anybody tell him to play like this or that?”

“I had said during the England tour that he reads bowlers well. He tries to play with the bowler’s mind and will do some-

thing the bowler is not expecting. His innings was very good. He missed out on a hundred, or maybe even a double hundred,” said the batting coach.

The one-off Test against Afghanistan happened just days after the IPL concluded and with most of the players in the Gill-led team coming to this Test after playing in the IPL, the side had its challenges. “The challenge was to get into red-ball mode quickly, in four-five practice sessions. We discussed certain things in Guwahati also.

“In England, I think our batters handled pacers really well. In the South Africa series, we could have done better. I don’t agree with a lot of people saying our batters struggled against spin. But we did not perform according to our potential,” Kotak signed off.

• BRIEFLY



Jofra Archer missed the 1st Test due to his IPL commitments. AP

McCullum hopeful of Archer’s return: Depends on conditions

ENGLAND HEAD coach Brendon McCullum said he hopes bowler Jofra Archer will be available for the second Test against New Zealand at The Oval, but stressed that selection will depend on conditions. The right-arm quick was rested for the opening Test at Lord’s after a short turnaround following his commitments with IPL side Rajasthan Royals. In his absence, Gus Atkinson, Ollie Robinson and Josh Tongue combined to take 19 wickets in England’s low-scoring win at Lord’s on Sunday, and McCullum indicated Archer would not be guaranteed a place even if fit for the second Test starting on June 17. “We are hopeful he will be available for the second Test. Then we will work out conditions-wise where we are at,” McCullum told reporters. REUTERS

Federer to return to US Open for exhibition event

ROGER FEDERER will return to the U.S. Open this year for an exhibition match, seven years after his last appearance at the Grand Slam in 2019, the event organizers said on Monday. Federer, who is the only player to win five consecutive U.S. Open titles, will headline an event titled “Roger Federer: An Icon Returns to New York” on August 25. He will be joined by 2003 U.S. Open champion Andy Roddick, as well as Andre Agassi and John McEnroe. REUTERS

Govt asks AIFF, ISL clubs to form task force

SPORTS MINISTER Mansukh Mandaviya asked the AIFF and ISL clubs to create a task force that would thrash out a “structured plan” for at least the next two seasons of the crisis-ridden league in a meeting. The deliberation session that lasted a couple of hours was “cordial”, according to well-placed sources and the minister urged the clubs and the AIFF to work out an “amicable business model” for the 14-club ISL. PTI

Indian archers begin Asian Games build-up

INDIA WILL begin their preparations for the upcoming Asian Games with a completely revamped squad taking the field at the Archery World Cup Stage 3 beginning on Tuesday. The biggest talking point is the absence of star archer Deepika Kumari from the recurve women’s team event title. Attention will now shift to 19-year-old Kirti Sharma, who topped the Asian Games trials, as she faces her biggest test yet on the international stage. PTI

Shashikesh Kumar handed 3-yr suspension

SPRINTER SHASHIKESH Kumar has been handed a 2nd three-year suspension by NADA’s Anti-Doping Disciplinary Panel (ADDP) for competing while serving a prior ban. Kumar was earlier suspended for a three-year period from January 10, 2024 to January 9, 2027. His fresh suspension period will start from January 9, 2027. Another track and field athlete Kajal has been handed a five-year ban. Her suspension began April 30, 2025, according to the latest list updated by the NADA. PTI

Shreyanka and Radha power win in warm-up game

BHARTI FULMALI, Shreyanka Patil and Radha Yadav starred as India crushed the West Indies by 26 runs in their first warm-up match of the Women’s T20 World Cup on Monday. Fulmali made 56 to power India to 179 for eight. In reply, the West Indies could only manage 153 for eight. India will take on the hosts England in their final warm-up match here before taking on Pakistan in their T20 World Cup opener on June 14 in Birmingham. PTI

Rahi tops women’s 25m pistol T4 finals

FORMER ASIAN Games champion Rahi Sarnobat produced a commanding performance to win the women’s 25m pistol finals, outwitting double Olympic medalist Manu Bhaker in the National Selection Trials 4 being organised to finalise India’s Asian Games shooting squad on Monday. Rahi looked in control throughout the final and finished with 37 hits to comfortably take the top spot. Bhaker settled for silver with 35 hits. PTI

• DIFFERENT TEST

In Dambulla, all eyes on Sooryavanshi debut as India A gear up for tri-series

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, June 8

UNDER THE Dambulla sun, a youthful India A squad, featuring a few experienced names, will begin their quest on Tuesday to strengthen their claims for the senior ODI setup as attention turns from T20 to the 50-over format.

The squad is largely built around IPL performers, and led by newly-appointed T20I vice-captain Tilak Varma. The main spotlight, however, will be on Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. If he plays against Sri Lanka A in the tri-series opener - with Afghanistan A the third team - it will mark his India A List A debut and a key step in his rapid rise.

The selectors have seen enough to include him in the senior T20I setup for the upcoming tours. Another big harvest of runs in the next two-

and-a-half weeks could only improve his chances of perhaps entering the 50-over squads as well.

The Sri Lanka tour, however, will be a different test. The pitches in Dambulla can be bowler-friendly, and with all matches happening during the day, there would be no dew factor to assist the batsmen. Sooryavanshi’s shot selection, hence, could have a greater bearing than pure intent.

The 15-year-old might need to balance his natural attacking game with a calmer approach when required, and that will be one of the key things India A will want to see from him. The white ball in ODIs doesn’t swing for a long time, but it offers enough assistance for bowlers to make inroads. How Sooryavanshi meets the challenge will offer a clearer picture of his development.



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi’s rapid rise continues with a call-up to the India A team and a chance to test his 50-overs mettle. REUTERS

But even with those challenges, there is still a real excitement around him. He brings energy to the top order. He forces fielding sides to think differently. And he can change the tempo of a game quickly. That is why his role in this series will be watched closely.

“I will change my batting according to the requirements of red-ball cricket. I will change according to the needs of ODIs. My dream is to play in all three formats,” he told RR in an interview recently.

Around him, India A have a strong group of IPL performers

Vaibhav might need to balance his attacking game with a calmer approach when required, and that will be one of the key things India A will want to see from him.

who are also looking to take the next step.

Priyansh Arya, who, like Sooryavanshi, first came into the spotlight in IPL 2025, will be a name to watch out for. The left-hander had a poor end to IPL 2026, but his ability to be dismissive towards anything on his pads makes him a dangerous batsman to have at the top.

In the second half of the

league, he also showed he could be equally aggressive on the off side, and his stands with Sooryavanshi could be crucial for India to put up tall scores on the board.

Ruturaj Gaikwad, who has come in for the injured Riyan Parag, brings experience at the top. The right-hander scored his maiden ODI hundred against South Africa in Raipur last December, and a good tri-series could improve his chances of staying in the setup in the forthcoming months.

The presence of Prabhsimran Singh adds an interesting dynamic. The right-hander has formed a successful opening partnership with Arya in the IPL, but may have to adopt a different role at number three or below in this tournament.

Ayush Badoni’s middle-order role and the need to bat deep into an innings will be crucial to building on the top-

order foundations. He can be flexible and can adapt depending on the situation. If India A lose wickets in the middle overs, Badoni’s role in rebuilding or accelerating will be key.

Nishant Sindhu offers balance as a left-handed all-rounder. He can hold an innings together if needed and also chip in with useful spin. On Sri Lankan pitches, his spin bowling could become important in the middle overs when batsmen try to rotate strike.

On the bowling side, Yash Thakur has been rewarded for a good Vijay Hazare Trophy campaign, where his 19 wickets in nine matches took Vidarbha to the title.

Yudhvir Singh Charak and Anshul Kamboj add more fast-bowling options, both capable of hitting hard lengths and breaking partnerships. Arshad Khan lends variety to the at-

tack. Vipraj Nigam and Harsh Dubey will offer the spin bowling options to complement the pacers.

But despite all the balance, the focus will still come back to Sooryavanshi. This is his first real step into India A cricket in List A format. The talent is clear, but this tour will show how ready he is for longer, more demanding challenges. If he adapts quickly in Dambulla, it will only increase the belief that he is a player for the future.

SQUAD: Tilak Varma (**Captain**), Priyansh Arya, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Ayush Badoni, Nishant Sindhu, Harsh Dubey, Suryansh Shedge, Prabhsimran Singh (WK), Kumar Kushagra (WK), Vipraj Nigam, Yash Thakur, Yudhvir Singh Charak, Anshul Kamboj, Arshad Khan.

Live on Sony Sports Network from 10 am